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EXPRESS investigation Part I

Picked by BJP, protected by Congress: Face of Karnataka job scams stayed on despite red flags

Last month, Shivashankarappa Sahukar, head of Karnataka Public Service Commission, was suspended over daughter job and paper leak. Over three years, Congress shunted out two officials who flagged his 'misuse of power'

Jay Mazoomdaar
Bengaluru, New Delhi,
September 18



Shivashankarappa Sahukar was suspended on August 25; the KPSC office in Bengaluru EXPRESS



Look who was in charge of probe against him: Member with her own political trail

Jay Mazoomdaar & Johnson T A
Bengaluru, September 18

IT'S NOT just Shivashankarappa S Sahukar who enjoyed patronage across the aisle in the Karnataka Public Service Commission. There's a political trail behind the KPSC's choice to lead its internal probe against him, records investigated by *The Indian Express* show.

The probe panel chief Shakuntala Dundigoudar, a former

E. Leaked papers, daughter job **P11**

struction company owned by her husband, Shrikant Dundigoudar, a PWD contractor linked to a slew of government contracts, according to available records. They are residents of Shiggaon in Haveri district, the former Assembly constituency of ex-CM and BJP leader Basavaraj Bommai.

The KPSC picked Shakuntala to head its four-member committee to investigate the allegations against Sahukar on

Found 'using phone, ChatGPT in exam hall', IIT-B student ends life; protests erupt

Pallavi Smart & Manish Kumar Pathak
Mumbai, September 18

A SECOND-YEAR student of IIT Bombay died by suicide Friday, hours after he was found using a mobile phone in an examination hall. The 19-year-old's death led to a protest by over 400 students on the campus and the postponement of the ongoing mid-semester examinations.

The student, from the Department of Energy Science and Engineering, was allegedly found using a mobile phone in the exam hall.

According to an official statement from the institute, the student had uploaded the examination question paper on ChatGPT to seek answers.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

NEW NAMES, SYMBOLS FOR TMC FACTIONS

Symbol gone, Mamata backs Cong candidate; he is arrested

Milan Pradhan, Cong's choice for bypoll in Nandigram, held in 2007 murder case

Ravik Bhattacharya & Damini Nath
Kolkata, New Delhi,
September 18

HOURS AFTER the Election Commission of India allotted alternative names and symbols to the TMC factions led by Mamata Banerjee and Arup Roy, the former Chief Minister Friday withdrew her candidate for the October 6 Assembly bypoll in Nandigram and extended

support to the Congress. She also moved the Supreme Court against the EC decision to freeze the original TMC name and symbol.

But in a jolt to the Opposition, the Congress candidate, Milan Pradhan, was arrested in a murder case dating back to 2007, the year Nandigram was rocked by an agitation over land acquisition.

The BJP candidate from

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

80 chefs, 450 menu items: Inside Asian Games kitchen, it's a culinary Olympics



Mihir Vasavda
Nagaya (Japan), September 18

SIXTY THOUSAND bananas. A tonne of rice. Two tonnes of chicken. Up to 35,000 pieces of



Peter Wright, who is responsible for the athletes' catering, next to a vat of soy sauce

bread and 30 kg of almonds. A total of 450 menu items. Every single day.

For Peter Wright, the founder of Global Hospitality Group, feeding an Asian Games is less about putting food on a plate than running a small international food system. It begins before dawn, caters to athletes from across the continent and keeps serving until 1am.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Happening today

• LEADER OF OPPOSITION Rahul Gandhi will interact with students in Indore as part of his 'Chhatron ki Goonj' initiative.

Surendra Koli, acquitted in Nithari killings, found dead

Vidheesha Kuntamalla, Sakshi Chand & Nirbhay Thakur
Haridwar, New Delhi,
September 18

SURENDRA KOLI, who was acquitted in the 2006 Nithari serial murders case last year and walked out of Greater Noida's Kasna Jail 10 months ago, was found dead in Haridwar on Friday.

Haridwar Police said Koli, 53, had been living in the city for over a month, running a small tea stall in the Sapt Sarovar area on Bhupatwala Road.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 7

Business as Usual

By EP UNNY

Tatas going through multiple Ls - Lead, List, Learn...



TOMORROW: LIFTING THE VEIL ON A SCAM



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Face of Karnataka job scams stayed on despite red flags

Over the past seven years since Sahukar was appointed to the KPSC as a member in 2019 and chairman in 2021 by the BJP government, a string of alleged irregularities has marked his tenure, an investigation by *The Indian Express* has found. Irregularities that were red-flagged by top officials within KPSC, at least four times between 2019 and this year — a period that straddles Karnataka governments under the BJP and the Congress.

Sahukar, 61, was clearly protected species.

In fact, his appointment process itself was fraught and the investigation reveals details of how an informal money lender rose to head one of the state's most powerful constitutional bodies tasked with recruiting for coveted government jobs.

Handpicked by BJP in 2019 despite red flags

On August 31, 2019, just 36 days after BJP's B S Yediyurappa took oath as chief minister for the fourth time, Sahukar was appointed under the "official" category to the KPSC along with two "non-official" members.

Sahukar, however, was subsequently shifted to the "non-official" category following objections that he had never held government office — "official" members of a Public Service Commission need to have held government office for at least 10 years. While non-official and official members enjoy identical status, the latter are usually relied upon to steer the organisation based on administrative expertise.

Red flags were raised over Sahukar's professional record, too.

According to KPSC records, he graduated in 1988 with a degree in agricultural engineering from Raichur College of Agricultural Engineering, where he worked as a supervisor between January 1989 and August 1991.

After a five-year gap, he took up a contractual job in July 1996 as Farm Guidance Instructor in a National Cooperative Union of India (NCUI) project in Gulbarga. What these records do not show is that in March 2010, NCUI decided not to extend Sahukar's contract beyond March 2011 and asked him to "hand over complete

charge", citing performance that was "not found satisfactory" and noting he was "not punctual".

There are no public records of Sahukar's subsequent engagements till the KPSC posting. "He did odd jobs and ran an informal money-lending business. But two years in the KPSC made him powerful enough to ensure he became the chairman even before the chair was vacant, so to speak," said a former KPSC member and ex-colleague of Sahukar.

The colleague was referring to the State Cabinet decision on March 17, 2021, to appoint Sahukar as KPSC chief on the same day IAS officer Shadakshari Swamy's tenure at the helm ended on April 3. In contrast, Swamy had been appointed interim chairman on January 10, 2019, over a month after his predecessor retired on December 8, 2018, and confirmed as permanent chairman only on August 17, 2019.

"That (Swamy's appointment) is the usual process. It takes a few weeks for screening the candidates, etc. But Sahukar's elevation was immediate," said a former senior office-bearer of the KPSC.

Sahukar did not respond to phone calls and messages from *The Indian Express* seeking comment. When contacted, Yediyurappa's media office said he was not immediately available for comment.

When Cong stepped in with a shield

By the time Congress returned to power and Siddaramaiah took charge as chief minister in May 2023, Sahukar was engaged in a faceoff with IAS officer Vikas Suralkar, the KPSC secretary since July 2022.

Suralkar had initiated transparency measures, including official social media accounts and more recruitment information on the KPSC website. "The chairman and his supporters among the members strongly resisted these measures. Things came to a head in 2023 when Sahukar started withholding approval on files and bypassing the secretary in holding meetings," said a KPSC official who witnessed the standoff.

In June 2023, the KPSC chairman wrote to the new Chief Minister against the secretary, followed by a formal

● KPSC UNDER LENS

Composition

- Up to 16 members
- 1 chairperson
- 6-year terms
- Permanent secretariat

Role

Recruitments to Karnataka Administrative Services; gazetted probationers, technical & specialised cadre; administrative & ministerial cadre; non-tech

cadre; dept exams for probation and promotions

Scale

Advertises thousands of jobs for lakhs of aspirants; conducts dozens of exams/interviews annually

Crisis

Facing multiple corruption charges; hundreds of jobs affected by ongoing investigations and litigation

complaint to the Chief Secretary in August. Responding to a show-cause notice, Suralkar submitted a report to the Department of Personnel and Administrative Reforms, flagging systemic loopholes.

In his September 13 letter, reviewed by *The Indian Express*, Suralkar said "departures from the rules" had resulted in "misuse of authority by the Chairperson and injustice to meritorious candidates". He enclosed documents detailing "deficiencies/irregularities" in the interview process and sought immediate action.

The next day, the Congress government removed Suralkar as KPSC secretary. When contacted, Suralkar declined to comment.

IAS officer Latha Kumari succeeded Suralkar in September 2023. In December, she refused to approve the appointment of KPSC's Head of Legal Cell, selected by a three-member panel headed by Sahukar, citing lack of transparency.

In response, Sahukar and five other commission members did not attend key meetings and gave written notice that they would not sign files until their candidate was appointed, records show.

The standoff stalled recruitment for more than 2,000 government jobs. Finally, in a letter to the Governor via the Chief Secretary on January 25, 2024, Kumari sought government action against Sahukar for alleged "misuse of authority".

The Indian Express reviewed the letter in which Kumari wrote that meetings were repeatedly postponed, stalling appointments and leaving files without orders or reasoned rejections. She accused the chairman of directing changes to

eligibility conditions and recruitment requirements, by-passing transparency checks, handpicking interview panels, and dictating how tenders and contracts were handled.

Officials worked under pressure and fear, hesitant to flag proposals they considered legally impermissible, Kumari wrote, recommending action under Article 317 of the Constitution against chairman Sahukar and four commission members.

According to sources in the KPSC and the government, Kumari was told during a meeting with a top Karnataka official on February 6, 2024: withdraw her letter or go on leave.

The next day, she was placed on "paid leave" and a replacement appointed. On February 13, the KPSC approved Sahukar's chosen legal-cell candidate and withdrew Kumari's notification inviting fresh applications.

When contacted, Latha Kumari said she did not want to discuss matters related to KPSC with the media. Siddaramaiah's media office said he declined to comment.

How a proposed SIT probe got buried

Another flashpoint between Kumari and Sahukar was the selection of 24 Assistant Executive Engineers (AEE). After the examination in July 2023 and interviews in September, the KPSC received a complaint alleging tampering of answer sheets. While the secretary sought an external probe, sources said, Sahukar ordered an internal inquiry.

As the probe dragged on, the secretary sent the final selection list to the government for appointment, conditional on the commission's decision

pending investigation. The government subsequently appointed 23 candidates with the same condition between June and December 2024.

In February 2025, the internal KPSC probe found 10 candidates guilty of tampering with answer sheets and sought cancellation of their selection. The candidates approached the Karnataka State Administrative Tribunal (KSAT) and then the Karnataka High Court.

On March 18, 2025, a bench of Justices Krishna Dixit and Ramachandra Huddar indicated that the court might hand the probe to the CBI. On March 24, 2025, the court considered the government's proposal to give the investigation to the CID — as recommended by the KPSC probe report — and said it would decide after hearing "all the stakeholders".

On April 8, lawyers for the students said they had "absolutely no objection whatsoever" to a CBI probe, asserting that their clients had committed no wrongdoing. The advocate general, however, proposed an SIT and 20 days later, submitted the names of three police officers in a sealed cover. The bench concluded the hearing and reserved its judgment on April 28.

On May 1, Justice Krishna Dixit was transferred to the Orissa High Court. On August 22, 2025, a new bench of Justices S G Pandit and K V Aravind sent the matter back to KSAT without ordering an investigation.

Asked whether the state had brought the proposed SIT probe to the notice of the new High Court bench, the office of Karnataka Advocate General K Shashi Kiran Shetty said in an email: "Yes. The Hon'ble Bench considered it appropriate that a Tribunal constituted for the speedy disposal of recruitment matters must be approached at the first instance, instead of invoking the inherent powers of the Hon'ble High Court."

A former KPSC member pointed out that "nothing stopped the state from ordering an investigation" on its own. "Whether the students are guilty or being framed, the tampering of OMR (Optical Mark Recognition) answer sheets happened in KPSC custody. A CBI or SIT probe could have exposed who was responsible," said the former member.

Look who was in charge of probe

July 25, a day after police registered an FIR over alleged irregularities in the recruitment of 400 veterinary officers during his watch. The KPSC dissolved the panel after the Congress government transferred the police investigation to the CID on July 28, ignoring the BJP's call for a CBI probe.

How a reforms panel was ignored

In 2023, Shakuntala's appointment to the KPSC itself had raised eyebrows within the official establishment.

The Karnataka Public Service Commission (Conditions of Service) Regulations, 1957 originally provided for a chairperson and nine members. The sanctioned strength was subsequently expanded to a chairperson and 13 members — 14 in all.

Article 316 of the Constitution requires that, "as nearly as may be", half the members of a Public Service Commission should have held government office for at least 10 years. The rest are classified as "non-official" members with no specific educational or professional qualifications prescribed.

On February 3, 2023, the Karnataka Administrative Reforms Commission-II recommended that the KPSC's total strength, including its chairperson, be reduced from 14 to eight. It noted that Maharashtra and West Bengal had three-member commissions and that, apart from Kerala, no other state at the time had more than eight members.

The report also proposed qualifications for candidates drawn from different professional fields. For an academic appointee, it suggested at least 10 years' experience as a full professor.

"By the end of February, CM Bommai issued an internal note to appoint Shakuntala. When it was informed that there was no vacancy for non-official members, he decided to increase the strength of the KPSC," said a former member.

On March 3, 2023, four weeks after the reforms report was presented, Bommai directed the Chief Secretary to take steps to increase the KPSC's sanctioned strength from a chairperson and 13 members to a chairperson and 15 members.

Records show the Chief Minister's Office and the Department of Personnel and Administrative Reforms moved rapidly.

On March 15, the government amended Regulation 3 by substituting "Fifteen" for "Thirteen". On March 16, Shakuntala was appointed as a non-official member — the sole appointee named in the notification.

On April 7, her husband Shrikant announced on Facebook: "I joined the BJP today in support of our MLA from Shiggavi-Savarnur constituency and the proud and popular Chief Minister of the state, Shri Basavaraj Bommai." Sources said the post marked Shrikant's return to the party after he had left in 2020 to join the Congress.

KPSC records do not state Shakuntala's educational or professional qualifications. When contacted, she declined to comment.

Last year, hearing a case on alleged irregularities in the KPSC selection process, a Karnataka High Court bench had observed: "It bewilders any sensible man that how unqualified persons if appointed as members would be able to conduct the interview to the meritorious candidates who obviously, will be graduates if not double/post graduates in various branches of knowledge, may be with super specialization too. What impression the superior lot would gather if it is made to appear before the inferior few, needs no elaboration."

Asked about Shakuntala's qualification for the public service commission and its panel, KPSC interim chairman Dr B Prabhudev stated: "As per KPSC records, she holds BSc and BEd degrees and was appointed as a non-official member in recognition of her social service. She was appointed to chair the preliminary fact-finding committee based on her seniority as a member."

Political & business ties

Corporate filings show Shakuntala had been a director of Hubballi-registered Bannur Infrastructure Services Pvt Ltd since its incorporation in 2013. Her directorship ceased on March 15, 2023, the day before her KPSC appointment. The filings for 2025 record her shareholding at 10%, with her husband holding 90%.

In April 2023, Congress leaders alleged that the Bommai government had awarded contracts worth thousands of crores of rupees to his associates, naming Shakuntala's husband Shrikant among them. Company filings show Bannur Infra-

structures' revenue rose from around Rs 25 crore in 2021-22 to Rs 65 crore in 2022-23.

Meanwhile, in unrelated proceedings decided by the Karnataka High Court in February 2025, Shrikant was described as a Class-I PWD contractor who had sought reimbursement of differential GST from 11 government respondents for works contracts he had executed.

In the run-up to the 2018 Karnataka elections, Shrikant was associated with a local grouping that opposed Bommai, then the sitting MLA from Shiggaon, according to a longtime BJP election organiser who worked in the Dharwad region.

"That was before he (Shrikant) formally joined the party (BJP) in April 2018 in the presence of (BS) Yediyurappa, and accompanied sitting MLA Bommai when he filed the nomination from Shiggaon (in 2023). He funded Bommai's Assembly campaign, and organised and addressed political gatherings seeking vote on his behalf," the poll organiser said.

When contacted, Shrikant said he was not in the BJP when his wife became a KPSC member but did not mention that he had rejoined the party weeks later. "The CM has all the powers to make the appointments. Maybe the considerations were to appoint a woman member and give regional representation to Haveri district. It is a false notion that Bannur Infrastructure received contracts during Bommai's tenure as CM. We have been doing business for over 10 years and are wrongly linked with him. He has not favoured us in any contracts," he said.

The Indian Express reached out to Bommai through emails, phone calls and messages. He was not available for comment.

According to sources, Shrikant's political association with Bommai strengthened in the months leading up to the May 2023 Shiggaon Assembly election. But they fell out before the 2024 Shiggaon Assembly by-election, necessitated by Bommai's election to the Lok Sabha, as Shrikant opposed the BJP's decision to field the ex-CM's son Bharath Bommai. Following the BJP's defeat, the party expelled Shrikant for six years for alleged anti-party activity in November 2024. "But none of this affected (Shakuntala's) position in the KPSC," the former office-bearer said.

Mamata backs Cong candidate; he is arrested

Nandigram is Hasirani Rath, mother of Chandranath Rath, Suvendu Adhikari's aide who was killed days before Adhikari became Chief Minister in May this year. The Mamata faction candidate, Sanchita Pradhan Dey, met Adhikari Thursday, a day before opting out of the race.

The Mamata faction and the Congress slammed the BJP over the arrest of Milan Pradhan and demanded his release.

Banerjee, in a post on X, said, "Minutes after we extended our support to the Congress candidate for the bypoll in Nandigram, Congress candidate Milan Pradhan was arrested.

The timing raises serious questions and is the usual BJP formula: dig out an old case. But why now? Just after we announced support to the Congress! The BJP's politics of vendetta and atrocities show a clear pattern. With manipulation, with vote loot, with intimidation, the Election Agency-BJP partnership is killing democracy every day."

Congress state president Subhankar Sarkar, addressing reporters, said, "Only one party and its accomplices will contest polls? There will be no multi-party system. The arrest of our candidate just shows this."

Congress leader Adhir Ranjan Chowdhury said, "The BJP is afraid because all the parties opposed to the BJP are joining hands with the Congress. And it is out of this fear that the Nandigram candidate is now facing arrest in connection with an old case. What was the police doing all this time? Even when the candidate submitted the affidavit at the District Magistrate's office, the DM raised no issue. And now, right in the middle of the campaign, when they can sense the momentum shifting towards the Congress, the BJP is panicking. Is that why this sudden arrest? The Congress

has never bowed its head, and it never will. If necessary, even if our candidate is kept in police custody, we will still fight this election."

A formal statement from the police on Pradhan's arrest was awaited. A police officer said Pradhan was among the accused in a murder case dating back to the Nandigram land agitation in 2007. There was a pending warrant against him, the officer said, adding that Pradhan will be produced in court Saturday.

Madan Mitra, MLA from Kamrhati who belongs to the TMC faction opposed to Baner-

jee, said, "If there is a pending case, the police and administration can arrest anyone. Mamata Banerjee should have supported our candidate, not the Congress. The Congress has no base there."

Earlier in the day, the Election Commission, which had frozen the TMC name and symbol Thursday, allotted separate names and symbols to the factions led by Banerjee and Arup Roy.

The Banerjee faction will now be called 'Mamata All India Trinamool Congress' with a 'football player' as its symbol. The rebel faction will be called the 'Democratic Trinamool Congress', and its symbol will be an 'envelope'.

Hitting out at the EC and

BJP, Banerjee said, "First, our bank account was frozen. Now, they have frozen my party's symbol and name. Earlier, they did this with Uddhav Thackeray. And now, us. It is a black day for democracy. What happened is illegal and against the Constitution. But we will fight it out. Rahul Gandhi called me last night. Arvind Kejriwal stood with us along with many other leaders. Our INDIA alliance stands together. We will together fight the BJP."

She said she would fight and win back her party's name and symbol, and would back the Congress candidate in the Nandigram bypoll. The announcement came after her faction's candidate, Sanchita Pradhan Dey, withdrew her nomination.

Asked why Dey withdrew her nomination, Banerjee said, "She was threatened. Earlier, she sent us a message that she wanted to contest, and we nominated her. But we have decided to support the Congress."

Targeting the BJP, she said, "They are not letting us hold rallies. Over 14,000 of our workers have been arrested by police who are working on BJP's behalf in Bengal. I am virtually under house arrest. But we will fight against all this. We will not surrender and we will bounce back."

While Nandigram and Rajnagar will go to polls on October 6, elections to the Kolkata Municipal Corporation and Howrah Municipal Corporation will be held after Durga Puja.

IIT-B

"Earlier in the day, during an examination, the student was found using a mobile phone in the exam hall. He had uploaded the examination question paper on ChatGPT to seek answers. No disciplinary action was initiated against the student. The matter was also discussed with the student by the instructor and the Head of the Department, who counselled him and assured him that the incident would not adversely affect his academic career. The student subsequently returned to his hostel room. Later in the evening, he was found dead in his room," the statement said.

A police officer of the Powai police station said, "The exam was until 4 pm and after that the student went to his hostel room. He died by suicide. He was found hanging in the room."

The body was sent to Rajawadi Hospital for a post-mortem examination. The student was a resident of Hostel 4.

As word spread on campus, students gathered near the main building of the institute and raised slogans against the administration. The protest continued until the Director of IIT-B, Prof Shireesh Kedare, came to meet the students around 10.30 pm. Following the meeting, the gathering was shifted to the convocation hall, located opposite the main building.

According to students at the protest, the ongoing mid-semester examination was postponed in view of the incident. "Students have always had one complaint with the administration that it continues functioning as it is, even after a serious incident like suicide. Tonight, many questioned this behaviour, following which it was declared that the mid-semester exam is now postponed," a student said.

The statement issued by the administration said, "The circumstances surrounding the death are being looked into by the appropriate authorities."

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Asiads

"It's slow madness at the start," Wright says. "By the end, it's damn crazy."
Around 17,000 athletes and officials from 45 countries are taking part in the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games. Wright and his team have 80 chefs from 25 countries working in the kitchen, with around 200 staff involved in the operation. The menu changes four times a day: Breakfast, lunch, dinner and supper, with the first food going out at 5am.
The scale is enormous, but the philosophy is simple: Make a 17-year-old athlete feel at home. "I'm a young athlete, pretend. It's my first trip overseas," says Wright. "I'm going to Japan... But when I get here, all that I've eaten in the past is things from my village or my community or what my coach tells me to eat, what my mother cooks for me. So I'm looking for something to be familiar with."
That means the Japanese setting does not translate into a dining hall dominated by sushi and sashimi. There are Chinese, Korean, Thai, Malaysian, Middle Eastern and Indian offerings, including rogan josh, dal, curries, chutneys, naan and biryani. The vastness of the Asian Games

means there are also different religious sensitivities to negotiate.
Even soy sauce is not quite as simple as it sounds.
"The Korean chef wants Korean soy sauce, the Japanese chef Japanese soy sauce and the Chinese chef Chinese soy sauce," says Wright, who has spent more than 40 years in hospitality and worked on catering at the Sydney, Beijing and Rio Olympics, the Vancouver Winter Olympics and two Commonwealth Games. "You can't put one soy sauce and go, right, you all have to use it. The chefs will fight you."
The same goes for biryani. Wright learnt that lesson in 1992, when Pakistan played England in the World Cup final at the Melbourne Cricket Ground. The Pakistan team manager asked for biryani as a match-day meal. "He asked me, 'Do you know what it is?' I replied, 'Yeah, yeah, I know what it is, no problem'. Because I'm a young chef with a big ego. I never heard of biryani in my life."
There was no internet to rescue him, so Wright turned to an Indian member of his kitchen staff, whose mother came to the MCG and taught the chefs how to make the dish.
Later, Wright asked the manager how it was. "He said, 'Oh, it was okay. It wasn't Pakistani biryani, it was Indian bi-

ryani'. I went, 'What are you talking about? It's the same thing'. And he said, 'no, it's not'.
It was an important lesson. "I didn't know there was a difference, but I learned something — authenticity," Wright says.
That obsession with authenticity now sits alongside an equally important concern: Control.
The athletes can choose from roughly 110-120 items in each meal period. Much of the food is kept as individual ingredients rather than being combined in advance. The salad bar, for instance, can have 40 or 50 components — tomatoes, corn, chillies, carrots, cucumbers, kimchi — allowing athletes to build their own plates.
For someone counting every calorie, the difference matters. Grilled chicken can come without the sauce; rice can be portioned precisely; nuts provide another source of nutrients.
"The elite athlete, you're the favourite for the gold medal, you will eat anything. You know what you want to eat," Wright says. "They're looking for macronutrients. They're looking for allergens."
Others arrive at the dining hall with a different strategy. Wright has watched newly arrived athletes pull out their cameras, film the buffet and fill their plates as though they have never

seen food before. "That only lasts for one or two days," he says. "And then they get into athlete mode, and then it comes back down to basic food."
Basic, perhaps. Small, certainly not.
Chicken is the biggest protein source, at roughly two tonnes a day, with around 800 kg each of beef and fish. Rice approaches a tonne on a peak day. Bananas are consumed at a rate of about 60,000 a day across the venues. Bread — sliced bread, rolls, flatbreads, naan and tortillas — adds up to roughly 35,000 pieces. Fruit is among the biggest overall categories, with athletes consuming seven or eight pieces each a day.
The sourcing is another operation altogether. Suppliers need certification, there are backup sources for key products and purchases are made several days in advance so that quality can be checked before food reaches the athletes.
"We can't use a supplier that doesn't have proper certification because if you have food poisoning in the village, could you imagine?" Wright says. "I would be running for the hills."
The local flavour comes through the supply chain as much as the menu. Wright's chefs, for instance, visited Nagoya's miso producers and countryside restaurants, speak-

ing to local cooks about rice, herbs, ginger and garlic before working with suppliers to bring those ingredients into the Games kitchen. Japanese rice is even purchased pre-rinsed, a small detail that becomes significant when you are cooking nearly a tonne of it.
Then there are the details that can be invisible to diners but matter enormously to the kitchen. At one point, the team discovered that pastry brushes were made with raccoon hair. "It's soft hair, but raccoons are carnivorous animals, not halal. If you brush the pie with a raccoon brush, it's not halal anymore. So, we have to chuck all the brushes out and buy synthetic ones," Wright says.
After all that precision, there is still one problem: Nobody wants to eat the same thing 21 times in a week. So, the kitchen introduces what Wright calls "surprise and delight" — a live burger station, shawarmas, grilled prawns, pasta or ice cream.
And when competition is over, the rules change again. Athletes who have spent years training for these Games, Wright says, often make a beeline for the things they had been avoiding. "Not really Olympic food," he says. "But when you finish competing, you just eat... cakes, cheeses and far too much food."

As students vote in DUSU polls, social media and Satya Niketan tragedy dominate conversation

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, September 18

THE ROAD outside Durgabai Deshmukh South Campus Metro Station was covered in colourful voting slips by Friday morning, as students streamed past to cast their votes in the Delhi University Students’ Union (DUSU) elections.

Just 12 days earlier, student groups had gathered at the same spot to protest after a PG hostel building in nearby Satya Niketan collapsed, killing seven persons, including five DU students. On polling day—which saw a turnout of 40.46%—the tragedy remained part of the conversation, but so did Instagram reels, freebies and campus-specific issues. For some students, repeated visibility was a campaign strategy in itself.

Familiar names

At Miranda House in North Campus, first-year English Honours student Shaily sat with her batchmates scrolling through social media posts. “Many of my friends decided to vote because they saw a particular candidate on Instagram,” she said.

Maintaining that representation was a concern, Shaily said, “Women’s representation is lacking, but students usually don’t talk about it. They have been saying, ‘I will vote for him because I have seen his name a lot’.” “Campaigning has remained largely male-dominated with major parties fielding male candidates for the President and Vice-President posts,” she added.

But online visibility— which also came in the form of movie tickets, dinners and hampers containing make-up kits and chocolates— did not work the same way for everyone. Kirti, a first-year law student at Law Centre II, was waiting to vote in the evening. “We saw that when the building collapsed in Satya Niketan, all parties shared reels and were very active, but the genuineness, since it was online, was questionable,” she said.

At Sri Venkateswara College, long queues had formed by noon, stretching towards the Metro station.

Anmol, an NSUI worker whose friend Neeraj Bawa was seriously injured in the Satya Niketan collapse, said indepen-



(Top) Voting underway at Miranda House; students enter Ramjas College on Friday to cast their vote. PRAVEEN KHANNA

dent candidates had made the contest more closely fought.

“Had it been only NSUI and ABVP, the chances would have been better,” he said, pointing to the possibility of votes moving to independent candidate Deepanshu Shokeen, who was denied a party ticket.

Tight security, long queues

In North Campus, security was tightened from 8.30 am, with heavy barricades put up along routes leading to the Arts Faculty to restrict the entry of outsiders. Party supporters were barred from entering the campus, though SUVs and groups of supporters of key NSUI and ABVP candidates were visible in the morning.

Vrinda Singh, a second-year law student at Campus Law Centre, said candidates were largely focusing on infrastructure concerns rather than student housing. “Student housing wasn’t discussed predominantly here... Candidates were mainly addressing infrastructure-related issues... maybe because the issues affecting us here are different from South Campus,” she said.

At Sri Venkateswara College, long queues had formed by noon, stretching towards the Metro station.

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dent candidates had made the contest more closely fought.

“Had it been only NSUI and ABVP, the chances would have been better,” he said, pointing to the possibility of votes moving to independent candidate Deepanshu Shokeen, who was denied a party ticket.

Polling day logistics

College authorities said elaborate arrangements were made to manage the voting.

Sri Venkateswara College Principal Prof Vajala Ravi said, “All 215 teaching staff, 150 non-teaching staff and around 50-60 contractual staff, including security personnel, had been deployed for election duty.”

Vice Principal Prof Nandita Narayanasamy said the college, which has 79 students with disabilities, had set up booths on the ground floor for them.

At Ramjas College, 2,578 of 5,973 students had voted in both the college and DUSU elections, Principal Ajay Arora said. “A turnout of around 43% was recorded,” he added.

Miranda House recorded 32% turnout, with students voting in both DUSU and college elections. The college also set up two ‘Walls of Democracy’ where student organisations and can-

HC bars victory processions, slams violations

New Delhi: Objecting to the campaign that included brandishing weapons, luxury car cavalcades, and the alleged assault of a teacher, the Delhi High Court Friday barred DUSU poll candidates from holding victory processions after the results are declared on Saturday evening. A division bench of Chief Justice D K Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia issued notices to 140 student candidates, saying they had engaged in conduct that violated the Lyngdoh Committee recommendations, the Model Code of Conduct and court orders.

didates put up posters and banners.

EVMS take centre stage

Around 960 EVMs were deployed this year, with 40 kept in reserve in case of technical glitches, Chief Electoral Officer Prof Raj Kishore Sharma said.

This was the first time EVMs were used in almost all DU colleges, barring a few where technical issues prevented their deployment. Earlier, most colleges used ballot papers for their college-level student union elections. The turnout for DUSU polls this year, at 40.46%, is higher than the last two years— 35.2% in 2024 and 39.36% in 2025. But the figure is lower than 2023 turnout of 42%.

While counting for DUSU polls will take place on Saturday, by late Friday afternoon, the mood had already shifted in some campuses, with celebrations breaking out as college-level results were announced. At Bhaskaracharya College, the SFI nominee won the presidential post.

DTC buses off the roads for fourth day, Metro ridership reaches record 82 lakh

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 18

THE DELHI Metro recorded its highest-ever single-day ridership of 82.44 lakh passenger boardings on Thursday as the strike by Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) bus drivers entered the fourth day.

The Delhi Metro has an average daily ridership of around 64 lakh passengers. At 80.97 lakh passenger journeys, last year’s highest ridership was recorded on August 11. On Wednesday, the second day of the strike, the Metro saw the next highest ridership at 80.71 lakh.

While the participation of drivers in the strike was limited on Tuesday, more than 80% of the public bus system has been halted in the city in the days since, according to the DTC Karamchari Ekta Union, the workers’ body which is supporting the strike. It estimates that more than 10,000 drivers have

• Rise in Metro ridership this week

DATE	BOARDINGS
Sept 14	72.73 lakh
Sept 15	76.86 lakh
Sept 16	80.71 lakh
Sept 17	82.44 lakh

The Delhi Metro has an average daily ridership of around **64 lakh**

SOURCE: DELHI METRO



been participating in the strike.

DTC has 6,840 buses, and witnesses an average daily ridership of around 40 lakh on normal days. In light of the ongoing DTC strike, Metro stations have been witnessing heavy crowds over the past couple of days.

Ridership on Monday stood at 72.73 lakh passenger board-

ings. By Tuesday, passenger boardings rose to 76.86 lakh. It climbed even further on Wednesday to 80.71 lakh, before hitting a record 82.44 lakh on Thursday. A passenger journey however, is not the number of people who ride the Metro on a given day. It is the number of Metro lines used by a passenger to complete his or her journey.

For instance, if a passenger changes a line once to reach his destination, it will be calculated as two journeys, and if she changes their line twice, it will be calculated as three journeys. Delhi Metro used to calculate passenger ridership until 2018, but it started reporting passenger journeys from 2019.

Officials said the network’s previous highest ridership had been 81.88 lakh boardings recorded on August 8, 2025, which was the eve of Rakshabandhan. The next highest figure of 81.01 lakh was achieved on August 27 of this year, which was again the Rakshabandhan eve.

Meanwhile, the protesting drivers are seeking better service conditions, including a minimum daily wage of Rs 2,000, an annual bonus, payment for working on government holidays, and medical insurance, among other demands.

Old vehicles, industry, dust in focus, Noida & Ghaziabad set to see tighter pollution curbs

Express News Service
Lucknow, September 18

ACTION AGAINST old vehicles, more electric buses, tighter industrial emission monitoring and mechanised cleaning to control dust are among the measures being planned for Noida and Ghaziabad as the Centre and Uttar Pradesh government step up efforts to tackle air pollution.

The measures were discussed at a meeting between union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav and UP Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath in Lucknow on Friday.

The review covered UP’s eight districts that come under National Capital Region (NCR), including Noida, Ghaziabad, Hapur, Meerut and Bulandshahr.

According to a statement, the meeting also discussed the

implementation of a new electric vehicle policy, deployment of electric buses, making pollution under control certificates mandatory and regulating vehicles operated by aggregators.

The meeting is part of a wider effort to coordinate pollution control measures across NCR.

While Yadav has already met Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and her Haryana counterpart Nayab Singh Saini, meetings with the Chief Ministers of Rajasthan and Punjab are planned, the statement said.

The Centre is separately coordinating with agriculture departments of various states on stubble management, it added. Yadav said more than 30 meetings had been held since last December on measures to control air pollution in NCR. Noida, Ghaziabad pollution.

• Skywatch


Forecast: September 19, 2026
Partly cloudy sky
MAX: 34-36
1.6°C below normal
MIN: 22-24
0.9°C above normal

● Good (0-50) ● Satisfactory (51-100) ● Moderate (101-200) ● Very Poor (301-400) ● Severe (401-500)

• AQI Tracker

 Narela Satisfactory AQI: 77	 Anand Vihar Satisfactory AQI: 95
 Sirifort Moderate AQI: 102	 Bawana Satisfactory AQI: 70

INDIA'S LARGEST CONTAINER PORT		
JAWAHARLAL NEHRU PORT AUTHORITY (TRAFFIC DEPARTMENT)		
ISO 9001:2015, ISO 14001:2015, ISO 27001:2022, ISO 45001:2018 CERTIFIED		
Applications are invited from eligible Indian Nationals for the following engagement purely on contract basis in Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority:		
Sr. No.	Name of Post	No. of Post
(i)	Legal Expert	1
For details regarding consolidated remuneration, educational qualification, age, experience and last date of receiving applications etc. visit our website www.inport.gov.in (Careers) and submit applications in the prescribed format by downloading the same from our website.		
Chief General Manager (Traffic)		



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(Affiliated to Guru Gobind Singh Indraprastha University, Recognised by Bar Council of India & AICTE)
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FILLING UP OF VACANT SEATS FOR THE ACADEMIC SESSION 2026–27

In accordance with the Order dated 14.09.2026 issued by the Directorate of Higher Education, Government of NCT of Delhi, applications are invited online through a Institute portal from eligible candidates for admission against available vacant seats in various programmes, subject to the sanctioned intake.

Admissions shall be made strictly on merit based on the National Level Test/CET/CUET, as applicable, from qualified candidates who were unable to secure admission during the counselling conducted by GGSIP University. Vacant seats will be notified on the website of the institute on 19.09.2026

Last Date for Submission of Online Application form through a Institute Portal is 23.09.2026 up to 11:00 AM.

Merit list along with First round of schedule of counselling will be displayed on 24.09.2026 at 11:00 AM.

FIRST ROUND OF COUNSELLING

The First Round of Counselling will be conducted on 25.09.2026 at 11:00 AM in the institute, for eligible candidates who have already registered with GGSIP University but have not secured admission during the University counselling process so far.

Seats remain vacant if any after first round of counselling will be notified on the website of the institute on 26.09.2026 at 11:00 AM

SUBSEQUENT ROUND OF COUNSELLING

Will be conducted to fill a vacant seats, if any, after inviting fresh applications online from 26.09.2026 to 28.09.2026. During second counselling candidate who didn't registered with GGSIP University can also apply. Merit list for conduct of second round of counselling will be displayed on 29.09.2026 at 11:00 AM and counselling will be held on 30.09.2026 at 11:00 AM in the institute.

Admissions will be confirmed on payment of prescribed fee after allotment of seat.

Candidates are advised to visit the Institute website regularly for further updates.



AU-Block, Outer Ring Road, Pitampura, Delhi-110034
Phone: + 91 (11) 27343401/02/03; E-mail: vipsedu@vips.edu.



VICTORIA MEMORIAL HALL
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APPLICATION INVITED FOR THE POST OF SECRETARY & CURATOR

Advertisement No. 01/2026

Victoria Memorial Hall, Kolkata, an autonomous organisation under the Ministry of Culture, Government of India, invites applications from the eligible candidates to fill up the post of Secretary & Curator in the Pay Matrix of Level -13 (**Rs.1,23,100-2,15,900/-**) by Direct Recruitment failing which by Deputation or transfer. The tenure to the post shall be for a maximum period of 05 (five) years or till attaining the age of superannuation, whichever is earlier, vide DoPT **Office Memorandum No.AB-14017/12/2022-Estt.(RR) dated 24.06.2022**. The post carries usual allowances as admissible to Central Government employees. For details, please visit to our website www.victoriameorial-cal.org Applications along with the required documents and credentials in the prescribed format should reach the **Secretary to the Hon'ble Governor, Lok Bhavan, Kolkata– 700062** latest by **26.10.2026 at 5:00 pm**.

GOVERNMENT OF NCT OF DELHI
DEPARTMENT OF TRAINING & TECHNICAL EDUCATION MUNI MAYA RAM MARG, PITAMPURA, DELHI-110034
Website: <https://tte.delhi.gov.in>, Email:pmsetu.gnctd@gmail.com, Ph:011-20817224



NOTICE FOR INVITING REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)

Request for Proposals (RFPs) are invited from reputed, credible and experienced Industry Partners/Industry Associations/Consortia/Industry-led Foundations/ Academic Institutions promoted or operated by Industry for participation in the Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation Through Upgraded ITIs (PM-SETU) scheme.

The scheme is a centrally sponsored initiative aimed at transforming Government Industrial Training Institutes (ITIs) into modern, industry-aligned Centres of Excellence.

The GNCT of Delhi intends to engage Anchor Industry Partner(s) for establishing and managing selected Government ITIs clusters in Delhi on a Hub-and-Spoke model to ensure outcome-based training and enhanced employability of youth.

Detailed guidelines of the PM-SETU scheme are available on the Departmental website: <https://tte.delhi.gov.in>

The Request for Proposals (RFPs) document can be downloaded from the e-Tendering Portal: <https://govtprocurement.delhi.gov.in> and also on departmental website from.

Last date of submission of RFP is **30.10.2026**.

Sd/-

Director

Directorate of Training & Technical Education

Government of NCT of Delhi

DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0220/26-27

epaper.indianexpress.com

EX-COLLEAGUE, HER PARTNER ARRESTED FOR MURDER OF DELHI RESIDENT

He was dead, but texts kept coming from his phone, family tells police

Pragynesh
New Delhi, September 18

ON THE evening of September 7, Sahil texted his childhood friend, Yuvraj Singh Manchanda. A resident of Sarita Vihar, Yuvraj (31), who worked as a manager at Adani Realty, was getting married next month and his bachelor's party was yet to be planned. "His elder sister said he had left for Gurugram on Sunday evening to attend an important meeting and never came home," said Sahil. He sent a few more messages before finally calling Yuvraj at 4 am on September 8. "The call was disconnected. I then got a text from his number saying that he would call later. I asked him where he was and why he wasn't replying,

but there was no response," he added.

Yuvraj, police said, had been dead since the night of September 6. The person on the other side of the messages was allegedly his murderer — Anya Vats, a former colleague, and her partner, Sanyam Sachdeva, they added.

The accused allegedly shot Yuvraj inside their car near a mall in Gurgaon's Sector 70.

Yuvraj had gone to meet Anya on September 6. "He left in his MG Astros car, and reached the location. There he got out and went inside Anya's white Hyundai Creta," said an officer. Police allege that Anya and Sanyam killed him and kept his body in the SUV for two days.

On September 8, they allegedly drove around Gurugram before dumping the body in a drain in



Victim Yuvraj Singh Manchanda

Badshahpur. They then fled to Uttarakhand and stayed at a PG near Kainchi Dham.

The Gurugram Police recovered the body on September 10.

"Anya and Sanyam were later arrested from Kainchi Dham after their vehicle was

traced. A gun has been recovered from them along with Yuvraj's car and phone," the officer added.

Yuvraj's family has alleged that while Anya was looking to dispose of his body, she continued talking to his friends, sisters and fiancée using his phone. Standing outside the Lajpat Nagar police station on Friday, Yuvraj's sister Karishma said they were having lunch at the Golden Dragon restaurant in Lajpat Nagar, K Block, when he rushed off.

"We were shopping for his wedding. Then he got a call and left abruptly, saying he had a meeting in Gurugram and would return home by 10 pm. After that, I didn't hear from him," said Karishma, a doctor based in Faridabad.

Police, meanwhile, ana-

lysed Yuvraj's call records and found that the last call he received before leaving the restaurant was from Anya.

Karishma said her brother didn't come home but she received a text from him. "He said he was fine and that he was in an important meeting. The next day, I got another text... he repeated that he was fine and that he might have to go to Bengaluru," she said.

Worried, the family started calling him, but the calls were repeatedly disconnected.

"He even sent a ticket to Bengaluru to his sister. But after September 8, his phone was switched off," said Sahil.

On September 16, Delhi Police learnt that an unidentified body had been found inside a drain in Gurugram's Sector 70 six days earlier.

AIIMS study ties metabolic health to accumulation of fat around kidneys

Tabshir Shams
New Delhi, September 18

A STUDY by researchers at AIIMS has found that among people with obesity and an unhealthy metabolic profile, a significant proportion also have excess fat accumulation around the kidneys — a finding that could be associated with an increased risk of kidney and cardiovascular complications.

More significantly, the study highlights that certain biomarkers detectable in blood or urine may identify early kidney injury before it is detectable through conventional kidney-function tests or imaging.

The findings are part of ongoing ICMR-supported research involving 44 obese patients admitted to AIIMS. Researchers found that 77 per cent of those classified as metabolically unhealthy had excess renal sinus fat, compared with 55 per cent of those who were metabolically healthy. Metabolic health is assessed through measures such as blood sugar and blood pressure.

Metabolic health and kidney fat

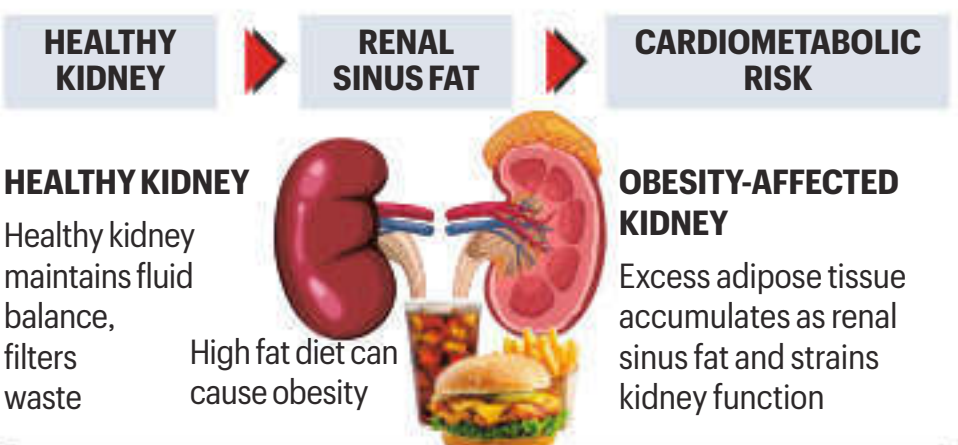
"Patients with poorer metabolic health were found to have substantially higher levels of fat around the kidneys," said Dr Amandeep Singh, an assistant professor of medicine at AIIMS Delhi and the study's lead researcher.

The researchers said these findings show that metabolic health may matter as much as, or perhaps more than, body weight alone when it comes to the accumulation of fat around the kidneys.

"Kidney fat was lowest in metabolically healthy non-obese participants," said Dr Singh. "How obese you are may matter less than how metabolically unwell you are. Two patients can have the same BMI, but the one with abnormal blood sugar or blood pressure may carry far more fat around the kidney than the

EXPRESS special

How obesity affects kidneys



one without."

Dr Singh said the kidney's response to fat accumulation unfolds gradually.

In the early stages, as fat builds up around the kidney, the glomerular filtration rate — a measure of how much blood the kidneys filter each minute — may actually increase.

Over time, he said, this process can progress to an "obese kidney," potentially marking a more advanced stage of kidney stress.

NGAL could offer an early warning signal

The challenge, researchers said, is that conventional blood tests may not reveal this damage until kidney function has already begun to deteriorate.

Dr N K Vikram, professor of medicine at AIIMS and a co-investigator in the study, said standard measures of kidney function can underestimate the extent of kidney impairment in people who are overweight or obese. "Conventional blood tests often fail to accurately reflect true renal function in individuals living with overweight or obesity," he said.

This is where newer biomarkers such as serum NGAL may have a role. NGAL, a protein associated with kidney injury and inflammation, was substantially higher among adults with greater degrees of obesity in the study.

The finding raises the possibility that NGAL could identify obesity-related kidney stress at an earlier stage.

But the researchers caution that the biomarker is not yet ready for routine screening. "These findings suggest that NGAL could help identify obesity-related renal stress earlier, but larger longitudinal studies are needed before it can be recommended as a routine screening test," Dr Vikram said.

Dr Singh said another peer-reviewed study by his team at AIIMS, which looked at obese adults who did not have diabetes, found a similar link between higher BMI and higher levels of NGAL. This suggests that obesity itself may put stress on the kidneys, even in people who do not have diabetes or other metabolic problems. "At the same time, metabolic problems such as high blood sugar and blood pressure may add to that damage," Dr Singh said.

The close link between obesity and metabolic problems was also seen in the current study. About 30 to 40 per cent of the patients had both obesity and Type 2 diabetes with insulin resistance.

Dr Singh said that as body weight increases, the amount of fat and tissue around the kidneys may also increase.

This, he said, means doctors may need to look beyond a patient's weight or BMI and also consider how healthy their metabolism is.

"We need to start asking not just how obese a patient is, but how metabolically unwell they are," he said. "That may matter more for the kidney."

Aerocity waterlogging: HC raps NHA, DIAL for 'callous' attitude

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, September 18

THE DELHI High Court on Friday pulled up the National Highways Authority of India (NHA) and the Delhi International Airport Ltd (DIAL), which operates the Indira Gandhi International Airport, for its "callous" attitude in not resolving the waterlogging issues in the upscale Aerocity area. The court has warned of "stringent" action if the agencies fail to resolve the issue.

A division bench of Justices Prathiba Singh and Manmeet Pritam Singh Arora was hearing a petition by a civil rights group, Social Jurist, seeking that a functional storm water drainage system be constructed along the National Highway-48 stretch between Mahipalpur and Rangpuri village.

"The development in the Aerocity area and the national

highway, which has led to this situation of waterlogging in Mahipalpur area, ought to have evoked a serious response from the agencies," the High Court observed.

Even as a joint stakeholders' meeting held earlier following the court orders in this regard was attended by representatives from NHA, Delhi Metro Rail Corporation, Municipal Corporation of Delhi, Delhi Development Authority, PWD, and the Delhi Jal Board, the High Court on Friday noted that "no responsibility has been fixed as to which job is to be undertaken by which agency."

"They have to do it for the people there. The cars have been submerged. (If you) don't resolve it, we will not hesitate (to stop construction). If you don't sort it out, there will be stringent action," the High Court further warned, adding, "If they do not take steps and come forward to

the court, we will stop construction. Be clear about it. If they want to shirk it, then we will stop construction in Aerocity. We will not hesitate."

"The callous approach of the NHA is not appreciated as much as there is no official present before the Court and neither is the counsel prepared to make any substantial submission," the HC underlined.

Directing the Delhi Chief Secretary to hold further meetings, as well as fix responsibilities on each agency concerned, the HC said, "The regular waterlogging in Mahipalpur area as also the traffic congestion in the said area needs to be resolved by the NHA and Delhi International Airport Limited on a speedy basis with proper proposal, failing which the court will be constrained to pass some stringent directions."

The court will hear the matter next on October 30.

Gurugram Police missed alert that could have identified Sarita Vihar man, cremated body

Not mandated in such cases, says Gurugram Police

Sakshi Chand & Alok Singh
New Delhi, September 18

A MISSING person report filed in Delhi. An unidentified body recovered in Gurugram. A photograph uploaded on an interstate police database. A Hue and Cry Notice circulated within the Gurugram Police as per procedure. Yet, Sarita Vihar resident Yuvraj Singh Manchanda (31), who was murdered on September 6 and thrown into a drain, remained unidentified and was cremated before his family could claim his body.

The sequence has raised questions over whether Gurugram Police checked Zonal Integrated Police Network (ZIPNET) — the police database meant to help match missing persons with unidentified bodies — after the body was recovered on September 10, and whether the Hue and Cry Notice, circulated to help locate a missing person, was shared with neighbouring police forces as well as per norms. (*See box*)

Further, according to Delhi Police, there is a discrepancy



Yuvraj Singh Manchanda's sister Karishma on Friday. EXPRESS

PROCEDURAL OVERSIGHT IN FOCUS

WHAT IS ZIPNET?

- **Interstate police database covering 8 states and UTs** — Delhi, Haryana, Rajasthan,

Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, Uttarakhand, Chandigarh and Himachal Pradesh

- **Carries details** of missing persons and unidentified bodies, facilitates sharing of data related to crimes, criminals, and stolen property

WHAT IS A HUE AND CRY NOTICE?

- **Police notice** circulated to help locate a missing person
- **Main purpose** is to seek assistance from police units and the public in locating the missing person

- **It can carry** the person's photograph and name; age and physical description; clothes and identifying marks and last known location among others

over the cause of death. While the postmortem examination

records the cause as asphyxiation due to drowning, Delhi

Police has said that Yuvraj was shot dead.

Yuvraj, an Adani Realty employee, had been missing since

September 6. His family approached Lajpat Nagar police station on September 11. Delhi Police said his details, including a clear photograph, were uploaded on ZIPNET the next day.

Two days earlier, on September 10, Gurugram Police had recovered a decomposed body from a drain in Badshahpur. It was cremated on September 14 — two days after the alert was issued on ZIPNET.

DCP (South Gurugram) Hitesh Yadav told The Indian Express that police received information about the body on the night of September 10. "Soon after, a mobile forensic science unit and local police reached the spot... The body had decomposed and was beyond recognition," he added.

Videography of the recovery of the body was carried out and a Hue and Cry Notice was circulated among police personnel as per procedure, the DCP said, adding that the body was kept at a mortuary for three days, as per norms.

"After no one claimed the body within 72 hours — the mandatory period — the post-mortem was conducted. Details of the unidentified body were uploaded on CCTNS (Crime and Criminal Tracking Network and Systems) on September 14. The body was cremated the same day," he added.

said, was filed by Sanyam's first wife, who accused him and Anya of domestic violence.

The case was registered at Shahdara police station. Sanyam's divorce from his first wife is still pending, the officer added.

"Yuvraj and Anya used to work together. She was accused of financial mismanagement at the company and started working as a freelance real estate agent. Sanyam also joined another company," said a senior officer.

Police said that as per Yuvraj's family, Anya had taken

some money from him while they worked together, though the issue was later resolved.

"We are probing whether the two had any business-related disputes... Initial interrogation has shown that Anya had some professional issues over some real estate-related deals," said the senior officer.

Police said they are also examining Anya's bank accounts.

"The accounts showed multiple high-value transactions but did not have much liquid cash," the senior police officer said.



Anya Vats, the accused. EXPRESS

istered against her in Greater Noida, police said.

The third case, an officer

Cheating cases, domestic violence complaint and business dispute: What police found about accused

Pragynesh
New Delhi, September 18

CHEATING PEOPLE by posing as a government official, allegations of domestic violence against her partner's first wife, accounts showing high value transactions but not having enough liquidity, and a supposed business rivalry have emerged in the investigation into Anya Vats, accused of killing Sarita Vihar resident Yuvraj Singh Manchanda in Gurugram.

According to senior Delhi Police officers, Anya, her

partner Sanyam and Yuvraj had earlier worked at Emaar. In 2022, Anya was allegedly fired over financial mismanagement. Yuvraj later left the company to join another one, before moving to Adani Realty as a manager.

According to the police, three cases against Anya came up during a background check.

In one, she allegedly posed as a government official and cheated people. A complaint by Punjab National Bank led to a case being registered at Parliament Street police station. Another cheating case was reg-



The mangled car; Delhi University student Vedant Khanna. EXPRESS

samples of the accused are still awaited to confirm if he was intoxicated.

Officers said the impact

flung the workers across the asphalt, hit an idling utility pickup truck — showing it forward by nearly 100 metres —



and mounted the central divider before coming to a halt.

Bijender and Pappu Singh were declared brought dead at

the Civil Hospital. Satish Chand died of the severe injuries shortly after. Ram Kumar is currently on ventilator support in the ICU of a private hospital.

Satish Chand, villagers recall, had moved to Delhi nearly eight years ago. He is survived by his wife and four children.

"Satish broke his back in the early years of his life for one reason: he refused to let his children grow up without education," said his childhood friend Chaman Lal.

"He had carved out a stable income, but with him gone, that cushion disappears. His wife, Dolly Devi, has no independent income. The fear now is that once whatever little

money he left behind runs out, the family will be forced to head back to the village, and pull the children out of their schools."

It was Satish Chand who helped Pappu get a job. With his two sons, aged 24 and 28, managing marginal agricultural plots back home, Pappu had taken up labour work to build a wedding fund for his 18-year-old daughter. "Pappu kept telling us that the moment he found a suitable match and married his daughter off, he would bring his sons here so Satish could teach them work," Gautam said. "He wanted to bring his wife over too and set up a permanent base. That cannot happen now."



Solemn Welcome

A SINGLE saffron sash and around a dozen roses — one each from a party worker — greeted BJP national president Nitin Nabin when he landed in Punjab's Pathankot on Friday to launch an outreach against substance abuse. The welcome lacked the usual fanfare and presents — bouquets, garlands, shawls and artefacts — offered by party leaders to the BJP president during his visit to any State or Union Territory. The reason: Nabin was visiting Punjab to meet the grieving family members of those who lost their lives due to drug addiction. Nabin launched the BJP's 'Nasha Mukt Punjab Yatra', one of the BJP's most significant electoral initiatives in the poll-bound state, from Pathankot.

On the Move

WITH THE government set to vacate Krishi Bhawan, the ministries housed there are also preparing to leave the premises. It is learnt that the Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution has formed six teams to coordinate various tasks, including logistics, transport and seating arrangements at the new office. One of the teams has been asked to inspect the new premises, signage, electrical fittings and air-conditioning, while another team is assigned the duty to check seating arrangements for all the employees. A dedicated team has been formed to track the transfer and placement of official records and confidential files.

Nitish gave up CM's post on his own, BJP didn't ask him to do so: Samrat

Patna: Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary on Friday asserted that his predecessor Nitish Kumar, the JD(U) president, had given up the post of his own accord and was not elbowed out by the BJP.

Choudhary underscored that Kumar, now a Rajya Sabha MP, "remains the NDA's undisputed leader in Bihar." "Nitish Kumar stepped down of his own accord. We had not asked him to do so. Of course, he did acknowledge the fact that Atal Bihari Vajpayee had let him become the chief minister for the first time when BJP had more MLAs than his party and that he now wanted to reciprocate the gesture," Choudhary said. PTI

To curb farm fires, Govt readies stiff 'red entry' rules in revenue records

Adverse entry will make it difficult for farmers to avail loans & mortgages

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, September 18

STEPPING UP its efforts to tackle Delhi-NCR's winter air pollution, the Central government has decided to strengthen the "red entry" system to penalise farmers burning stubble. A red entry in the revenue records can potentially land farmers in trouble, making it difficult for them to avail loans and mortgages.

In its latest move to address choking air pollution in Delhi every winter, the Centre has brought a new draft of Rules governing the fight against crop residue burning, a key contributor to air pollution in the national capital. Under the draft Rules, land belonging to farmers found to burn stubble would be marked with a red entry in revenue records for up to 15 months. If they continue to set fields on fire or do not pay compensation, this period could extend for another 15 months.

These Rules, first notified in 2023, included the red entry provisions. The red entry system has faced strong opposition from farm unions. The Centre's changes are unlikely to take effect until the end of the upcoming paddy harvest season, owing to the window for seeking comments on the new draft.

This is the first time the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change has specified the validity of red entries under the draft Commission for Air Quality Management in National Capital Region and Adjoining Areas (Imposition, Collection and Utilization of Environmental Compensation for Stubble Burning) Rules, 2026. The Rules, brought in 2023, spell out the quantum of compensation for burning crop stubble, its collection, and utilisation.

Before they sow wheat between mid-September and early December, many farmers in Punjab, Haryana, Delhi and Uttar Pradesh set their fields on fire to burn stubble or crop residue. This is among the major causes of toxic air in Delhi-NCR, contributing up to 35% of the pollutants on some days.

The new draft, published on September 16, has not changed the land-holding-based compensation imposed, but has specified the validity of the red entry. The red entry, it says, shall be valid for 15 months from the date of the incident and will expire if no subsequent incident of stubble burning is found. It will also expire if any environmental compensation imposed has been deposited. However, if there are subsequent incidents of stubble burning on that land or if any compensation imposed is not paid, the validity of this red entry will extend for 15 months.

The draft Rules have also tweaked the section regarding utilisation of environmental compensation. According to the latest draft, the compensation



Stubble burning is among the key causes of toxic air in Delhi-NCR, contributing up to 35% of the pollutants on some days. FILE

will be utilised for measures to control stubble burning, ranging from crop diversification programmes to biomass utilisation to research and development in crop residue management and to subsidising residue management technologies. The Centre has provided a two-month window to invite objections and suggestions to the draft.

A source said the draft Rules add clarity to red entries made as a consequence of stubble burning. *The Indian Express* has sought comments from the Ministry on the rationale behind the red entry's 15-month validity and its repercussions, and a response is awaited.

The impact of red entries has varied across states where these Rules apply. In Punjab, farm unions have raised grievances related to loans, subsidies, and mortgaging of land. In Haryana, in certain districts like Kurukshetra, authorities have said that the red entry will be made on the 'Meri Fasal Mera Byora' portal for

farmers if they burn stubble. Such farmers will be banned on the portal for two years, depriving them of the benefits of all agricultural schemes.

Jagmohan Singh of the BКУ (Dakaunda) said they have always opposed these red entries and farmers should be provided financial assistance to manage paddy stubble. "The pollution issue cannot be solved with *jabardasti* (by force). These red entries do create some difficulties, but we have demonstrated and petitioned against them in the past and got them removed from the revenue records."

In a February 2025 report, the parliamentary standing committee on subordinate legislation, headed by Shiv Sena MP Milind Deora, recommended introducing an "incentive-based" red entry removal system, enabling early removal for farmers actively participating in sustainable farming practices or government-supported stubble management programmes.

Won't register any FIR against farmers: Mann

Express News Service
Ludhiana, September 18

PUNJAB CHIEF Minister Bhagwant Mann on Friday said that the state government will not register any FIR against farmers.

Addressing farmers during Kisan Mela at the Punjab Agricultural University in Ludhiana, Mann said that the paddy harvesting season was about to commence and once again Punjab farmers would be blamed and defamed for "spreading air pollution" by burning stubble — from New Delhi to Lahore.

"I told the Centre that first you boast that Punjab is the highest contributor of the paddy — 180 lakh metric tonne — to the central pool, but then you don't see how much stubble this much paddy produces... I told the Centre that the only solution to stubble is cash incentives for farmers, maybe around Rs 1,500 per acre..." he said, adding that "parcha (registering FIRs) or satellite surveillance won't work".

"*Parcha purcha karan da dil ni karda yaar... aiyen kiven parcha kar daange... par lodhi na pave oss hisaab naal kar leyo...* (We have no such intention to register FIRs against farmers, so please manage your stubble accordingly so that we do not reach such a situation," Mann said, while urging farmers not to burn stubble in the coming paddy season.

Year after Ladakh stir, Wangchuk to lead Leh march on Sept 23

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, September 18

CLIMATE ACTIVIST Sonam Wangchuk will lead a 20-km march in Leh next week to mark the first anniversary of statehood protest.

On September 24 last year, four civilians died after protests turned violent in Leh city. Following the protests, Wangchuk, who was on a hunger strike during the incident, was booked under the National Security Act and lodged in Jodhpur prison for six months.

The march was earlier planned from Kargil and was set to culminate at Leh on September 24. However, weather considerations have prompted it to be truncated to a 20-km "symbolic" march. Announcing the plans for the padyatra on social media, Wangchuk said, "I had earlier spoken to you about the padyatra in support of the efforts for conservation of Ladakh's culture, environment and democracy. However, as it is getting colder (in Ladakh) and the warming up of the political climate, we will hold a symbolic 20 km march in Leh on the 23rd."

He underscored that September 24 will be marked as "*shaheed diwas*" in memory of civilians killed last year while seeking protection for Ladakh's environment and democracy. Ahead of the statehood protest anniversary, the Ladakh administration on Sunday announced compensation for the families of the four persons who died in the protest in Leh on September 24 last year —



Sonam Wangchuk will lead the 20-km march to mark the first anniversary of statehood protest in which four civilians were killed in police firing

fulfilling one of the demands of the two representative bodies of the UT.

The administration has also announced compensation for the people injured during the protests for statehood for Ladakh. Of the Rs 1.52 crore sanctioned for compensation, Rs 15 lakh each has been announced for the families of the four persons who died during the protests. It has announced Rs 3 lakh each for people with major injuries, and Rs 1 lakh each for protesters with minor injuries.

As many as 44 were injured during the protest for statehood and the Sixth Schedule for Ladakh, in Leh last September. The protests erupted after student and youth organisations had called for a shutdown in Ladakh after two elderly persons fainted while on a hunger strike during a fast that Wangchuk announced. A judicial inquiry was conducted, although its findings have yet to be made public.

TRINAMOL CONGRESS SYMBOL FREEZE

'Vote theft, party theft': Opp hits out at BJP, backs Mamata

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 18

THE CONGRESS hit out at the BJP on Friday over the arrest of its Nandigram bypoll candidate Milan Pradhan in a 19-year-old case, calling the move a "political revenge and murder of democracy".

Reacting sharply to the development, Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi wrote in a post on X: "The arrest of Congress candidate Milan Pradhan for the Nandigram by-election is no coincidence — it is political revenge, the murder of democracy. The BJP has no faith in fair elections — that's why it wants to cling to power sometimes through vote theft, sometimes through stealing governments, and sometimes through stealing parties... The Congress will neither fear nor bow down. We will fight — and we will win."

AICC general secretary (organisation) KC Venugopal said using a 19-year-old case to arrest Pradhan is an indication that the BJP would go to any lengths to "hijack" democracy. "Democracy is on ventilator in BJP's West Bengal. This is BJP's latest effort to ensure 'Opposition-Mukt Bharat', successfully converting our great Constitu-



Former West Bengal chief minister Mamata Banerjee during a press conference in South Kolkata's Kalighat on Friday. ANI

tional democracy into a Banana Republic," he said.

Earlier in the day, leaders of the INDIA alliance threw their weight behind former Bengal chief minister Mamata Banerjee after the EC directed the two TMC factions not to use the party name, All India Trinamool Congress, and its 'Jora Ghash Phul' (two flowers with grass) symbol in the October 6 bypolls.

"First Shiv Sena, then NCP, and now TMC. Every time, the same pattern — BJP and the EC join forces to split a party. Then its election symbol is snatched away," Gandhi said.

AAP national convener Arvind Kejriwal posted on X: "Modi ji's birthday gift to the country.

Will they win the poll this way?"

Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav said, "...I don't have anything else to say... I just want to ask whether the affidavits submitted by us to the EC were received?"

The BJP hit back at Gandhi, alleging that he did not appear to know that parties such as the TMC and the NCP emerged after breaking away from the Congress. BJP national spokesperson Sudhanshu Trivedi said that Gandhi's statement was a "peculiar example of his political ignorance" and of making a mockery of his own party's history, whereas the BJP and the Jana Sangh "have always struggled to uphold democratic values".

After weeks-long standoff, Punjab clears 8% DA hike for staff, pensioners

Kanchan Vasdev
Chandigarh, September 18

THE PUNJAB government on Friday announced an 8% hike in two instalments of dearness allowance (DA) from October, ending a weeks-long standoff with state employees.

The issue had been at the centre of the employees' agitation over the past few weeks, with employee and pensioner organisations demanding the release of pending DA instalments and arrears, along with other service-related demands.

The decision followed a meeting in Chandigarh between Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann and representatives of employee and pensioners' organisations.

Punjab minister Aman Arora said that the meeting was held in a "congenial environment", and Mann had a "good discussion" with the employee representatives. The two 4% instalments will take the DA for government employees and pensioners to 50%.

Arora said the decision to release the 8% DA would put an additional burden of Rs 248 crore every month on the state exchequer and require an additional Rs 1,750 crore over the remaining seven months of the current financial year.

Telangana HC disqualifies Cong MLA under anti-defection law

Sreenivas Janyala
Hyderabad, September 18

THE TELANGANA High Court on Friday disqualified Khairatabad MLA Danam Nagender under the anti-defection law, setting aside the Speaker's decision to let him continue after he defected to the Congress.

Nagender was elected on a Bharat Rashtra Samiti (BRS) ticket in the December 2023 Assembly elections but quit and joined the Congress. The HC ruling comes on the back of a petition filed by BJP floor leader Aleti Maheshwar Reddy and BRS Huzurabad MLA Padi Kaushik Reddy.

The petition challenged Telangana Assembly Speaker G Prasad Kumar's decision to strike down their request to disqualify Nagender.

A Bench comprising Chief Justice Aparesh Kumar Singh and Justice G Mohiuddin disqualified Nagender as MLA from the date of his election. The petition was filed after Nagender unsuccessfully contested the Lok Sabha poll in May 2024 as a Congress candidate from the Secunderabad Lok Sabha constituency while he was still an MLA.

On September 9, 2024, the Telangana HC had directed the Legislative Assembly Secretary



Khairatabad MLA Danam Nagender

to place the disqualification petitions of three MLAs who defected to the Congress before the Assembly and take action within the next four weeks.

Justice B Vijayen Reddy, who was hearing petitions filed against BRS MLAs Danam Nagender, Kadiam Srihari and Tellam Venkat Rao for defecting to the Congress, directed the Assembly secretary to place all three disqualification petitions before the Speaker to draw up schedules for personal hearings of the candidates under the anti-defection law.

The first petition was filed by BJP Nirmal MLA Aleti Maheshwar Reddy, urging the court to direct the Speaker of the Legislative Assembly to disqualify Danam Nagender, the MLA from Khairatabad who joined

the Congress from the BRS and contested in the Lok Sabha polls.

Maheshwar Reddy stated in his petition that he visited the Speaker's office on July 1, 2024, to submit his disqualification petition, but it was not accepted.

The second petition against Danam Nagender was filed by BRS Huzurabad MLA P Kaus-hik Reddy, while the third by BRS Quthbullapur MLA K P Vivekanand Goud sought the disqualification of Tellam Venkat Rao, the MLA from Bhadrachalam, and Kadiyam Srihari, the MLA from Station Ghanpur. The court clubbed all three petitions together.

Kadiyam Srihari won the December 2023 Assembly elections from the Station Ghanpur Assembly constituency as a BRS candidate but quit the BRS and joined the Congress with his daughter, Kadiyam Kavaya, within three months. Kavaya won from the Warangal Lok Sabha seat in the April 2024 elections.

Nagender won Khairatabad twice — in 2018 and in 2023 — but defected to the Congress in March 2024, unsuccessfully contesting the general election from Secunderabad and losing to BJP's G Kishan Reddy. Rao is a first-time MLA and won Bhadrachalam as a BRS candidate in December 2023.

UP polls to youth unrest: Why BJP is treading with caution over delimitation

CAPITAL CONTEXT

BY LIZ MATHEW

A WEEKLY LOOK AT POLITICS IN A STATE FROM THE VANTAGE POINT OF NEW DELHI

WITH THE Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections barely five months away, the BJP seems to be getting increasingly circumspect about the timing of its proposed delimitation exercise. A BJP section is in favour of pushing for expanding the Lok Sabha's strength through delimitation after the UP polls, considering the high electoral stakes in the politically most crucial state and its possible impact on the party's prospects in the 2029 Lok Sabha elections, party sources said.

The BJP leadership is treading cautiously over delimitation as it does not want to upset the regional parties on the issue and is keen to keep the lines open to even non-NDA players

so that they could come handy during the 2029 Lok Sabha elections if required, according to sources.

The party is looking beyond delimitation to ensure that it has "enough friendly partners", especially in the South, keeping in view possible "anti-incumbency" and "fatigue" factors in 2029, sources said.

While the BJP-led NDA government did not bring a fresh constitutional amendment Bill to advance women's reservation law to 2029 — along with a delimitation Bill for expansion of the Lok Sabha from 543 MPs up to 850 — during the monsoon session of Parliament, the BJP dispensation has already mustered "numbers close to a two-thirds majority" needed to pass it, sources said. Such legislation, the Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026, was defeated in the Lower House in the April special session.

"The issue is no longer about the numbers. It is about

current political priorities, and the UP election is our priority now. The party has yet to assess the ground situation, so the leadership has not taken a final call on delimitation yet," according to a BJP insider.

Asserting that the Narendra Modi government is committed to push the constitutional amendment Bill linked to women quota and delimitation, senior BJP leaders said the party leadership has been "constantly in touch" with even non-NDA parties that are likely to support it.

Maintaining that the BJP leadership has been in discussion even with senior leaders of the DMK led by ex-chief minister M K Stalin, a party source said, "DMK has assured its support if the government gives a constitutional guarantee to retain Tamil Nadu's existing share of the Lok Sabha seats (7.2%) for another 25 years. But the party wants it to be incorporated in the Bill."



Sources say the BJP leadership does not want to upset regional parties on the issue and is keen to keep lines open to even non-NDA players so they could come handy in the 2029 LS polls. EXPRESS FILE

A DMK leader said, "We don't want to be carried away, we want to see it as part of the Bill. No verbal assurance can be taken as a guarantee."

The BJP leaders who are of the view that the government should pause its delimitation

move till the UP elections' conclusion argue that in the backdrop of youth protests over alleged irregularities in the education and exam systems as well as unemployment, the government should not do anything to "antagonise" regional

players and smaller parties till the scenario for the 2029 Lok Sabha face-off is clearer. "The UP Assembly election results will give us more clarity in this regard," said a BJP leader.

"Clearly, any legislation of this kind is bound to be tested in the court just like the EC's SIR (Special Intensive Revision) exercise is being tested in the court now. The government, knowing the potential of such legal challenges, has to be very careful while proceeding," said another senior BJP leader.

In a bid to boost its prospects in the 2029 battle, the BJP is keen to further strengthen its ties with the NDA allies, especially the TDP and JD(U), keep the DMK in good humour, and develop a better understanding with the BRS. Both the DMK and BRS are currently neither part of the NDA nor the Opposition INDIA bloc.

Senior BJP leader and ex-Union minister Ravi Shankar Prasad pointed out that a de-

limitation exercise is anyway required for the implementation of the Women's Reservation Act.

"In the face of the settled legal and constitutional position, whether the (Lok Sabha) number is 800 or 543, whenever the allocation of seats for women is to be done, who will do it? The delimitation commission based upon the number of women, or overall proportion. Therefore, the whole delimitation exercise headed by a retired Supreme Court judge backed by a legal provision is salutary. Its not something new. Delimitation is a must, it's going to happen, it should happen," Prasad told *The Indian Express*.

"In 2001, the pressure of South India had worked and a freeze was done till 2026 and the year is to end soon. There is always a case for delimitation," he added. This was a reference to the 84th Constitutional Amendment, 2001, passed by

the then Atal Bihari Vajpayee-led NDA government, which extended the freeze on the total number of the Lok Sabha and Assembly seats for each state until the first Census after 2026.

The Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam, passed by the Modi government in 2023, stipulates that 33% women's quota in the Lok Sabha and the Assemblies would be implemented following delimitation on the basis of the first Census after the Act was passed.

While the population enumeration for the ongoing Census will be conducted across the country in February 2027, it has been advanced in snow-bound regions and poll-bound states like UP, Punjab and Goa.

So, unless the freeze on the allocation of seats through population-based delimitation, as done by the 84th Constitutional Amendment, is extended by Parliament, it will expire with the completion of the ongoing Census exercise.



Delhi and Dhaka look at Nov dates for Rahman’s India visit

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, September 18

MOVING TO put their relations back on track, Delhi and Dhaka have begun talks on a bilateral visit to India by Bangladesh Prime Minister Tarique Rahman, exploring a window in the latter half of November, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

This development comes days after the New Delhi summit of BRICS leaders — Rahman did not attend though India, as the host nation, extended an invitation to Bangladesh since it is the current chair of the BIMSTEC grouping.

Earlier, Delhi had invited Rahman for a bilateral visit in August. But that did not materialise. There was outrage in Bangladesh over the remarks of Sheikh Hasina, the country’s ousted Prime Minister who has been living in India, during an interaction with the media via an audio link on August 5 which marked two years of the fall of her government.

Sources said the two sides are now looking at dates in November for a bilateral visit.

According to the Ministry of External Affairs, Delhi had extended an invitation to Rahman for a stand-alone bilateral visit after he entered office in February following the elections in Bangladesh.

Indian High Commissioner



Bangladesh Prime Minister Tarique Rahman

Dinesh Trivedi is learnt to have initiated the conversation in Dhaka and Delhi, and the two sides are looking at possible dates that also suit Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s schedule.

A change of guard is also taking place at the Bangladesh High Commission in New Delhi. High Commissioner M Riaz Hamidullah is expected to head to Geneva as Bangladesh’s Permanent Representative to the UN. Foreign Secretary Asad Alam Siam is expected to replace him as the new High Commissioner of Bangladesh. The formal paperwork is said to be underway because the official agreement has to be approved by the Indian government.

Sources said the two sides are trying to overcome the diplomatic challenge following the postponement of Rahman’s

visit in August.

Ties between the two countries, severely strained following the 2024 ouster of Hasina, had been looking up after Rahman took charge of Bangladesh in February. But Hasina’s public interaction in New Delhi this August angered Dhaka which has been seeking her extradition to Bangladesh where she faces a death sentence.

At the heart of scheduling Rahman’s visit is Dhaka’s precondition that a “propitious environment needs to be created” for it — a reference to the presence of Hasina in India and her public statements.

Bangladesh wants a clear response on the steps being taken on the issue of Hasina’s extradition. Delhi has not yet responded, and a battle of nerves is being played out amid hectic negotiations to find a “middle ground”.

While stating that the extradition request is “being examined”, the Indian side has been emphasising on a forward-looking relationship built on “mutuality of interests and reciprocity”. Delhi has signalled that it aims to address broader bilateral and security concerns alongside Dhaka’s requests.

Sources said the two sides are “aware” of the significance of the Rahman visit, and have much to benefit from a strong and robust relationship.

SC judges to visit new NTA office to run check on infra, manpower

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, September 18

A TWO-JUDGE bench of the Supreme Court hearing petitions seeking restructuring of the National Testing Agency (NTA) said on Friday that the judges would visit the agency’s headquarters to check if it has the required infrastructure and manpower for carrying out the onerous responsibilities.

“We will come there one day. Myself and my brother,” said Justice P S Narasimha, who led the bench also comprising Justice Alok Aradhe.

Justice Narasimha made the remark after Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the Centre, told the bench that the NTA now has a permanent address at Minto Road in Central Delhi.

“We will come and see if the system is actually in place, whether it is working or not working, manpower, how is it,” he said.

Justice Narasimha also sought to impress upon Mehta the importance of strengthening the NTA’s system institutionally to prevent paper leaks. He underlined the need for NTA to have a permanent setup and permanent staff. “Each of these aspects — permanency of the place, permanency of at least half of the staff, not everyone should be on deputation”, said Justice Narasimha.

Mehta added to the list — “and whether you need a statutory backing to the existence of the committee”?



The National Testing Agency relocated from Okhla to the Government of India Press Building on Minto Road

The NTA is under the shadow of the NEET-UG paper leak that sparked nationwide protests earlier this year, leading to the resignation of Dharmendra Pradhan as the Union Education Minister.

The top court is hearing petitions seeking replacement or restructuring of the NTA, which holds all-India competitive exams such as JEE (Main), CUET (UG), CUET (PG), UGC-NET and CSIR-NET and NEET (UG). Among the petitioners are the Federation of All India Medical Association (FAIMA), United Doctors Front and RJD MP Sudhakar Singh. The petitions also seek “digital locking” of question papers, a transition to computer-based test model and publication of centre-wise results to detect anomalies.

Asked about the progress of the work by the High-Powered Task Force set up by the Centre under Infosys co-founder Nan-

dan Nilekani to recommend structural changes needed in the conduct of the NEET exams, Mehta told the court that it had “conducted extensive consultations”, including with former ISRO chairman K Radhakrishnan, who is heading an earlier High-Level Committee of Experts (HLC).

He said: “It is our expectation that by the end of this month, the committee may come out with the report.”

“What is the progress, what are the suggestions? We want somebody from the committee to tell us,” said Justice Narasimha. “Ask the joint secretary (assisting the committee) to file an affidavit indicating the progress of the matter, what are the suggestions?” the judges said, adding that “most important... is institutionalisation”.

“We had the Radhakrishnan Committee. So what we have today is only a committee

report. Full stop,” said Justice Narasimha.

“We will see the implementation,” said Justice Narasimha. For the petitioners, Advocate Tanvi Dubey pointed out that the Radhakrishnan Committee had specifically referred to the need to have domain experts and a governing body.

Justice Narasimha said taking advice from domain experts is an integral part and the two committees are taking care of it. “Once the affidavit is placed on record, we will know how it’s progressing. We will accordingly deal with it,” he said.

Dubey said while there are plans to transform the NEET-UG exam from pen-paper to computer-based, there should also be time-bound direction as the next exams are only a few months away.

Mehta said, “The government and the Nilekani Committee are also cognisant that we are nearing the next exam. So something will have to be done. That’s what we are given to understand.” He added that all suggestions given by all petitioners were placed before the Nilekani Committee.

The bench said that NTA should put up the affidavit on its website so that all stakeholders can have a look.

“...We direct NTA to place the affidavit on its web portal so that progress can be looked into by other stakeholders. We direct the Joint Secretary to the High Powered Task Force to file affidavit indicating the progress within 2 weeks,” the court said.

MP HC judge to donate Rs 1.1 crore retirement benefits to PM CARES

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, September 18

JUSTICE AVANINDRA Kumar Singh of the Madhya Pradesh High Court announced in his farewell speech on retirement that he and his wife have pledged their bodies for donation after death for scientific purposes.

Justice Singh said the body-donation pledge was made two days before his retirement through a medical college. He said the idea came from his wife, who also suggested that he donate his GPF to the PM CARES Fund.

“I believe that we serve God not only by worshipping Him, but also by taking care of all the things, big and small, that God has created on this earth... My wife and I pledged and registered two days before through a medical college that, after our death, our bodies can be used for scientific purposes,” Justice Singh said, his voice choking with emotion.

“As per the office calculation, I am expected to receive



Justice Singh retired from the High Court on September 17

approximately Rs 1 crore one lakh from my GPF account. I pledge before you all to donate the entire amount, as soon as I receive it, to the PM CARES Fund for nation-building,” he said. “And this step is the beginning and not the end.”

Justice Singh specifically credited his wife for both decisions, saying she had stood by him throughout his life and had supported him wholeheartedly at different points of his career.

Justice Singh retired from the Madhya Pradesh High Court on September 17 after 36 years of judicial service.

Milestone at Kuno: Cheetah born to South African feline has four cubs of its own

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, September 18

A DAY AFTER Project Cheetah completed four years in India, an Indian-born cheetah has given birth to four cubs at Kuno National Park, marking a milestone for a programme that began with the translocation of animals from Africa and is now seeing successive generations born in India.

KGPI2, an Indian-born female and daughter of the South African cheetah Gamini, gave birth to the four cubs in Kuno, Union Environment, Forest and Climate Change Minister Bhupender Yadav said.

“A truly historic and joyous moment for Project Cheetah! A day after India’s Cheetah Project completed four years, KGPI2, an Indian-born female cheetah, has given birth to four cubs in Kuno,” he said. “Four years, four new lives — a beautiful symbol of hope, resilience and the growing success of cheetah conservation in India.” The latest births take India’s cheetah population to 56,

including 36 cheetahs born in the country. Kuno now has 53 cheetahs, while another three are at Gandhi Sagar Sanctuary.

The birth is particularly significant because KGPI2 is itself a product of the reintroduction programme. It was born in India to Gamini, one of the cheetahs brought from South Africa. The births mean animals born after the return of cheetahs to India are now themselves producing offspring.

Project Cheetah began on September 17, 2022, with eight cheetahs brought from Namibia. A further 12 were brought from South Africa in February 2023, followed by nine from Botswana this year. Over four years, the programme has shifted from the initial translocation of adult animals to breeding and establishing India-born generations. For the programme, KGPI2’s litter matters beyond the numbers. The project’s longer-term objective is to establish a viable population that can survive and breed under natural conditions.

To stem migration, Uttarakhand looks at a spiritual solution — Rudraksh farming

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
Dehradun, September 18

FOR A state touted as Dev Bhoomi (land of the Gods), Uttarakhand is not alien to the significance of Rudraksh — the seed used to make prayer beads and is revered by Hindus and Buddhists. Now, the state government has plans to channelise these very beads to stem a problem that it has been battling for decades: Migration, especially from the hill districts.

The Uttarakhand government has directed its Horticulture Department to draw up a formal cultivation policy for Rudraksh, as part of an effort to create new income sources in these districts. The instruction came in a notification on August 31. Signed by Under Secretary Sandeep Sharma of the state’s Agriculture and Farmers Welfare department, and addressed to the Director of Horticulture & Food Processing, the letter instructed officials to study a proposal “on cultivation methods, farm management, post-harvest processing, marketing and soil suitability”. It asked the department to “submit a clear proposal to the government as soon as possible.”

The letter follows a request from Tehri Garhwal MLA Kishore Upadhyay to Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami, and a four-member government delegation’s visit to Nepal in March this year — to study Rudraksh cultivation there. The delegation included Upadhyay, Rudraksh



(From left) Rudraksh expert Prince Agrawal, Tehri Garhwal MLA Kishore Upadhyay and top agriculture scientist Ramesh Singh Pal visited Nepal in March to study Rudraksh cultivation there. EXPRESS

expert Prince Agrawal, and senior agricultural scientist Ramesh Singh Pal. The group’s findings are laid out in a 197-page technical report and an accompanying presentation, “*Strategic Introduction of Rudraksha Cultivation in Uttarakhand*”, presented to Dhami in July.

Uttarakhand’s hill districts have long been losing residents to Dehradun, New Delhi and other cities — a trend the state’s own migration commission has tracked and attributed, in part, to a lack of viable income from agriculture, crop damage from wildlife, and fragmented landholdings. “Our villages in Uttarakhand have become ghost villages. It’s happening because there is simply nothing there. The land is just lying empty,” Pal told *The Indian Express*.

The expert team’s presenta-

EXPRESS special

collector and raw-bead trade, at \$100,800,000 — roughly five times India’s import bill of \$20.140,000, over 95% of which, the presentation states, comes from Indonesia and Nepal.

Pal said, “We went to Nepal and saw a 29-mukhi Rudraksh there.” Referring to the bead with 29 lobes or ridges — a rare variety, he said, “A single piece is for about Rs 1.5 crore. China imports more of this than India does.” The presentation notes that large-scale commercial production of Rudraksh is dominated by Nepal and Indonesia, and argues that Uttarakhand, which shares similar soil and climate conditions with Nepal’s growing regions, has not yet captured any share of that trade.

As per the presentation, Nepal’s Rudraksh belt sits between 600 and 2,000 metres in altitude, with average temperatures of 25-30°C and annual rainfall of 1,500-2,500 mm. Uttarakhand’s proposed growing zone — 500-1,800 metres high with 22-35°C average temperature, and 1,000-2,200 mm of rain — falls within a comparable range. “The comparative soil analysis indicates Uttarakhand soils are largely suitable for Rudraksh cultivation and comparable to Nepalese growing regions,” it said.

The presentation listed Pauri, Tehri, Rudrapur, Chamoli, Almora and Bageshwar as “high potential” districts for plantation, and Nainital, Champawat, Pithoragarh and the hill areas of Dehradun with “mod-

erate potential.”

However, Pal has also raised concerns about issues that have affected earlier, less organised attempts to grow Rudraksh in the state. He said a similar-looking but different species, known as Bhadraksh, is often mistaken for or substituted for genuine Rudraksh. Another problem that the report acknowledges is that Rudraksh trees do not begin fruiting for 6-8 years, and take about 10 years to reach peak production stage.

The report estimates that a hill migrant working in a city typically saves Rs 10,000-Rs 15,000 a month. By comparison, it states, a single mature Rudraksh tree can produce 1,000-2,000 beads a year, which, at a conservative wholesale price of Rs 10-Rs 20 per bead for the common five-faced variety, would generate Rs 10,000-Rs 40,000 annually per tree. A family managing 20 mature trees could earn Rs 2 lakh-Rs 8 lakh a year, according to the report.

To cover the years before the trees begin bearing fruit, the plan proposes using the Centre’s rural employment guarantee scheme to fund labour for digging pits, planting and fencing for the first 3 years. The Horticulture Department would supply saplings for free or at subsidised rates for the purpose. The report sets a target of 10,000 hectares under Rudraksh cultivation by 2047, with 10 million trees planted, 50,000-70,000 farmers, and up to 150,000 jobs created.

Punjab police ASI on patrol shot dead; govt announces Rs 1 cr ex gratia

Kamaldeep Singh Brar
Amritsar, September 18

AN ASSISTANT Sub-Inspector (ASI) of the Amritsar Commissionerate Police was shot dead by unidentified motorcycle-borne assailants in the early hours of Friday while performing night patrol duty.

The deceased officer, identified as ASI Harjit Singh, was a resident of Tarn Taran deployed with the Police Control Room (PCR) under the jurisdiction of the Gate Hakima police station.

The incident occurred at around 2:30 AM near the Bhagtwala grain market when two assailants riding a motorcycle opened fire on him.

Singh sustained critical gunshot wounds and was immediately rushed to a nearby hospital in Amritsar, where he succumbed to his injuries during treatment.

Following the attack, police teams quickly arrived at the scene to secure the area and collect forensic evidence.

The investigation is ongoing with the authorities examining nearby CCTV footage to establish the motive behind the crime and track down the assailants.

The state government announced an ex-gratia grant of Rs 1 crore, while HDFC Bank will provide an additional insurance compensation of Rs 1 crore.

Delhi HC grants bail to British national Jagtar Johal in seven NIA cases

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, September 18

CITING *The* inordinate delay by the prosecution in producing before it verifiable evidence, the Delhi High Court on Friday granted bail to Jagtar Singh Johal, a British national jailed for his alleged role in funding the Khalistan Liberation Force, which had carried out targeted killings in Punjab.

Johal, 38, was arrested in November 2017 when he arrived in Punjab to marry his fiancée. His trial was deferred numerous times. Later, in March 2025, he was acquitted in one case, which the prosecution did not challenge.

The latest verdict now clears the way for his release from jail, after being incarcerated for more than eight years.

The seven NIA cases, lodged between 2017 and 2019 in various divisions of Punjab, include terror law charges, offences under the Arms Act, as well as murder. The court found the acquittal of “strong persuasive value”, noting that “on similar averments, (Johal) is being implicated” in the seven NIA cases as a co-conspirator. “Therefore, at least for enlarging (Johal) on bail, this order shall have a strong persuasive value,” it held. He shall also furnish an undertaking to this extent before a trial court. Johal must also surrender his passport.

{ PIYUSH DESAI • 1939-2026 }

An industry veteran who believed ‘tea can dissolve differences’

Leena Misra
Ahmedabad, September 18

A TEA TASTER, philanthropist and one who deeply loved Indian music. This is how those who knew him describe Piyush Desai, Chairman of Ahmedabad-based Wagh Bakri Tea Group, who passed away on September 15 at the age of 86.

Narandas Desai, Piyush’s grandfather, began with a tea estate on a 500-acre plot in Durban in 1892 and returned to India in 1919 with a ‘certificate’ from Mahatma Gandhi, who was also in South Africa at the time. In Ahmedabad, Narandas founded the Gujarat Tea Depot and launched the Wagh Bakri

brand with its iconic logo showing a tiger and a goat drinking from the same cup.

Sources close to Piyush Desai say he “was everything the brand stood for and did not believe in communal discrimination”. The brand markets itself on the belief that “tea can dissolve differences”.

Bhushan Punani, General Secretary of the Blind People’s Association (BPA), a voluntary organisation based in Ahmedabad, remembers how he first met Desai. “In 1984, Piyushbhai and his brothers came to IIM-Ahmedabad (located opposite BPA) and realised it was closed with no one to guide them. So, they walked across to BPA and



Piyush Desai’s was one of the lone critical voices during Gujarat riots in 2002

met our then general secretary and gave the largest donation from any single individual—Rs 1.51 lakh—at the time.”

He also recalls Desai’s other philanthropic contributions.

Following the 2001 earthquake in Kutch, Desai donated Rs 15 lakh to BPA, which was helping rehabilitate victims who sustained physical disabilities due to the quake.

His latest contribution, Punani says, was the donation of 200 smart glasses four years ago for visually challenged BPA members to help them access reading and study materials. Desai served as BPA President from 2014 to 2020, and later invited Punani, an IIM-A alumnus, to join the Wagh Bakri board. Punani is now an additional director in the company.

When riots broke out in Gujarat in 2002 following the train burning in Godhra, Desai’s was

the only critical voice among corporate leaders in the state that spoke out. He also took the lead in organising relief and rehabilitation for those affected by the riots. A close associate who chooses to remain anonymous tells the paper: “Piyushbhai could not see anyone in distress, his heart would go out to them and he would extend his help. He did not believe in communalism; Hindus and Muslims were one for him.”

Desai also remained closely associated with Gujarat Vidya-pith when Narayan Desai (son of Gandhi’s secretary Mahadev Desai), was its chancellor. “He was also a member of its committee,” says the source.

He was also the Vice President of Sadvichar Parivar, another Ahmedabad-based NGO, in 2012-2014 and donated Rs 31 lakh for a hostel for physically challenged people in Uvarsad, Gandhinagar, says PK Laheri, former Gujarat Chief Secretary and Managing Trustee of the organisation.

Associated with tea trade for six decades, the company grew during Piyushbhai’s tenure and now boasts a presence in more than 66 countries and multiple states in India. The company, estimated to be worth Rs 2000 crore, has nearly 9% share in the country’s tea market.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Patna HC issues notice to I&B over ‘Best Book on Cinema’ award

Santosh Singh
Patna, September 18

THE PATNA HC on Thursday issued notice to the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting and the NFDC, asking them to explain how a biography of singer-actor Kishore Kumar was selected as the Best Book on Indian cinema at the 70th National Film Awards.

Justice Ajit Kumar was hearing a petition filed by Patna-based Hindi writer and literary critic Anant Prasad Sinha. He moved the court seeking to quash the Award for Best Book on Cinema, awarded to *Kishore Kumar: The Ultimate Biography*, authored by Anirudha Bhattacharjee and Parthiv Dhar, and published by HarperCollins. It was announced on August 16, 2024, and presented at New Delhi’s Vigyan Bhawan on October 8, 2024. In his petition, the petitioner alleged the ministry violated its own eligibility criteria for the prestigious award. The matter will be heard on Oct 8.

INS Kolkata was on routine patrol, Pak vessel conduct wrong: MEA

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, September 18

THREE DAYS after a frontline warship of the Indian Navy and a Pakistani Navy vessel were involved in a collision in international waters in the North Arabian Sea, Delhi on Friday officially identified the ship as *INS Kolkata* and said that the *Pakistani Naval Ship Hunain* conducted itself in an “unacceptable and unprofessional manner at sea” that resulted in the collision.

Ministry of External Affairs’ official spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal on Friday said: “Let me reiterate the facts of the matter. *INS Kolkata* was on a routine deployment in the western Arabian Sea when *Pakistani Naval Ship Hunain* conducted itself in an unacceptable and unprofessional manner at sea that resulted in a collision.”

“The dangerous overtaking manoeuvre by *PNS Hunain* was in gross violation of Article

10 of the Agreement between India and Pakistan on Advance Notice on Military Exercises, Manoeuvres and Troops Movements of April 1991, which specifies that naval units at sea are not to be within 3 nautical miles of each other. In addition, the Pakistani ship also infringed the International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea,” he said.

“The Pakistan side has once again been advised about the need for all military units to observe due care and respect the provisions of the relevant agreements between the two sides in order to prevent any repeat of such incidents,” he said.

The MEA spokesperson said the incident did not cause any major damage to *INS Kolkata* and she remains at sea.

On Wednesday, India summoned Pakistan’s Charge d’Affaires and lodged a strong protest over the incident. Later, Islamabad countered with its own protest.



Indian Navy destroyer *INS Kolkata* was involved in a collision with *PNS Hunain* in the North Arabian Sea on September 15

Pakistan’s Ministry of Foreign Affairs summoned the Charge d’Affaires of the Indian High Commission in Islamabad in response to the incident, it said in a statement. It said the Pakistani Navy was undertaking its biennial exercise SEA-SPARK-26 when the Indian vessel carried out “aggressive maneuvers in dangerously close proximity of Pakistani naval ship, resulting in contact between the two vessels”.

Islamabad called the incident a “highly provocative and unacceptable action by a vessel of the Indian Navy in Pakistan’s Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ)”. Responding to this, the MEA spokesperson said on Friday: “We have seen Pakistan’s response to the protest we had lodged. It is the usual prevarication that we expected. We reject the allegations and insinuations contained therein.”

Girl in ‘sexual abuse video’ linked to TN granite baron traced, probe widens

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, September 18

THE MINOR girl at the centre of the alleged sexual abuse case against granite businessman R Veeramani has been traced, and has identified herself and Veeramani in the video that first led to the case, senior police officers said.

Her statement has been recorded before a Judicial Magistrate, marking the most significant breakthrough since Veeramani, founder of GEM Granites and chairman of the GEM Group of Companies, and two of his associates were arrested last month. Earlier this year, Chennai police cited inability to identify the girl as grounds to close investigation, only for a POCSO court to intervene. The probe has widened beyond the girl. Police claim to have identified other women and minor girls who they suspect may have been sexually assaulted by Veeramani over a period of years.

A Chennai police officer said the original police team had not done enough in pursuing the case. “They had the video and they had to register an FIR. But the matter was not escalated to higher-ups,” said the officer. “We have identified the girl who was a minor when she was allegedly sexually exploited in 2019. She claims she is the person in the video. Her statement has been recorded before the magistrate.” Investigators have also invoked the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act against the accused.

“We are in the process of recording the statements of some suspected victims. Almost all of them are from very poor families,” said the officer. Police are also probing is some of the suspected victims were supported by charitable activities associated with Veeramani.

Police sources said investigators are also looking into whether the alleged sexual abuse went beyond the Teynam-

pet house linked to the original video, and are examining locations such as Veeramani’s residence, his office and a guest-house on the outskirts of Chennai.

Veeramani, who is in his 80s, was arrested on August 29 along with his longtime associate Shanthy and her husband, Mahendra Simhan, managing director of Gem Software Solutions. Police alleged the couple facilitated offences and were involved in tampering with or destroying evidence. The allegations against them have not been adjudicated. Police are probing whether Shanthy took some of the alleged victims for shopping or to luxury hotels, and looking into messages she exchanged with Veeramani.

The case had begun on October 6, 2025, when a child-rights activist approached the city police with a USB drive containing footage purportedly showing Veeramani sexually assaulting a minor girl. The footage carried a timestamp from 2019. Police registered an FIR the following day and questioned Veeramani and Shanthy. Both denied the allegations and said the man in the recording was not Veeramani.

The investigation then stalled. The earlier investigation also cited the absence of corroborating CCTV material and the inability of a cyber expert to retrieve the original recording from the DVR after the passage of several years.

In February, the Anti-Vice Squad filed a report seeking to drop further action. The Special POCSO Court ordered further probe. The court questioned, how investigators had failed to establish the scene of the alleged offence despite possessing the video. Searches at the Teynampet property led police to electronic devices that were sent for forensic examination. Police also claim to have found indications of evidence tampering.

Police have since been granted limited custody to question Veeramani.

EXPRESS special

Coming up in Ayodhya, a memorial dedicated to Ram Temple movement

Maulshree Seth
Lucknow, September 18

ON MARCH 25, 2020, Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath carried the idol of ‘Ram Lalla’ to a makeshift temple within the Ayodhya temple premises for the grand Ram Temple’s construction to begin at the main site. Six years later, the Shri Ram Janmbhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust has now erected a memorial temple at the site of the makeshift or interim temple.

Dedicated to the 27-year-long journey of the Ram Temple Movement — and the idol from a “makeshift tent to the grand temple” — the gates of the Memorial Temple in Ayodhya would soon be opened to the public.

What the Memorial Temple houses

While this outer structure has been created to match the red sandstone design of the main temple, the smaller Memorial Temple has been built with teak wood with carvings. At its centre, the temple would house



The newly constructed Memorial Temple within the premises of the Ram Temple in Ayodhya. EXPRESS

an electric-lit “akhand jyoti” or “eternal fire”, as a symbol of remembrance of the struggle.

To showcase the 27-year journey, the makeshift tent, in which the Ram Lalla idol was kept, would also be placed inside the Memorial Temple in a foldable form, informed officials.

Sources inform that the Memorial Temple also has an old idol of Lord Hanuman. It was reportedly brought here along with the Ram Lalla idol and kept under the same tent. However,

after the completion of the new Ram Temple, the Ram Lalla idol was shifted to its main ‘Garbhagriha’ (sanctum sanctorum), and the Lord Hanuman idol would remain inside the makeshift-turned-memorial temple.

Alongside this temple, a memorial pillar dedicated to “those who sacrificed their lives for the Ram Temple Movement over decades” has also been constructed, officials said. Atop this memorial, which is in the form of a ‘Stambha’ or a pillar, sits a

sun-shaped head, with engraved pictorial display of Lord Ram as well as the Trust slogan, “Ramo Vighrahan Dharma”, meaning “Ram is the embodiment of Dharma”.

Opening date yet to be decided

Temple Construction Committee Chairman Nripendra Mishra said, “The construction of both the makeshift temple and the memorial next to it is complete. It would be open to the public soon as a symbol and remembrance of the history.”

Asked about date and timing of opening of the Memorial Temple and the pillar, he said, “Both the structures are complete. It is upon the (Trust) CEO to decide when and how they would be opened to the public.”

As for the eternal fire inside the temple, he informed, “Since it is a wooden memorial structure thus the idea was to have a Jwala which does not generate heat or any possibility of an accident, thus, it was decided to have an electric eternal Jwala in this Memorial Temple.”

Cases over food, recitals ridiculous: SC judge

Amaal Sheikh
New Delhi, September 18

CRITICISING WHAT he described as the growing number of criminal cases that should never enter the justice system, Supreme Court judge Justice Ujjal Bhuyan on Friday pointed to cases registered against people for consuming a particular kind of food, reciting poems, raising slogans seeking bail for others, participating in demonstrations, commenting on social media, performing stand-up comedy, and even over the content or titles of films and books.

“The accusations are ridiculous and often border on an affront to one’s intelligence. Nonetheless, registration of such criminal cases continues unabated. Not only that, in some

cases chargesheets are also filed, leading to trial knowing fully well what would be the outcome,” he said.

Speaking at an event organised by the Centre for Discourse on Criminal and Constitutional Jurisprudence at India International Centre, New Delhi, on the theme ‘Ethics in Criminal Litigation — Duties of Defence & The Prosecution’, Justice Bhuyan said: “At the drop of a hat, their sentiments are hurt. And they file this type of cases.”

He said such prosecutions were adding to the burden on an already overburdened criminal justice system. Citing figures from the National Judicial Data Grid (NJDG), Justice Bhuyan said more than 4.27 crore criminal cases were pending across Indian courts as of September 17,

with trial courts accounting for 95% of that backlog.

“When you have so many cases clogging the court system, with the system unable to cope with it, as if almost bursting at the seams, superimposition of such frivolous cases is only adding to the unworkable burden on the trial courts,” he said.

He called for a special drive by trial courts to clear such “frivolous litigation” and proposed a one-time amnesty for non-serious criminal cases. “There can be a one-time amnesty across the board for non-serious cases, non-sessions cases... so that our courts can concentrate on those cases which require our concentration,” he said.

Referring to custodial violence and alleged encounter killings, he said he was being forced

to reconsider the belief that such practices had substantially receded after landmark judicial interventions.

“I thought that after D.K. Basu (D.K. Basu v. State of West Bengal, 1997), custodial violence is a thing of the past. But I am forced to reconsider this,” he said, adding that “extrajudicial killings are on the rise in India”.

“Policemen resorting to extrajudicial killings is unacceptable. It’s failure of policing; it’s failure of investigation.”

Justice Bhuyan said public confidence in the criminal justice system ultimately depends on fairness of process. “A conviction should be trusted because it was obtained fairly. An acquittal should likewise be trusted because it was argued honestly,” he said.

I&B Ministry notifies new film certification guidelines for CBFC

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, September 18

THE MINISTRY of Information and Broadcasting (I&B) has notified new film certification guidelines for the Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC) earlier this week.

These revised guidelines retain all the aspects of its detailed 1991 version, save for the addition of two new points.

One calls for a disclaimer or statutory warning in scenes depicting or involving the use, consumption or trafficking of narcotic drugs or other psychotropic substances.

These scenes must now carry the warning ‘Illicit Narcotics Destroy Health and Guarantees Imprisonment, Say No to Drugs.’

The other point pertains to the specification of new-age markers in line with the three new categories under the UA (Unrestricted Public Exhibition With Parental Guidance) certification, as notified in the Cinematograph Rules, 2024

The latest guidelines state that if the Board thinks that it is necessary to caution the parents or the child’s guardian to consider as to whether their wards may be allowed to see such a film, the same shall be certified for unrestricted public exhibition with an endorsement to that effect.

The three categories are UA 7+, UA 13+, and UA 16+ — to

mark content suitable for children in the age group of seven, 13 and 16, respectively.

Posting the new guidelines on X, CBFC Chairperson Shashi Shekhar Vempati stated: “Request all filmmakers to study the revised Guidelines for Film Certification and understand the framework within which Film Certification happens before submitting applications.”

He also called on film associations and related bodies to disseminate the guidelines within the fraternity to create greater awareness and appreciation of the guidelines.

The I&B ministry stated that CBFC will ensure that anti-social activities and violence are not glorified or justified, and that the modus operandi of criminals and other visuals or glorifying crimes are also to be avoided, as per the guidelines. Further, the ministry stated that scenes showing involvement of children in violence as victims or perpetrators or as forced witnesses to violence, or showing children as being subjected to any form of child abuse are not to be presented needlessly.

The CBFC is also to discourage scenes showing abuse or ridicule of physically and mentally handicapped persons; and those showing cruelty to, or abuse of animals.

Court grants bail to US national in ‘terror conspiracy’ case

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, September 18

A DELHI court on Friday granted default bail to US national Matthew Aaron VanDyke, one of seven foreign nationals arrested in March by the NIA for allegedly conspiring to carry out terrorist activities against India.

Presiding over the case, special NIA Judge Prashant Sharma held that the chargesheet filed by NIA was “piecemeal”, invoking only Sections 21 and 23 of Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025, while the investigation into offences under Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA) remained pending. “...At this stage it cannot be concluded that applicant/accused Matthew Aaron Vandyke is not entitled for default bail. As such, the investigating agency cannot circumvent section 187(3) BNSS (erstwhile section 167(2) CrPC) by filing incomplete chargesheet, for the purpose of denying default bail to applicant/accused,” the judge said in his order dated September 18.

Represented by advocates Rohit Dandriyal and Rohit Gour, VanDyke sought default bail under Section 187(3) of the BNSS read with Section 43D(2) of the UAPA. It governs statutory right to default bail when an investigation is not completed within prescribed period — 90 days for serious offences and 60 days for others. Section 43D(2) of the UAPA modifies this timeline for terror cases, allowing a Special Court to extend investigation period up to 180 days on a satisfactory report from the public prosecutor.

VanDyke was arrested on March 13, and the 180-day period for completing the investigation lapsed on September 8 — the same day the NIA filed its chargesheet. “...Applicant/accused has filed a present application for seeking default bail, stating that in the wake of said incomplete charge-sheet, applicant/accused is entitled for default bail,” Judge Sharma said.

The judge noted that, “...based on the abovementioned understanding of law and appreciation of facts, co-accused persons involved in this case, are also entitled to default bail, as per law,” he said.

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Prof. B.A. Mir

Dt: 18-09-2026

Dean Academic Affairs

[FROM PAGE 1]

Surendra Koli, acquitted in Nithari killings, found dead

It was there that he was found hanging.

Police have informed his family and said no suicide note was recovered.

Circle Officer, Haridwar City, Shishupal Singh Negi, confirmed that it appeared to be a suicide. The body was sent to the Haridwar District Hospital for a post-mortem.

It was an acquaintance, Dharmender Kaushik, who found Koli dead around 10 am and informed the police.

Police said Kaushik told them he found the shop shut and knocked on the shutter but got no response. He initially thought Koli, who was diabetic, was asleep.

According to police sources, Koli arrived in Haridwar one-and-a-half months ago and tried

to find accommodation in Roshanabad, but couldn’t produce an Aadhaar card required for police verification.

Around the same time, sources told *The Indian Express*, Koli managed to find work as a security guard at a factory. After he left that job, Kaushik helped him get another position as a guard through a firm at an apartment, sources said, adding that Koli left that job too.

About three days before his death, Koli rented a small tea stall in Bhupatwala, opposite Lal Mata Temple, in Kaushik’s name, according to police sources.

Koli brought his belongings from Roshanabad and began living inside the stall. He had been selling tea and biscuits there for just two or three days.

A diary found at the shop, which appeared to contain Koli’s daily expenditure and work-related accounts, has been collected by the police.

Another acquaintance, Jai Kashyap, 28, said he met Koli in Roshanabad around 25 days ago. Koli had introduced himself as Sada Ram from Almora, and told him he was looking for a room and work. Kashyap helped him find both.

It was only after his death that Kashyap learnt his true identity. “I came to know his name today,” Kashyap told *The Indian Express* in Haridwar. “I helped him as a human being.”

He said Koli had never told him that he was in trouble. “But I could see that he was troubled by something,” he said. “I did not know why.”

The Nithari case

Koli and his employer, businessman Moninder Singh Pandher, were arrested in December 2006 after skeletal remains were discovered in a drain and on an open strip of land behind a house owned by Pandher in Noida’s Sector 31. Koli worked there as a domestic help.

Digging eventually unearthed 19 bodies, mostly of children who had vanished from the nearby Nithari village.

Noida police had filed 19 FIRs against Pandher and Koli relating to crimes against 19 different girls, and the CBI filed chargesheets in 16 of them.

The prosecution’s case rested on two pillars: an alleged confession Koli gave before a magistrate — describing luring, strangling and dismembering

victims — and the recovery of remains supposedly based on his disclosures.

In 2009, both Koli and Pandher were convicted and sentenced to death by a special CBI court for the rape and murder of a 14-year-old. On appeal, the Allahabad High Court acquitted Pandher but upheld Koli’s conviction and death sentence. Koli then approached the Supreme Court, which dismissed his appeal in 2011 and a review petition in 2014.

In September 2014, an execution warrant was issued against Koli, and he was moved to Meerut jail with a hanging scheduled for 5.30 am. Senior advocate Indira Jaising rushed the matter to a judge’s residence at night, and a bench was convened.

The execution was stayed just hours before the hanging was due to happen.

He was tried and convicted in 12 other Nithari cases between 2010 and 2021 and sentenced to death. All were based on the same evidence — his 2007 confession and the recoveries made in 2006. Pandher was also convicted and sentenced to death in two of them.

But in October 2023, the Allahabad High Court acquitted Koli in all 12 cases and Pandher in the two against him.

On November 11, 2025, a bench led by Chief Justice B R Gavai overturned its 2011 ruling and ordered Koli’s release, calling the original investigation “botched”.

Pandher walked out of a Noida prison in 2023.

SALUTE THE SOLDIER



GORKHA RIFLES

Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart, No 81169 Late NK Karki Limbu of 3/11 GR, who made supreme sacrifice during Hyderabad Police Action on 19 Sep 1948.



Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart, No 9407008 Late Rfn Ram Bir Rai of 2/11 GR, who made supreme sacrifice during OP BATTLE AXE on 19 Sep 1967.

Colonel 11 GR & Sikkim Scouts and All Rank

BORDER SECURITY FORCE



CONSTABLE MANJU BHAI
14 BN BSF
01.06.1969 – 19.09.1998

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Manju Bhai on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries in Counterpart firing in Sundarbani area, J&K and later succumbed to his injuries.



LANCE NAIK MADHUKAR JAGTAP
76 BN BSF
13.10.1957 – 19.09.1990

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Lance Naik Madhukar Jagtap on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries during a Counter terror operation in Handwara area (J&K) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.



NAIK KABINDRA MARK
91 BN BSF
12.03.1943 – 19.09.1990



CONSTABLE AJMER SINGH
91 BN BSF
04.02.1967 – 19.09.1990

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans Naik Kabindra Mark and Constable Ajmer Singh on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal bullet injuries in a fierce encounter with militants in Bandipur area (J&K) and later succumbed to their injuries.



CONSTABLE JAGBIR SINGH
92 BN BSF
05.06.1968 – 19.09.1990

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Jagbir Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries in a fierce encounter with militants in Sopore area, J&K and later succumbed to his injuries.

NORTHERN RAILWAY

(E-Auction Notice)

Sr Divisional Commercial Manager/PS, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites bids through e-Auction through IREPS (<https://ireps.gov.in>) for the allotment of Automated Teller Machine/Digital Banking Unit/Banking e-Lobby Contracts at following Railway stations/locations:

E-Catalogue No	Date & Time of bidding	Railway Stations/Locations/Sites
DLI-ATM-05-2026	05.10.2026 at 12:00 Hrs	Anand Vihar Terminal (2), Tohana (1), Jakhal, (1), Noida (1).

Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen: <https://ireps.gov.in/>

All bidders who intend to participate in the e-auctions conducted through E-Auction Leasing module of IREPS should fulfil following mandatory requirements before they can submit their bids:

- Registration on IREPS for E-Auction Leasing module -Active IREPS User Account for E-Auction Leasing Module. • Payment of One Time Registration Fee;
- Current Account in State Bank of India. • Integration of SBI Bank Account with IREPS Account; • Lien Marking of Funds; • Updation of Turnover Details. • A new mechanism namely Virtual Account Number (VAN) has been introduced now for E-Auction Leasing module, which can be used by the bidders as an alternative to Lien Marking Mechanism. The bidders are free to switch between Lien Marking Mechanism (if activated) and VAN mechanism at any point of time, before entering the bidding room. VAN mechanism does not require the bidder to have a current account in State Bank of India. The users are free to transfer money from any of their existing bank accounts in any bank to their VAN account, which enables them to participate in IREPS E-Auctions.
- Contractors Who do not have IREPS account for any module of IREPS can submit their online request for registration by clicking on New Vendors / Contractors (E-Tender /E-Auction/Leasing) link on IREPS Home page.

Railway Authority to contact, in case of any query: Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Commercial Branch, State Entry Road, New Delhi 110055. Email: publicitycellidli@gmail.com Tel: 011-23743084

No.3PUB/ATM/DLI-DIV/E-auction/2022 Dated:- 09.2026 3251/26

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE No. 43/2026-2027 Dated: 18/09/2026

Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement system

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi - 110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items :-

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	09262613	WOOD BASED RESIN IMPREGNATED COMPRESSED LAMINATE (COMPRESSG BOARD)	14266 NOS	12-10-26
02	07261356	AIR SPRING ASSEMBLY	194 SET	13-10-26
03	77269093 RGC	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR HVN CUT LINER (T-10229 & T10230) &(T-10235)	60000 NOS	15-10-26
04	09262141	ROTARY BOTTOM OPERATED ARTICULATED LOCK	7698 NOS	19-10-26
05	77269092 RGC	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR HVN CUT LINER(T-10228)	124000 NOS	21-10-26
06	77269094 RGC	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR HVN CUT LINER(T-10232)	140000 NOS	27-10-26
07	77269095 RGC	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR HVN CUT LINER (T-10233 &T-10234)	37000 PAIR	02-11-26
08	77269053A	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR SLEEPER (T-4865)	100 SET	03-11-26
09	77269090 RGC	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR HVN CUT LINER (T-10225)	140000 NOS	06-11-26
10	77269052A RGC	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR SLEEPER (T-4218)	500 SET	17-11-26

Note: 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No Manual offer will be entertained. 3245/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE



HARYANA REAL ESTATE REGULATORY AUTHORITY

New Mini Secretariat, 2nd Floor, Sector-I, Panchkula.

E-mail: hrrerapk1-hry@gov.in, officer.rera.hry@gmail.com

Website: www.haryanarera.gov.in

PUBLIC NOTICE

For kind attention of allottees of the Real Estate Project namely "Park City" an Industrial plotted colony on land measuring 15,906 acres situated in the revenue estate of village Kanganpur, Sector-1A, Sirsa being developed by Monsoon Buildwell Pvt. Ltd.

1. The above-mentioned project was registered with HRERA Panchkula vide Registration No. HRERA-PKL-SRS-377-2022 dated 28.11.2022 valid upto 31.12.2025.

2. The promoter has requested the Authority that instead of revoking the registration on its expiry, the Authority may permit it to remain in force till 30.04.2027(inclusive of 4 months extension as per advisory issued by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs) subject to such further terms and conditions as it thinks fit to impose in the interest of the allottees and any such terms and conditions so imposed shall be binding upon the promoter.

3. The Authority is considering the application of the promoter to permit continuation of registration under section 7(3) of the Act for this project. However, the first right of refusal for carrying out of the remaining development works is that of the association of allottees. Therefore, the Authority hereby invites objections from the association of allottees in particular and any other concerned persons in general.

4. The objections shall be filed in the registry of the Authority before 06.10.2026 which will be considered by the Authority under section 7(3) of the Act.

Secretary (Acting)
HRERA Panchkula

No. 49405/HRHY

Panel probing Koregaon Bhima violence concludes hearings

Pune: Nearly nine years after the Koregaon Bhima Commission of Inquiry was formed by the Maharashtra government to probe the violence in Pune's Koregaon Bhima area in 2018, the panel has concluded its hearings to record evidence.

V V Palnitkar, the Commission's secretary, said on Friday,

“The government has given an extension of two more months to complete its work. The Commission will now prepare its final report.” One person died and several were injured in a violence that occurred in the area where lakhs had gathered to commemorate the 200th battle of Koregaon Bhima. ENS



OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BERHAMPUR
(At/Po-Ambapua, Near Income Tax office, Berhampur-760011, Ganjam, Odisha)
(E-Mail:- serwbpr2004@yahoo.com, Tel No. :-680-2404287)

NOTICE

FOR PRADHAN MANTRI GRAM SADAK YOJANA (PMGSY) NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH "e"-Procurement
Bid identification No. Online Tender/20-2026-27/PMGSY/BPR

The Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Berhampur on behalf of Odisha State Rural Road Agency invites the percentage rate bids in electronic tendering system for construction of Roads & Bridges under Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana [PMGSY-IV (B-I)] in the districts of **Kandhamal** for 06 (Six) number of packages with estimated cost totalling to **Rs 6.89 Cr (Approximate)** including their maintenance for five years from the eligible contractors registered with **State PWD /CPWD/MES / Railways**. The registered bidder of outside Odisha, can also participate in this process, but shall have to subsequently undergo registration with the appropriate authority of the State Govt. preferably within a month of the deadline for bid submission, but prior to signing of the contract

Date of release of Invitation for Bids through e-procurement. **Dtd. 18.09.2026**

Last Date/Time for receipt of bids through e-procurement: **03.10.2026 upto 5.30 P.M**

(i) EMD/Bid Security, Cost of Bid document to be transferred through Online as per the procedure mentioned in the DTCN.

(ii) Non-submission of the information/documents through online by the bidder as per mentioned DTCN will also liable for rejection of his tender.

For further details and corrigendum (if any) please log on to www.pmgstyenders.gov.in.

Sd/-
Chief Engineer
R.W.Circle, Berhampur

OIPR- 25001/25071/1/26-27/0034



बिहार शिक्षा परियोजना परिषद
NOTICE INVITING RFP
(<https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in>).

I. Bihar Education Project Council (BEP), Patna, invites "Request for Proposal (RFP) for Supply of Menstrual Hygiene Kits for Adolescent Girls of Government Schools in Bihar".

II. The complete RFP documents can be seen on and downloaded from the website <https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in> and our official website <https://bepcssa.in>

III. Schedule of Events:

Sl. Information	Details
1 RFP Issuing Authority	State Project Director, Bihar Education Project Council (BEP)
2 RFP No. and Date of availability from e-procurement portal	RFP Reference No. BEP/MSH/2026-27/4397, Dated 15/09/2026 . Available for download from 21/09/2026, 11:00 AM onwards till 07/10/2026, 3:00 PM on https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in
3 Last date for submission of written queries for clarifications	25/09/2026, 02:30 PM Email: ssabihar@gmail.com
4 Date of pre-bid conference	25/09/2026, 03:00 PM at through online mode Google Meet joining info Video call link: https://meet.google.com/tnt-yoe-e-kzs e-mail: ssabihar@gmail.com
5 Release of response to clarifications	26/09/2026, 5:00 PM
6 Last date of submission of bid	07/10/2026, 4:00 PM
7 Last date of submission of Hard copy of EMD	07/10/2026, 4:00 PM
8 Last date of submission of Sample (Before bid submission closing date & Time)	07/10/2026, 4:00 PM
9 Opening of Technical Bids	07/10/2026, 4:30 PM
10 Opening of Financial Bids	To be intimated
11 Contact person for queries	State Project Director, Bihar Education Project Council (BEP), Shiksha Bhawan, Bihar Rashtra Bhasha Parishad Campus, Saidpur - 800 004. e-mail: ssabihar@gmail.com

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

State Project Director
Bihar Education Project Council

PR- 012016 (B & C) 2026-27

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।



GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	GMDA GURUGRAM	DESILTING OF 1200MM I/D MASTER SEWER LINE ALONG MASTER ROAD DIVIDING SECTOR 49/50, GURUGRAM BY SUPER SUCKER MACHINE AND ALL OTHER WORKS CONTINGENT THERETO. - 1 WORKS	11.09.2026 21.09.2026	1,44,31,344/-	https://www.gmda.gov.in	9541291407 xen4infr2.gmda@gmda.gov.in
2	GMDA GURUGRAM	STRENGTHENING / REHABILITATION OF EXISTING MASTER SEWER LINE OF SIZE 1000MM PIPE LINE WITH MACHINE WOUND SPIRAL LINING (MWSL) TECHNOLOGY ALONG MASTER ROAD BETWEEN SECTOR - 22/23, GURUGRAM INCLUDING SITE SURVEY, DE-SILTING BY MECHANICAL MEANS, PROVISION OF PUMPING AND BYPASS ARRANGEMENTS, DISPOSAL OF SILT/DEBRIS, SUPPLY OF ALL MATERIALS, LABOUR, COMPLETE IN ALL RESPECT AND ALL OTHER WORKS CONTINGENT THERETO. (INCLUDING 3 YEARS DEFECT LIABILITY PERIOD FREE OF COST)	11.09.2026 28.09.2026	8,40,46,600/-	https://www.gmda.gov.in	9773972700 xen4infr2.gmda@gmda.gov.in
3	GMDA GURUGRAM	OPERATION AND MAINTENANCE OF HYDRAULICALLY OPERATED SEWER CLEANING MACHINE UNDER GMDA, GURUGRAM. AGEPROVIDING 1 NO. DRIVER CUM OPERATOR AND 3 NOS HELPERS FOR OPERATING THE HYDRAULICALLY OPERATED SEWER CLEANING MACHINE INCLUDING SERVICING OF MACHINE AND REPLACING OF THERMOPLASTIC JETTING HOSE AND NOZZLES ETC. COMPLETE IN ALL RESPECT AND ALL OTHER WORKS CONTINGENT THERETO. (FOR 24MONTHS) + 1 WORKS	11.09.2026 21.09.2026	66,54,808/-	https://www.gmda.gov.in	9773972700 xen4infr2.gmda@gmda.gov.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in



समाहरणालय, भागलपुर
(महानिषेध एवं उत्पाद कार्यालय)
अल्पकालीन सूचना
प्रेस-विज्ञापित
अधिरहित (Confiscated) वाहन की नीलामी की सूचना-

एतद द्वारा सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि भागलपुर जिला अन्तर्गत महानिषेध उत्पाद विभाग / विभिन्न थानों में पूर्ण शराबबन्दी के क्रम में महानिषेध एवं उत्पाद अधिनियम, 2016 के अंतर्गत दर्ज उत्पाद वाहनों में समाहित, भागलपुर / प्राधिकृत अधिहरण न्यायालय से पारित आदेश के आलोक में निम्नांकित वाहनों की नीलामी "जहाँ है, जैसे है" के रूप में अपर समाहर्ता, भागलपुर की अध्यक्षता में वाहन नीलामी समिति के सदस्यों के द्वारा दिनांक- **08.10.2026, 15.10.2026 एवं 22.10.2026** को तथा प्रत्येक सप्ताह के (गुरुवार) तथा सार्वजनिक अवकाश रहने पर उसके अगले कार्य दिवस को रतम-8, 7 एवं 8 के अनुसार पूर्वाह्न 11 बजे से खरमनचक स्थित सहायक आयुक्त महानिषेध कार्यालय कमांडरुष, भागलपुर में नीलामी की जायेगी। तीन बार नीलामी के उपरांत बचे हुए वाहनों के मूल्य को प्रत्येक नीलामी में 10% कम करते हुए "जहाँ है, जैसे है" के आधार पर तब तक नीलामी की जानी है, जब तक वाहन नीलाम न हो जाए। सर्वोच्च बोली वाले ही नीलाम वाहन के क्रेता होंगे। यह आम सूचना निम्नांकित सूची में अंकित वाहनों के स्वामी के लिए भी सूचना है कि इन वाहनों को नीलामी हेतु योग्य घोषित किया जा चुका है। वाहनों का निर्धारित मूल्य / वाहन का प्रकार एवं जन्म वाहनों के अधिरक्षा का स्थान (रतम-04) निम्नांकित है:-

-- सातवीं, आठवीं एवं नौवीं नीलामी हेतु वाहनों से संबंधित विवरणी--
कड़िका- (क)

क्र० सं०	अधिहरण वाद संख्या	वाहन का नाम / वाहन का निबन्धन सं०	थाना का नाम (अधिरक्षा का स्थान) / काण्ड सं० / काण्ड दिनांक	अंतिम रूप से निर्धारित मूल्य	आठवीं नीलामी हेतु अंतिम रूप से निर्धारित मूल्य का 40% की कमी कर अंकित राशि	आठवीं नीलामी हेतु अंतिम रूप से निर्धारित मूल्य का 50% की कमी कर अंकित राशि	नौवीं नीलामी हेतु अंतिम रूप से निर्धारित मूल्य का 60% की कमी कर अंकित राशि	वाहन स्वामी / प्रतिवादी का नाम	अनुमति
1	68/2023-24	महिन्द्रा रेक्सटॉन आरएलएफ0 270. एक्सएमडी07 और एक्स 7 DL10CG-0907	अजीयक 53/23 27-05-2023	6,00,000	3,60,000	3,00,000	2,40,000	शिवय कुमार, पेट-सुबौर शर्म, आर०/ओ०-255, निवर मेन मार्केट, मजनुपुरा, नौबं ईस्ट, दिल्ली, पिन न०-110053। तथा राधा-पैदानपुरा, कॉलोनोम, भागलपुर, पिन न०-813203।	

-- आठवीं, नौवीं एवं दसवीं नीलामी हेतु वाहनों से संबंधित विवरणी--
कड़िका- (ख)

क्र० सं०	अधिहरण वाद संख्या	वाहन का नाम / वाहन का निबन्धन सं०	थाना का नाम (अधिरक्षा का स्थान) / काण्ड सं० / काण्ड दिनांक	अंतिम रूप से निर्धारित मूल्य	आठवीं नीलामी हेतु अंतिम रूप से निर्धारित मूल्य का 40% की कमी कर अंकित राशि	आठवीं नीलामी हेतु अंतिम रूप से निर्धारित मूल्य का 50% की कमी कर अंकित राशि	नौवीं नीलामी हेतु अंतिम रूप से निर्धारित मूल्य का 60% की कमी कर अंकित राशि	वाहन स्वामी / प्रतिवादी का नाम	अनुमति
1									
2	94/2024-25	EICHER PRO 2095 XP ट्रक DL1MB-1526	उत्पाद (नगरविभाग) 688/2024 05-10-2024	18,00,000	9,00,000	7,20,000	5,40,000	शशिभूषण कुमार, पेट-शो पोखार, रा०-एच०/ओ०-10, माता वाली मल्ली, सहोद भारत सिंह, कनवाल नगर, उत्तर-पूर्वी, दिल्ली, पिन न०-110094।	

1. विशेष जानकारी हेतु सहायक आयुक्त महानिषेध, भागलपुर के कार्यालय से सम्पर्क स्थापित कर सकते हैं तथा अधिक जानकारी के लिये भागलपुर जिला के वेबसाइट www.bhagalpur.bih.nic.in पर जानकारी प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

विस्तृत जानकारी www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

जिला दण्डाधिकारी,
—सह—
समाहर्ता, भागलपुर

PR. No. 011971 (Excise) 2026-27

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

Food regulator considers ban on analogue paneer

Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, September 18

THE COUNTRY'S apex food regulator, Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) is considering a nationwide ban on analogue paneer — a non-dairy product where the milk constituents such as milk fats and milk protein are substituted with vegetable oil, fats, vegetable proteins.

A senior official confirmed that consultations on a regulation for such paneer is under way and a draft is likely to be put out soon.

At least eight states — including Karnataka, Gujarat, and Maharashtra — have already implemented a similar ban at the state-level.

The issue came into focus last year after social media posts about 'fake paneer' being served at a Mumbai restaurant owned by entrepreneur Gauri Khan went viral.

Afterwards, the food regulator met stakeholders and asked whether the foods prepared using vegetable-oil based 'paneer' should clearly state terms such as 'non-dairy' and 'analogue' and then describe its constituents.

For example, 'Analogue of Cheese (Milk Solids, Refined Palm Oil, Hydrogenated Vegetable fat, Modified Starch, Emulsifier)'.

While labelling norms of the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India already state that restaurants must always provide details of the foods they are selling, the food regulator also asked whether menu cards should specifically mention whether the paneer or cheese being used are "non-dairy" or "analogue".

The food regulator's dairy products standard states that the raw materials for paneer should be milk and milk solids — and it may only contain acidulants such as lactic acid, citric acid, malic acid, vinegar, glucono delta lactone, sour whey, salt, and spices or condiments. It does not allow for vegetable oil, fats, vegetable proteins.

According to the official in know of the matter, the regulator is also considering whether or not to allow the sale of the vegetable-oil based paneer if it goes by a different name.

Last year, the food regulator had also considered whether or not there should be a prohibition on the sale of these items in the loose form.

Another suggestion is to register all manufacturers of dairy analogues. Usually, smaller food manufacturers with an annual turnover of less than 12 lakhs or a capacity of less than 100 kgs/litres per day do not have to register with the food regulator.

FSSAI initiates legal action against Nestlé

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 18

THE FOOD Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) has initiated three adjudication cases against Nestlé for promoting its infant formula in a way that increases its saleability.

The apex food regulator on Friday said the Swiss food and beverage company's Nan Excellence Pro Stage 1 infant formula claimed to contain whey protein and 5 HMOs (human milk oligosaccharides, or enzymes found in mother's milk). Another product, Lactogen Pro 1, claimed to have whey protein that is easy to digest.

"FSSAI examined the mentioned infant nutrition products and their promotional material available on e-commerce platforms," the regulator said, adding that these claims violated regulations. FSSAI regulations mandate products "to not have picture, graphic material or phrases" that's designed to increase the saleability of the infant milk substitute.

It also discourages terms like 'humanised' or 'maternalised' that give the impression that infant food is an equivalent for or better than mother's milk.

For the violation of the latter rule, FSSAI invoked the Infant Milk Substitutes, Feeding

Bottles and Infant Foods (IMS) Act, 1992. A sample of the formula was also found sub-standard with respect to biotin content. The FSSAI regulations of infant food states that they should contain 75 to 50 µg of biotin (a water-soluble vitamin).

These developments have led to three adjudication cases against Nestlé. "This is a very encouraging development," said Dr Arun Gupta, chief coordinator of Breastfeeding Promotion Network of India. "Nestlé is one of the bigger producers of infant formula... the move sends a signal to others to follow suit," he added.

The FSSAI began its probe after a 2024 investigation by the Swiss NGO Public Eye found that Nestlé infant formula and baby milk products in lower-income countries, including India, contained more sugar than those sold in Europe.

Responding to the cases, Nestlé India spokesperson said: "Our products are fully compliant with all the applicable regulations. The said products and their labels were approved by the expert committee of FSSAI."

"We confirm our adherence to regulations, including norms and label declarations as per laws. We will continue to work closely with FSSAI," the spokesperson added.

Gondhal is India's official Oscar entry, its director says 'nervous but ready'

Dipanita Nath
Pune, September 18

AS IT sank in that his film, *Gondhal*, was India's official entry for the 99th Academy Awards, Santosh Davakhar became aware of "the huge responsibility". He had been informed the declaration would happen on September 18 or 19 and had been searching on Google from afternoon when people started calling him about the honour.

The Film Federation of India (FFI) announced on Friday that the Marathi film *Gondhal* was chosen as India's of-

A poster of Gondhal

ficial entry to the 2027 Oscars. "India and FFI have shown their faith in our team and our product. I am feeling very nervous but we are ready for the campaign. We have already hired most of the media and PR team in Los Angeles," said Davakhar, who is based in Sinnar, Nashik.

Gondhal is a Marathi thriller that unfolds around the traditional Gondhal ritual and folk-

performance tradition of Maharashtra. It won the award for the Best Director and Best Cinematographer at the 24th Pune International Film Festival (PIFF) in 2026.

Davakhar also won the Silver Peacock for Best Director at the 56th International Film Festival of India (IFFI) in 2025. "After the IFFI award, I became very confident about the film. When I visited international film festivals, I had the impression that Indian films revolve around poverty and marginalisation. These are important issues but I also feel that India has a rich heritage and culture and we must represent this in our cinema," he said.

Davakhar is a project consultant by profession. A social activist, he started his career as a professor. His CV includes a screenplay writing short course from the Film Television Institute of India. His previous short movie, *Adhnyat*, revolves around class distinctions in the world and won several prizes internationally. Among his other works is directing a government ad film for a cashless economy.

Davakhar is already working on his next film, about Shahaji Raju, the father of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj. "His life was full of struggle. That's why I want to represent it," he said.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Salman, S/o Nafisuddin R/o H.No.1334, Gali No.14, Rajeev Gandhi Nagar, Mustafabad, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.89/2021 u/s 498A/406/506/34 IPC & 3/4 D.P. Act, P.S. Bhajanpura, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Salman** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Salman** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Salman** of **FIR No.89/2021 u/s 498A/406/506/34 IPC & 3/4 D.P. Act, P.S. Bhajanpura, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.11.2026**.

By Order,
Ms. Rishika Shrivastava
Judicial Magistrate First Class (Mahila Court-01)
North-East District, Court No.67
4th Floor, Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/13125/NE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. PC. /84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Tara Chand, S/o Babu Lal R/o A-7/115, SS Nagar, WPIA, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.643/2022 u/s 188 IPC, P.S. Ashok Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Tara Chand** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Tara Chand** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Tara Chand** of **FIR No.643/2022 u/s 188 IPC, P.S. Ashok Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Upasana Satija
Chief Judicial Magistrate, North-West
Room No. 106, First Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/12839/NW/2026

epaper.indianexpress.com



भवन निर्माण विभाग

विद्युत कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय

विद्युत भवन प्रमंडल, मुजफ्फरपुर

अति-अल्पकालिन कोटेशन आमंत्रण सूचना सं०-14 वर्ष 2026-27

इस कार्यालय के अंतर्गत निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु निर्माण/अपूर्तिकर्ता/अधिकृत एजेंसी/पर्याप्त अनुभव रखने वाले संवेदको से दर उद्धरण मुहरबंद कोटेशन दिनांक-28.09.2026 को अपराह्न 3.00 बजे तक अयोधस्ताक्षरी के कार्यालय में आमंत्रित किया जाता है। सरकारी संस्थानों में कार्य अनुभव प्राप्त संवेदको को प्राथमिकता दी जायेगी। सभी प्राप्त कोटेशन उसी तिथि को अपराह्न 3.30 बजे कोटेशनदाताओं या उनके द्वारा प्राधिकृत प्रतिनिधियों के सक्षम खोली जायेगी। कोटेशनदाता स्थल निरीक्षण के पश्चात् ही कोटेशन समर्पित करेंगे। उक्त कार्य के बारे में विस्तृत जानकारी, रूपरेखा एवं अन्य सूचनाएँ किसी भी कार्य दिवस में अयोहस्ताक्षरी के कार्यालय या वेबसाइट www.prdbihar.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी

Sl. No.	Name Of work.	Time of Completion
1.	SITC of 500 KVA Outdoor CSS Transformer at BKPI Pugn in District Sitamarhi.	03 Month

(ई० बलवीर चन्द्र भारती)

विद्युत कार्यपालक अभियंता

विद्युत भवन प्रमंडल मुजफ्फरपुर

भवन निर्माण विभाग

PR- 011957 (BCD) 2026-27

विस्तृत सूचना www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर भी देखी जा सकती है।

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार



कार्यालय नगर परिषद्, खगड़िया

E-mail:- em.npkhagaria@gmail.com

☎ 244-291608

ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना (ई-टेंडरिंग द्वारा <https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in>)

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या-20/2026-27 (ई-टेंडरिंग)

Nagar Parishad Khagaria (herein after referred as NPB) Intends to issue for Bids for Selection of NGOs/Agencies/institutions/Organization for the following work:-

Inviting Proposals for Design, Build, Construct, Install, and Commissioning of Material Recovery Facility (MRF) of 10 TPD for Dry waste along with Operation and Maintenance of the plant for 5 years on EPC Mode And Design, Build, Construct, Install, and Commissioning of Compost Plant of 42 TDP TPD for Wet Waste along with Operation and Maintenance of the Plant for 5 years on EPC Mode.

01.	Name and Address of Advertisement issuing Authority	Executive Officer, Nagar Parishad Khagaria.
02.	Date of notification for Invitation of Request for Proposal (RFP)	14.09.2026
03.	Date/Time of Commencement of Downloading the Tender document (RFP)	दिनांक-05.10.2026 को 11:00 बजे पूर्वाह्न से (सिर्फ वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in) पर
04.	Pre-Bid Conference Date	दिनांक-07.10.2026 समय 11:00 बजे पूर्वाह्न से 01:00 बजे अपराह्न तक स्थान- कार्यपालक पदाधिकारी का कार्यालय, नगर परिषद्, खगड़िया
05.	Last Date/Time of Uploading Tender Document	दिनांक-12.10.2026 को 03:00 बजे अपराह्न तक। (सिर्फ वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in) पर
06.	Last Date/Time of Submitting Document (Hard Copy)	दिनांक-13.10.2026 को 03:00 बजे अपराह्न तक। 1. नगर कार्यपालक पदाधिकारी, नगर परिषद्, खगड़िया।
07.	Date/Time of opening of Technical Bid	दिनांक-14.10.2026 को 11:00 बजे पूर्वाह्न
08.	Date/Time of Opening Financial Bid	Financial Bid Will be opened only after successful completion of technical bid.

9. कार्य का विवरण :-

क्र. सं.	निविदा का प्रकार	कार्य का नाम	प्रारंभिक राशि (रुपये में)	अग्रिम की राशि (रुपये में)	परिष्कार किए गए मूल्य (अप्रारंभिक रु. में)	Bid Processing Fee (Through online payment) (रुपये में)	कर्म अवधि
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1	Tender	Design, Build, Construct, Install, and Commissioning of Material Recovery Facility (MRF) of 10 TPD for Dry waste along with Operation and Maintenance of the plant for 5 years on EPC Mode under Nagar Parishad Khagaria	2,66,33,300.00	5,32,700.00	10,000.00	As per E-proc2	06 Months
2	Tender	Design, Build, Construct, Install, and Commissioning of Compost Plant of 42 TPD for Wet 02 Waste along with Operation and Maintenance of the Plant for 5 years on EPC Mode under Nagar Parishad Khagaria.	4,47,85,100.00	8,95,700.00	10,000.00	As per E-proc2	06 Months

नोट :- Bidders Should submit bid processing fee through Online Payment as per Amount generated on website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in

10. निविदा की वैधता अवधि :- 120 दिन (निविदा अपलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि से)।

निविदा की विस्तृत जानकारी state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

नगर कार्यपालक पदाधिकारी

नगर परिषद्, खगड़िया

PR- 012021 (B & C) 2026-27

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।



बिहार सरकार

वरीय परियोजना अभियंता का कार्यालय

बिहार राज्य पुल निर्माण निगम लि०, कार्य प्रमंडल, दरभंगा

वेबसाइट:-<http://www.brpnln.bihar.gov.in> ईमेल:-spe-darbhanga@brpnn.co.in

|| SHORT NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER ||

(केवल ई-टेंडर पद्धति के अनुसार वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)

NTT No.- BRPNNL/DBG/C009/ 1308

बिहार राज्य पुल निर्माण निगम लिमिटेड/कंवेय/राज्य सरकार/एम्.ई.एस./सी.पी.इ.ए.सी./सार्वजनिक क्षेत्र के समुचित श्रेणी में निम्नलिखित संवेदको से **SBD** अग्रसारित ई-निविदा प्रक्रिया के माध्यम से दो बीड प्रणाली (तकनीकी एवं वित्तीय) अनुरागत उल्लिखित **Construction of Toll Plaza** हेतु मंदावर पर **(Item Rate)** प्रस्ताव आमंत्रित किये जाते हैं। यदि संवेदको बिहार राज्य पुल निर्माण निगम लिमिटेड में पूर्व से निविदाएं नहीं है, तब एंटरप्रनाम के पूर्व उन्हें निगम में निविदा करवाना अनिवार्य होगा।

क्र.	जिला	कार्य का विवरण	प्रारंभिक राशि (लाख रु० में)	परिष्कार किए गए मूल्य (Online Payment) (रु० में) (अप्रारंभिक)	अग्रिम की राशि (लाख रु० में)	Bid Processing Fee (Online Payment) (रु० में) (अप्रारंभिक)	कार्य की अवधि (मास में)
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1	Saharsa	Construction of Six lane Toll Plaza At Baluaha Ghat 2-Lane Bridge Over River Gandak in Dist. Saharsa in the State of Bihar.	1465.70	10000.00	24.65	11800.00	3 मास
2		Construction of Six lane Toll Plaza on Rosera Darbhanga Road near Hathauri Ghat-2 Lane Bridge Over River Kareh	909.93	10000.00	18.20	11800.00	3 मास
3		Construction of Six lane Toll Plaza Near H.L.R.C.C. Bridge on Bishunpur Astarwel Road over Arai River	917.626	10000.00	18.35	11800.00	3 मास
4	Dar bhang	Construction of Six lane Toll Plaza Near H.L.R.C.C. Bridge on Ghanshyampur Rasiyari Road over Kamlabalan River	925.83	10000.00	18.52	11800.00	3 मास
5		Construction of Six lane Toll Plaza Near H.L.R.C.C. Bridge at 18th KM of Balia Kakodha Devna Rajakharwar Jhanjharpur road	927.45	10000.00	18.55	11800.00	3 मास
6		Construction of Six lane Toll Plaza on Rosera Baheri Singhia near. Baheri Ghat-2 Lane Bridge Over River Kareh	967.80	10000.00	19.36	11800.00	3 मास
7	Sarnast pur	R.C.C. Bridge on Hasanpur- Soharwa Satighat road near Kundal Village Over River Kareh	959.02	10000.00	19.18	11800.00	3 मास

Sl. No.	Activity	Duration
1.	Download/Upload date of bid documents	From 24.09.2026 (10:00 Hrs.) to 05.10.2026. (15:00 Hrs.) (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
2.	Pre-bid Meeting	01.10.2026 at 15:00 Hrs. (Meeting Hall of BRPNNL 7, Sardar Patel Marg, Patna – 800015)
3.	Last Date/Time for submission/ uploading of offer/Bid	05.10.2026 upto 15:00 Hrs. (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
4.	Date & time for opening of Technical Bid	05.10.2026 at 15:30 Hrs. (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
5.	Date, time and place of opening of Financial Bid	To be informed later to technically qualified bidder. (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

8. अनुमानित / प्रारंभिक राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है तथा कार्य स्थल के अनुसार निरूपण में परिवर्तन किया जा सकता है।

9. किसी भी प्रकार की जानकारी अथवा सुझाव को वेबसाइट http://www.brpnln.bihar.gov.in एवं www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर प्रकाशित किया जायेगा।

सम्पर्क पदाधिकारी का नाम:-

1 वरीय परियोजना अभियंता, मो. नं.- 9431005938

2. परियोजना अभियंता मो. नं.- 91539626510/8969698827

3. लेखापाल मो. नं.- 7261005179

वरीय परियोजना अभियंता

बिहार राज्य पुल निर्माण निगम लि०,

कार्य प्रमंडल, दरभंगा

विस्तृत जानकारी state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

PR. No.012009 (B&C) 2026-27

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA				TENDER NOTICE		
SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP/ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/CORP/ AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF VIDEO LARYNGOSCOPE ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	17.09.2026 01.10.2026	84,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentmg2020@gmail.com
2	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF OPERATING HEADLIGHT ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	17.09.2026 01.10.2026	12,50,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentmg2020@gmail.com
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaaprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in						No- 49418/HRY



Bihar Education Project Council

NOTICE INVITING RFP

(<https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in>).

I. Bihar Education Project Council (BEPC), Patna, invites "Supply of Library Books in Government Schools of Bihar for the year 2026-27".

II. The complete RFP documents can be seen on and downloaded from the website <https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in> and our official website <https://becpsa.in>

III. Schedule of Events:

Sl	Information	Details
1	RFP Issuing Authority	State Project Director, Bihar Education Project Council (BEPC)
2	RFP No. and Date of availability from e-procurement portal	RFP Reference No. BEPC/LB/2026-27/4399, Dated 15/09/2026. Available for download from 21/09/2026, 11:00 AM onwards till 07/10/2026, 3:00 PM on https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in
3	Last date for submission of written queries for clarifications	25/09/2026, 02:30 PM Email: ssabihar@gmail.com
4	Date of pre-bid conference	25/09/2026, 03:30 PM at through online mode: Google Meet joining info Video call link: https://meet.google.com/tnt-yoe-e-kzs e-mail: ssabihar@gmail.com
5	Release of response to clarifications	26/09/2026, 5:00 PM
6	Last date of submission of bid	07/10/2026, 4:00 PM
7	Last date of submission of Hard copy of EMD	07/10/2026, 4:00 PM
8	Last date of submission of Sample (Before bid submission closing date & Time)	07/10/2026, 4:00 PM
9	Opening of Technical Bids	07/10/2026, 4:30 PM
10	Opening of Financial Bids	To be intimated
11	Contact person for queries	State Project Director, Bihar Education Project Council (BEPC), Shiksha Bhawan, Bihar Rashtra Bhasha Parishad Campus, Saidpur - 800 004. e-mail: ssabihar@gmail.com

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

State Project Director
Bihar Education Project Council

PR. No. 012015 (B&C) 2026-27

बिहार में शराब का व्यापार, विक्री एवं सेवन अवैध है।
इससे संबंधित शिकायत इस नंबर पर दर्ज कराये, आपकी जानकारी गुप्त रखी जाएगी।
टॉल फ्री नं- 15545 या 1800 345 6268



जल संसाधन विभाग

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय

सिंचाई यंत्रिक प्रमंडल, मोहनियाँ

कोटेशन आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या -11/2026-27

(केवल ई-कोटेशन पद्धति के अनुसार वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)

1. कार्य का विवरण :-

पु. सं.	कार्य का नाम	प्रारंभिक राशि (लाख रु० में)	अग्रिम की राशि (लाख रु० में)	परिष्कार किए गए मूल्य (अप्रारंभिक रु० में)	केन्द्रीय की देय किं प्रोसेसिंग की (अप्रारंभिक) (रु० में)	कार्य अवधि की अवधि
1	Design, Supply, Fabrication, Fitting, Fixing, Installation, Transportation, Er ection, Testing & Commissioning of 04 Set 500 H.P Centrifugal Pump With C.I. Casing S.S. CF8M Impeller of 60 Cusec Capacity Each, 16 Meter Head approx & Motor Driven 03 phase 11 KV, 50 HZ AC Foot Mounted Spiral Case Induction Motor having Enclosure as per SPDP/TEFC as per Specification in Pump House Including Other Allied Mechanical & Electrical Component With Operation & Maintenance Of Entire System For Five Year With Defect Liability Period For Renovation Of Bahura Pump Canal Project, Bahura in Kaimur District.	1788.60722 (Tentative)	1789000 (FIXED)	10,000.00	As applicable	12 मास

2. कोटेशन आमंत्रण सूचना गिरित करने की तिथि :- दिनांक :-16-09-2026

3. कोटेशन खगवाज डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की तिथि:- दिनांक-16.10.2026से दिनांक-27.10.2026के 3.00 बजे अपराह्न तक (सिर्फ वेबसाइट-www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)

4. प्री-बिड मीटिंग का समय, स्थान एवं तिथि :- दिनांक-22.10.2026के 4.00बजे अपराह्न में मुख्य अभियंता (यंत्रिक) का कार्यालय, जल संसाधन विभाग, पटना।

5. तकनीकी बिड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :- दिनांक-30.10.2026समय 3.30 बजे अपराह्न।

6. वित्तीय बिड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :- दिनांक-30.10.2026समय 3.30 बजे अपराह्न।

7. कोटेशन खोलने का स्थान :- www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर

8. कोटेशन की वैधता अवधि :- 120 दिन

9. निष्ठापनाका का पदनाम एवं पता :- कार्यपालक अभियंता, (यंत्रिक) सिंचाई यंत्रिक प्रमंडल, मोहनियाँ।
मो नं: 8285653609

विशेष जानकारी प्राप्त करने हेतु वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in एवं [https://wrd.bihar.gov.in/state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar](http://wrd.bihar.gov.in/state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar) पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता (यंत्रिक)

सिंचाई यंत्रिक प्रमंडल, मोहनियाँ

Mob:- 8285653609

PR- 012035 (WRD) 2026-27

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।



Bihar Education Project Council

NOTICE INVITING RFP

(<https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in>).

I. Bihar Education Project Council (BEPC), Patna, invites "Request for Proposal (RFP) for Supply of Student Kit for Class I-IV Students of Government Schools in Bihar".

II. The complete RFP documents can be seen on and downloaded from the website <https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in> and our official website <https://becpsa.in>

III. Schedule of Events:

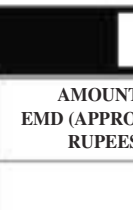
Sl	Information	Details
1	RFP Issuing Authority	State Project Director, Bihar Education Project Council (BEPC)
2	RFP No. and Date of availability from e-procurement portal	RFP Reference No. BEPC/FLN-SK/2026-27/4400, Dated 15/09/2026. Available for download from 21/09/2026, 11:00 AM onwards till 08/10/2026, 3:00 PM on https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in
3	Last date for submission of written queries for clarifications	25/09/2026, 02:30 PM Email: ssabihar@gmail.com
4	Date of pre-bid conference	25/09/2026, 05:00 PM at through online mode: Google Meet joining info Video call link: https://meet.google.com/tnt-yoe-e-kzs e-mail: ssabihar@gmail.com
5	Release of response to clarifications	26/09/2026, 5:00 PM
6	Last date of submission of bid	08/10/2026, 4:00 PM
7	Last date of submission of Hard copy of EMD	08/10/2026, 4:00 PM
8	Last date of submission of Sample (Before bid submission closing date & Time)	08/10/2026, 4:00 PM
9	Opening of Technical Bids	08/10/2026, 4:30 PM
10	Opening of Financial Bids	To be intimated
11	Contact person for queries	State Project Director, Bihar Education Project Council (BEPC), Shiksha Bhawan, Bihar Rashtra Bhasha Parishad Campus, Saidpur - 800 004. e-mail: ssabihar@gmail.com

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

State Project Director
Bihar Education Project Council

PR. No. 012014 (B&C) 2026-27

बिहार में शराब का व्यापार, विक्री एवं सेवन अवैध है।
इससे संबंधित शिकायत इस नंबर पर दर्ज कराये, आपकी जानकारी गुप्त रखी जाएगी।
टॉल फ्री नं- 15545 या 1800 345 6268



RAJENDRA UNIVERSITY

RAJNA VIHAR, BALANGIR – 767002, ODISHA [INDIA]

e-mail: rajendrauniversitybgr@gmail.com

11001/321/2627

Ref. No. 2152 /RUB

Date: 09.09.2026

Invitation of Bids

Sealed tenders are invited from intending reputed public sector organization such as State PSU/ Central PSU/Departmental Undertaking herein after referred to as Project Management Consultant (PMC) for Rajendra University, Prajna Vihar, Balangir as mentioned in the Performa as per our terms and conditions so as to reach the undersigned on or before Dt.05.10.2026 by 11.30 AM through Speed Post/ Registered Post only and which will be opened on the prescribed date & time in presence of the party or their authorized representative (if any). The sealed cover should be super scribed with “Engagement of State PSU / Central PSU / Departmental Undertaking as Project Management Consultant for Construction of different Buildings initially which can be further extended subject to approval and sanction from the Govt. of Odisha”. Rajendra University reserve all the right to cancel any or all tenders without assigning any reason thereof. The Performa, terms and conditions can be obtained from the University website: www.rajendrauniversity.ac.in

Sd/-
Registrar
Rajendra University, Balangir

OIPR- 11001/11411/1/26-27/0003



BIHAR SCHOOL EXAMINATION BOARD

NOTICE FOR BLOCKCHAIN SOLUTION WORKSHOP

The Bihar School Examination Board (BSEB), Patna hereby invites participation from reputed Technology Solution Providers, OEMs, System Integrators and Experts for a constructive workshop on "Blockchain-Based Solution encompassing the end-to-end examination process."

The workshop will provide an opportunity for technical deliberations on the proposed solution, including functional requirements, solution architecture, security, integration, scalability, interoperability and implementation approach.

Date: 24 September 2026, Time: 11:00 AM

Venue: Bihar School Examination Board, Patna

Email ID: eproc-bseb-bih@gov.in/ eproc.bseb@gmail.com

Interested organizations/experts having relevant experience may participate and present their proposed technical approach and solution architecture.

Note: All interested participants are requested to kindly confirm their participation via email to facilitate the necessary arrangements.

Notice No.- PR 214 / 2026

Secretary



RAJENDRA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES, RANCHI

(An Autonomous Institute under Govt. of Jharkhand)

Ranchi, Jharkhand

Letter No: 2636

Date: 16-09-2026

Corrigendum Regarding Extension of last date of application submission vide Advertisement No. 2572 / dated 08-09-2026

With reference to Advertisement No. 2572 dated 08.09.2026, issued by the Institute for filling up the vacant posts of Assistant Professor, the last date for submission of applications, which was earlier 30.09.2026, has been extended to **15.10.2026**.

The proposal has received approval from the competent authority.

Detailed advertisement can be seen in www.rimsranchi.ac.in

Last Date of Application: 15-10-2026

Sd/-
Dean,
Rajendra Institute of Medical Sciences, Ranchi

PR.NO.389944 Rajendra Institute of Medical Sciences(26-27):D

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA				TENDER NOTICE		
SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP/ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP/AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HSAMB BHIWANI	SIR OF 7 NOS LINK ROADS FROM VILLAGE UNN TO KATERA (ID-485), JAISHREE TO KAMOD (ID-490), GHAKARA SCHOOL TO DABRISAHUWAS ROAD (ID-495), GHIKARA TO MURCH (ID-492), KADMA TO DHANU BHALOTIA (ID-461), APPROACH ROAD UPTO SPORTS STADIUM CHANDWA (ID-472) AND NORAGANGAS JATTAN TO BADERA VIA SHYAM BABA MANDIR (ID- 8593) IN DABRI AND BADERA CONSTY. DISTT. CH DADRI (WORK PLAN FOR THE YEAR 2026-27) + 1 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 24.09.2026	2,45,55,446/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01664247282 ecbhiwani2025hsamb@gmail.com
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaaprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in						No- 49420/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA				TENDER NOTICE		
SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP/ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP/AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION FARIDABAD	HIRING OF SEATER MOBILE TOILETS FOR FARIDABAD HALF MARATHON-2026 SURAJKUND MELA, FARIDABAD ON 27/09/2026	17.09.2026 22.09.2026	04.33 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01292411649 mcfamruti@gmail.com
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaaprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in						No- 49424/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA				TENDER NOTICE		
SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP/ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP/AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HSAMB KATHAL	CONSTRUCTION OF CENTRE OF EXCELLENCE FOR VERTICAL FARMING AT CHEEKA, DISTT. KATHAL + 1 WORKS	17.09.2026 06.10.2026	2,53,74,028/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9416178720 xenkathal4.hsamb@gmail.com
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaaprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in						No- 49427/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA				TENDER NOTICE		
SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP/ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP/AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	GMDA GURUGRAM	CONSTRUCTION OF SERVICE ROAD FOR DIVIDING SECTOR 106/09, GURUGRAM AND ALL OTHER WORKS CONTINGENT THERETO. + 1 WORKS	15.09.2026 29.09.2026	19,42,37,180/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8595330024 xen1.gmda@gmda.gov.in
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaaprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in						

• KARNATAKA PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

What led to KPSC chairman’s ouster: Leaked papers, a job for his daughter

Johnson T A
Bengaluru, September 18

FROM QUESTION papers leaked to a select group of candidates to the alleged illegal selection of its chairman’s daughter, the Karnataka Public Service Commission (KPSC) is mired in controversy over two major recruitment scandals. Its chairman Shivashankarappa S Sahukar has been suspended even as the state police’s Criminal Investigation Department (CID) is probing multiple allegations of nepotism and corruption.

One case relates to the recruitment of the KPSC chief’s daughter Suma Sahukar (28) to the post of industrial extension officer in the state industries and commerce department under the OBC quota, allegedly using a fake income certificate.

The second case, in which the chairman’s anticipatory bail was rejected on September 7 amid CID investigations, concerns the recruitment of 400 veterinary doctors, where 29 of the selected candidates, including another alleged relative of the chairman, are accused of receiving the question paper a day before the exam.

Both cases, in which selection began in 2024 and was completed in July this year, are before the Karnataka High Court. BJP MLA Basanagouda Patil Yatnal has sought

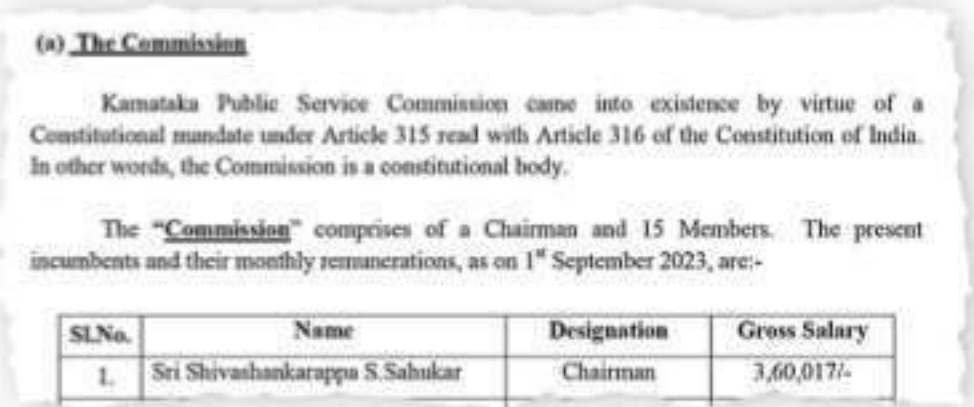
a CBI probe into Suma’s recruitment, while an affected candidate in the other case, Dr Manjunath (30), has sought a probe by the central agency into the veterinarians’ recruitment. The court has barred coercive police action against some of the 29 alleged beneficiaries and reserved its verdict on the CBI-probe demand.

On September 7, the CID told the High Court that Sahukar was allegedly in frequent contact via internet calls with middleman and self-styled BJP worker Basavaraj Kannale, who allegedly leaked the veterinarians’ exam paper along with the arrested KPSC controller of exams, IAS officer Gyanendra Kumar Gangwar. Gangwar has been arrested and the KPSC chairman questioned by the CID three times in the case.

Job for chairman’s daughter

Hearing BJP MLA Yatnal’s plea on July 20, the High Court observed that the allegations, if true, “have the potential to erode the sanctity of a constitutional institution entrusted with one of the most solemn public functions — the recruitment of meritorious candidates into the civil services of the State”.

According to the FIR filed on July 10 by a KPSC representative, the Commission had called for recruitment to 50 posts of Industrial Extension Officers in March 2024.



Sahukar’s daughter Suma applied under the OBC III B category, wrote the exam in July 2025, and was selected in January 2026. During document verification in February this year, she allegedly produced an income certificate showing Rs 40,000 annual family income, as per the FIR registered for forgery and fraud.

However, the FIR said, her father became a KPSC member on September 3, 2019 at Rs 2.05 lakh a month, and chairman on April 5, 2021 at Rs 2.25 lakh a month. KPSC records show Sahukar’s gross monthly salary as chairman was Rs 3.60 lakh in 2023 — more than Rs 42 lakh a year, over 100 times what Suma claimed was her family’s annual income.

Suma was granted conditional anticipatory bail on July 24. Her father was suspended by Governor Thaawarchand

KPSC records show the salary of its chairman Shivashankarappa S Sahukar in 2023. His daughter had declared the annual family income as Rs 40,000, police said.

Gehlot on August 25, on the state cabinet’s recommendation.

Fraud in posts for veterinarians

In an FIR filed on July 24, 2026, against Sahukar and two unnamed KPSC members, Dr Manjunath and 24 others alleged they were wrongly denied selection to 400 veterinarian posts announced in 2024. The FIR states 29 candidates scored abnormally high marks in the January 2026 test, including an alleged relative of the KPSC chairman. The complaint alleges the paper was leaked beforehand. The CID probe has allegedly found candidates paid up to Rs 80 lakh to middlemen, were housed at resorts and hotels, coached on answers, and driven to exam centres on the day.

Hearing Manjunath’s plea on July 29,

the High Court said: “The complaint, therefore, paints a picture of a recruitment exercise that, if the allegations ultimately withstand judicial scrutiny, would disclose not sporadic irregularities but a systematic assault upon the constitutional mandate governing public employment.”

Third complaint, political fallout

A third FIR, filed in July, alleges that candidates’ confidential details were leaked to middlemen even before the process concluded, with offers made “in exchange for enormous sums of money”, including one aspirant allegedly offered OMR-sheet changes for Rs 80 lakh. The purported recordings of such offers were given to police via a complaint filed on May 29, 2026.

Sahukar was appointed KPSC member and chairman during the BJP’s 2019-2023 tenure. BJP MLA Yatnal, a bitter political rival of party colleague B S Yediyurappa, has said that Sahukar was appointed by the former CM as he was a relative. Yatnal also called the subsequent Congress government’s registration of the case as an “eyewash”.

BJP state president and Yediyurappa’s son B Y Vijayendra said there was “no question of backing anybody who was guilty”.

Congress leader and the state’s Home Minister Priyank Karge said his government is committed to “upholding the integrity and credibility of the public recruitment process” and that the CID’s involvement would “inspire confidence among lakhs of aspirants”.

The CID probe has also raised questions about the KPSC’s recent recruitment of 38 Karnataka Administrative Service gazetted probationers, for which over two lakh aspirants appeared for the 2024 preliminary exam — after documents relating to some candidates surfaced during searches on arrested middleman Kannale.

Another CID probe is underway into a complaint over a shortlisted Karnataka Administrative Service (KAS) aspirant being allegedly favoured by a KPSC member during the interview process in May 2026.

This is not the first time that the KPSC has come under the scanner.

It has seen politically driven appointments for years, with major recruitment scams coming to light in 1998, 1999, 2004 and 2011 involving A K Monappa, a secretary, H N Krishna, a chairman, Mangala Sridhar, a member, and Gonal Bheemappa, a chairman. Following the latest scandal, former Karnataka CM, leader of the JD(S) and Union minister H D Kumaraswamy has sought the disbanding of the KPSC.

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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

• WILDLIFE

A Himalayan bird’s calls are changing due to human noise: Why this matters

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
Dehradun, September 18

THE HIMALAYAN monal, the state bird of Uttarakhand, is a striking-looking landfowl found across the Himalayan mountains, including in Jammu and Kashmir, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand and Sikkim.

While the ground-dwelling bird is not endangered, a study carried out by researchers at Hemvathi Bahuguna Garhwal University (HBGU) has found that the bird is changing its calls — because tourism and traffic are making its surroundings noisier. This could have implications for its success in mating, though the researchers, Rajeev Lochan, Dinesh Kumar Sharma and Anand Kumar, have not established this.

What did the study show?

To study the monal’s calls, the researchers used passive acoustic monitoring devices, along with a microphone, across different seasons. They compared two areas within the Kedarnath Musk Deer Sanctuary — the Madmaheshwar Valley, which has relatively little human activity, and Chopta Valley, which has roads, tourists, pilgrims and other visitors. They recorded hundreds of monal calls and compared them. The striking finding was that monals in the noisier area used higher-frequency calls.



WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

A Himalayan monal.

Chopta has a tendency to call with more frequency and amplitude. In Madmaheshwar valley, it was relatively less. The reason is that there is human-made noise, either through transportation or the heavy footfall from the pilgrimage,” co-author Anand Kumar, an assistant professor at HBGU’s Department of Zoology, told *The Indian Express*.

The study found that this difference was particularly strong at the higher end of the birds’ call frequencies. The researchers say this suggests that the monal has some ability to adjust its calls to its surroundings.

Why is this important?

For the monal, calls are important for communication, including reproduction and social behaviour. The researchers worry that increasing human noise could make such communication more difficult. “The male makes the mating call and the female responds to that call,” co-author Lochan told *The Indian Express*. But with more tourism and noise, “it will not be able to reach females, because it will be masked with noise.” The researchers say more work is needed to understand what the changes in calls mean for the monal’s breeding and survival. The study does not say that only tourism is affecting the monal’s calls, but calls for better management of noise in heavily visited areas. The answer, they say, is not to stop tourism, but to manage how human activity affects these landscapes.

• CORPORATE

What next for Tata after boardroom showdown



GEORGE MATHEW

THE TATA Sons board meeting on Thursday was expected to resolve some of the biggest questions confronting the holding company of the Tata group. Instead, it has opened a new chapter in an increasingly bitter power struggle.

The board approved a fresh five-year term for N Chandrasekaran as Executive Chairman despite Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata voting against the proposal. It also decided to proceed with the listing of Tata Sons after the Reserve Bank of India rejected the company’s request to surrender its registration as a Core Investment Company.

Both decisions face another test — the annual general meeting (AGM). And that is where the balance of power changes dramatically. Tata Trusts hold 66% of Tata Sons. Noel Tata has opposed Chandrasekaran’s continuation and has argued that the company should remain unlisted. But Venu Srinivasan, the other Tata Trusts nominee on the Tata Sons board, backed both decisions. The result is a potentially prolonged battle involving the board, Tata Trusts, the AGM, the Articles of Association, and the RBI. Here’s what lies ahead.

What happened at the board meet?

The board meeting reversed the course that had been set in August. Chandrasekaran had informed the Tata Sons board on August 12 that he would not offer himself for another term after his current tenure ends on February 20, 2027. But on September 3, the Nomination and Remuneration Committee of Tata Sons met and unanimously recommended that Chandrasekaran reconsider his decision.

On September 17, Chandrasekaran agreed to reconsider. The board voted to re-

appoint him for another five years. Four directors backed the proposal: Venu Srinivasan, Harish Manwani, Anita M George, and Saurabh Agrawal. Noel Tata voted against it. Chandrasekaran did not vote.

The same four directors also backed the decision to proceed with Tata Sons’ listing, while Noel Tata opposed it. The decisions therefore represent a majority of the six-member board, but not a consensus. More importantly, the September 17 vote has brought the disagreement between the Tata Sons board and Tata Trusts into the open.

Noel Tata has challenged the legality of the board’s decision itself. Tata Trusts said the Articles of Association require the support of the Trusts’ nominee directors for the appointment or reappointment of the chairman. Noel Tata also placed before the board a legal opinion from former Chief Justice of India D Y Chandrachud supporting the Trusts’ position on the requirement of backing of their nominee directors.

That means the September 17 resolution may now become the subject of further corporate and legal proceedings.

Why will the AGM be crucial?

The next battleground is the Tata Sons AGM. The board can recommend and approve a reappointment, but the shareholders’ meeting has an important role to play in the process: they can accept these proposals or reject them. Chandrasekaran’s directorship itself was due for renewal at the AGM, and he needs to remain a director to continue as chairman through the end of his present tenure.

This makes the AGM critical to Chandrasekaran’s future. But there is a major complication: there is currently no clear date for the AGM. The earlier AGM, scheduled for August 18, could not proceed because of a lack of quorum. Under the Articles of Association, at least five members have to be present and the quorum has to include an authorised representative jointly nominated by the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust and the Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT).

The problem arose after the Charity Com-



SANKHADEEP BANERJEE

Tata Sons chairman N Chandrasekaran.

Rift in group

The rift between management and controlling shareholders threatens to stall resolutions on strategic priorities.

Insiders say there is a sense of uncertainty among senior directors over each others’ intentions and the group’s direction.

missioner’s order in May restricted the SRTT from conducting its board proceedings. Without a properly convened SRTT board meeting, it cannot make the joint nomination required for the AGM quorum.

Even though the September 17 board meeting has put Chandrasekaran’s reappointment on the table again, the shareholders cannot immediately have their say. When the AGM eventually takes place, Tata Trusts’ 66% holding becomes critical. Noel Tata may have lost the board vote 4-1. But the shareholder arithmetic is very different.

The question therefore is not merely whether the Tata Sons board supports Chandrasekaran. It is whether the reappointment can survive the shareholder process and the objections raised by Tata Trusts. That makes the next AGM potentially one of the most consequential shareholder meetings in Tata Sons’ history.

What about the listing of Tata Sons?

The second major decision on September 17 concerns the future ownership structure of Tata Sons. The RBI last week rejected Tata Sons’ request to surrender its registration and remain outside the regulatory frame-

work applicable to it. Tata Sons had sought to remain a private, unlisted company.

Tata Sons has been classified as an upper-layer NBFC since September 2022. The RBI decision effectively means that the company has to address the regulatory requirements applicable to it, including the implications for listing. The September 17 board has now decided to proceed with the necessary steps for listing rather than challenge the RBI decision. But that does not mean an IPO is around the corner. A listing would involve a long regulatory and corporate process.

There is also a fundamental disagreement over what a listed Tata Sons would mean for the Tata group. Noel Tata has argued that listing would fundamentally alter the character of Tata Sons.

But the September 17 board decision has now formally put the company on the listing path. There is another important shareholder dimension. The Shapoorji Pallonji group owns about 18.37% of Tata Sons and has favoured a listing.

What happens next?

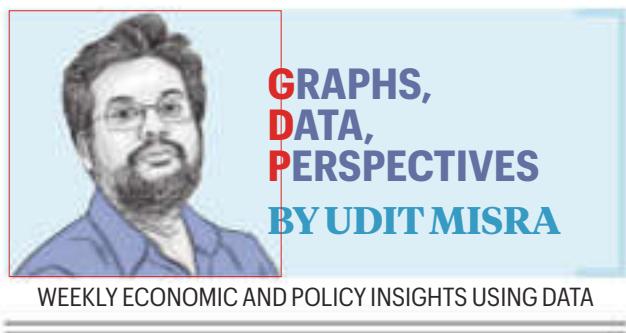
The immediate future of Tata Sons is likely to be dominated by three parallel processes — the AGM, the Chandrasekaran succession battle, and the RBI-driven listing process. First, Tata Sons will have to resolve the procedural deadlock over its AGM. Until the quorum issue involving the SRTT is addressed, the shareholders cannot effectively settle the pending matters.

Second, Chandrasekaran’s reappointment will remain contested. The board has backed him for another five years, but Noel Tata has rejected that decision and has challenged its legality. The legal opinion obtained from Justice Chandrachud adds another dimension to the dispute.

Third, Tata Sons has to respond to the RBI’s decision. The board has chosen to move ahead with listing, while Noel Tata wants the company to explore avenues to remain private. The September 17 meeting has therefore not produced a settlement. It has clarified the fault lines. **FULL VERSION ON** WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• ECONOMICS

Hawkish or dovish? The varying interpretations of US Fed rate hike



THE FEDERAL Reserve, which controls US monetary policy, has decided to raise the Federal Funds Rate (FFR) by 25 basis points (one basis point is one-hundredth of a percentage point). It is now in the 3.75% to 4% range, up from 3.5% to 3.75%.

Raising the FFR makes it costlier for banks to borrow from each other and, thus, makes all loans extended by US banks costlier. Higher cost of credit drags down economic activity as it discourages overall demand and helps cool down prices in the economy. This decision is typically taken when a central bank is concerned about curbing inflation. It is keenly watched worldwide because tweaking credit costs also affects stock markets.

The US Fed has a dual mandate: Pursuing both price stability and maximum employment. For price stability, the Fed has a target of 2% inflation. Employment has no numerical target. Often, the Fed’s

focus is either more on curbing inflation or boosting employment, depending on what it thinks is the bigger concern. What stood out about the Fed’s decision was that it could make for a variety of interpretations.

Hawkish

A hawkish central bank or hawkish policy decision is primarily focused on maintaining price stability and not letting inflation rise above 2%. An increase in the FFR — the first in three years — suggests that new Fed Chair Kevin Warsh has seen enough price rises with the West Asia crisis and tariffs. He is even willing to go against US President Donald Trump by raising rates, months before the crucial midterm elections.

Warsh noted that while “economic activity is expanding” and “the unemployment rate has changed little”, “inflation had remained elevated”.

Not so hawkish

Another interpretation would argue that this policy isn’t all that hawkish. The table provides the Fed’s Summary of Economic Projections (SEP).

Four times a year, the Federal Reserve releases a summary of Federal Open Market Committee (FOMC) participants’ projections for GDP growth, the unemployment

• US Fed’s Summary of Economic Projections

Variable	2026	2027	2028	2029	Longer-run trend
Change in real GDP	2.3	2.4	2.2	2.1	2.0
June projection	2.2	2.3	2.2	—	2.0
Unemployment rate	4.1	4.1	4.1	4.1	4.2
June projection	4.3	4.3	4.2	—	4.2
Inflation	3.7	2.3	2.1	2.0	2.0
June projection	3.6	2.3	2.0	—	2.0
Federal Funds Rate	4.1	4.1	3.9	3.6	3.2
June projection	3.8	3.6	3.4	—	3.1

SOURCE: U.S. FEDERAL RESERVE

Two stances

- A hawkish policy decision is focused on maintaining price stability and not letting inflation rise.
- A dovish policy prioritises growth or job creation.

rate, inflation, and the appropriate policy interest rate. The FOMC is the 12-member entity that decides on monetary policy.

The table shows the median FOMC projections. The FOMC expects economic growth to be stronger than its June assessment, even higher than the long-run trend. Unemployment projections, too, are expected to be better than the long-run average.

Inflation is expected to worsen, and the FOMC does not expect it to return to its 2% level before 2029. US inflation was last under 2% in February 2021.

Given this projection, a hawkish central

bank would have signalled many more interest rate hikes, but the Fed has only pencilled in a single 25-basis-point rate hike over the next year. Many in the markets believe the Fed will have to undertake an additional three rate hikes in the next year.

Actually dovish

For these reasons, one could argue that the interest rate hike was not hawkish enough and points to a rather dovish stance. Considering that the Fed is unlikely to have chosen the October policy review for a rate hike, coming too close to the midterms, it follows that it chose the bare minimum now.

Not dovish enough

While some argue about the stance, at least one man vociferously believes that this policy decision was not dovish at all.

Trump criticised the Fed decision on Truth Social: “Interest Rates in the United States should be 1%, or less, because we are the Best Credit in the World — BY FAR. Our Country is BOOMING with new Investment... LOWER THE INTEREST RATES... AND FAST!” Earlier, too, Trump berated Warsh’s predecessor, Jerome Powell, for being “too late” to cut interest rates.

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SATURDAY, SEPTEMBER 19, 2026

13

A boardroom rebellion in Tata Sons, a modern-day Greek tragedy



COOMI KAPOOR

FOR OVER half a century, an invisible shadow has hung over the House of Tatas: The possibility of a hostile takeover. Last Thursday, the custodians of one of India's most respected and largest business conglomerates feared their worst nightmare could eventually unfold. At Thursday's Tata Sons board meeting, a majority of members, including a nominee of the Tata Trusts, businessman Venu Srinivasan, defied the chairperson of the Tata Trusts and a Tata family member, Noel Tata, to vote to retain the services of N Chandrasekaran as executive head of the group.

The rebellion reflects the vulnerability of the venerable 158-year old business house, founded by the visionary Parsi businessman Jamsetji Tata, which was at the forefront of India's industrial revolution and whose brand name is synonymous with honourable business practices and quality products.

Apprehensions of a future change in ownership first surfaced in 1969 after the government introduced the Monopolies and Restrictive Trade Practices Act, under which companies could no longer be run by a managing agency. Tata Sons, the group's managing agency, appeared to lose its relevance as its shareholding in the group's companies was minimal. The actual owners of most of the listed Tata companies were family charitable trusts, most notably the Sir Dorabji Tata and the Sir Ratanji Tata trusts. The snag is that under Section 153 A of the Companies Act of 1956, the charities commissioner is expected to appoint a public trustee to act on behalf of charities in corporate matters. A special exception was made for the Tatas since the holdings preceded the framing of the rules in independent India. Despite their token shareholding, thanks to the respect commandeered by the former



Tata chairpersons, J R D Tata and his successor, Ratan Tata, the charities commissioner never interfered in the management of Tata companies. In 2002, under the Vajpayee government, the Tata Trusts' control over the companies got formal recognition when the Companies Act was amended with Section 153 A allowing the Tata Trusts to vote directly on the Tata Sons board and not through government nominees.

Though the two main Tata trusts were in a dominant position, since together they own 66 per cent of Tata Sons, a niggling thorn in the Tata family's side was that the late construction magnate Shapoorji Pallonji Mistry had succeeded in purchasing an 18.37 per cent stake in Tata Sons. Financial journalists often claim that these share transfers date back to business dealings between Shapoorji and legendary financier F E Dinshaw in the 1930s. Actually, the shares were procured much later from Tata family members. JRD's widowed sister, Rodabeh Sawhny, sold her stake of 5.9 per cent in January 1965 with her brother's blessings. In July 1969, the Sir Ratan Tata Trust, of which Noel Tata's father, Naval, was then chair-



ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

person, raised funds by selling a 4.81 per cent stake to a Pallonji investment company. (It is speculated that the trusts sold the shares to square up IOUs from Tata companies which were originally in the possession of Dinshaw and had subsequently been taken over by Shapoorji.) The last share purchase in 1974 of 6.68 per cent from JRD's brother Dara was without JRD's consent and created a scare in the group since by then the MRTPA Act had been introduced. The Mistry family's shareholding in Tata Sons becomes of crucial importance in the current imbroglio since it is the largest holding by private individuals and not charities.

Understandably, Tata Sons has consistently stonewalled any attempt for public listing of its shares, since it opens a Pandora's box and provides an avenue for outside business interests to attempt to take over this unique business house. But while the Tata trusts are not prepared to sell their stakes, in recent years, the debt-burdened Shapoorji Pallonji Mistry group has been keen to offload some of its shares. In 2021, the Supreme Court rejected the SP group's appeal that Tata Sons buy out the SP group's stake at a court-

determined "fair" value on the grounds that Tata Sons was a private company and its Articles of Association contained strict restrictions governing transfer of shares.

Unfortunately for the Tatas, in 2021, the RBI introduced the concept of Upper Layer of NBFCs. It ruled that large, systemically important non-banking financial companies would have to be listed within three years of being notified. In September 2022, Tata Sons was classified as an NBFC listing, setting the clock ticking towards an eventual listing requirement. The group fought to stave off what seemed to most to be inevitable.

With the managing chairperson of the group, Chandrasekaran, now reappointed and the other board members also openly backing public listing of the group, Noel is fighting a lonely battle, though assisted by some of the best legal minds in the country. In a dramatic reversal of roles, the Tata Trusts are now keen to do business with the SP group (According to some media reports, the SP group has offered to sell 3 per cent of its Tata Sons stake for Rs 25,000 crore). In this modern-day Greek tragedy, many of the key Parsi players have close connections. For instance, Noel's wife Aloo is Pallonji Mistry's daughter, though the Tata shares were left only to Mistry's two sons. One of the sons, Cyrus Mistry, died in a road accident and was ruthlessly ousted as chairman of the Tata Group by Ratan, then chairman of the Tata Trusts and Noel's half brother.

In the long run, it is only the Narendra Modi government that can protect the Tatas from being taken over by rapacious outside business interests. In an interview, Cyrus once expressed this very fear to me. He wanted Ratan Tata to squarely lay down a corporate governance framework to spell out the role of Tata Sons, the role of the trusts and the role of the operating companies. Else, his apprehension was that after some years, the group could be lost to the wrong people. Noel also must rise above petty matters, to ensure that the legendary House of Tatas survives predatory assault from multiple quarters, some hidden, others not so.

Kapoor is the author of *The Tatas*, Freddie Mercury and Other Bawas

In India-China thaw, Beijing's signals for Washington



JABIN T JACOB

IN TERMS of realpolitik, it is fair to say that the 18th BRICS Summit hosted by New Delhi was really all about whether Communist Party of China General Secretary and Chinese President Xi Jinping would even make it, and then after he did, about the bilateral meeting between him and Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi. For India, this was about sustaining the thaw in bilateral ties for domestic economic reasons and about signalling to the US that it had other friends around the world and could influence those friends. For China, however, Xi's turning up in New Delhi — after skipping the 2023 G20 summit India hosted — was less about India and primarily about signalling to the US less than two weeks before he embarks on a state visit to Washington, DC.

The Modi-Xi meeting on the sidelines of the Summit saw both countries produce their own statement. Comparing the two, there are four noteworthy aspects.

One, there is the question of focus. The Chinese statement is longer than the Indian one — the English version is almost thrice as long — but this does not necessarily mean the attention is on India. On the contrary, the Chinese seem to be speaking as much to the Americans as to the Indians. While there is no substantive reference to BRICS in the Indian statement, the Chinese statement has references to "great[er] BRICS cooperation" as well as to the Global South, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the G20. If India was trying to walk a fine line between promoting its strategic autonomy through BRICS and keeping ties with the US on an even keel, China was less concerned about such niceties, using the BRICS shoulder to fire at the US.

Two, there is the different order in which each country prioritises bilateral issues. The issue of "peace and tranquility in the border areas" takes up the bulk of the Indian statement. It calls for "for both sides to observe existing agreements and understandings on border related issues". While the Chinese statement refers to "maintain[ing] peace and tranquility in the border areas" twice, there is not the same level of detailing as it has for people-to-people exchanges and multilateral cooperation. Perhaps this is because the details are available in the "Eight Points of Outcomes and Consensus" at the end of the 25th round of talks between the two Special Representatives (SRs) on the boundary question last month.

It is worth pointing out that this joint statement largely comprises promises. One such is the agreement for expert groups to discuss "Early and Substantial Harvest of boundary delimitation and Border Management" but whose definitions are not clear and terms of reference yet to be agreed on. Another is to hold a meeting "about hydrological data sharing, and renewal of relevant MoUs" — an issue that the two SRs have been discussing for at least two years.

More importantly, and three, while both statements lay out their version of what good bilateral ties should look like, the Chinese are quite specific about what India ought to do. Xi says the two countries "are partners rather than adversaries, and are each other's development opportunities rather than a threat"; should "eliminate interference"; and aim for "open and inclusive multilateral cooperation". The statement underlines the need for India to commit to a "dual-track" of advancing ties in other areas and on border issues in parallel. This is a position that India has eventually come around to following the announcement of completion of the disengagement of troops in 2024, but the Chinese clearly want more — or more accurately, less Indian insistence on border issues.

What "interference" is, is left undefined, allowing for any number of issues that can be raised to pressure India later. China also expects India to "effectively improve the public opinion base of bilateral relations", indicating as it has done frequently in recent years that critics of Chinese policies and those sceptical of the current India-China détente need to be muzzled for the sake of "positive energy" in the relationship. The Chinese have also tried to exert pressure by explicitly referring to India's "policies and positions on Taiwan and Tibet" — references absent in the Indian statement.

Fourth, China takes out insurance when it says that the view of both nations as "partners rather than adversaries... is a strategic judgment based on the stage of development and the international environment of the two countries". This position is a give-away of Chinese thinking — in domestic politics as well as in external policies, Beijing has regularly changed course depending on these factors. Today, those circumstances — a difficult domestic economic situation and more significantly, the run-up to the 21st National Congress of the CPC a year from now — require stability in ties with India and the US, while also keeping the two apart through such mechanisms as BRICS.

When domestic and international circumstances change, China will be back to its more familiar avatar.

The writer is professor, Department of International Relations and Governance Studies, and director, Centre of Excellence for Himalayan Studies, Shiv Nadar University, Delhi NCR

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Fed's hike

THE FED'S rate hike may look like a technical adjustment, but for households it translates into a tighter squeeze ("Rates must reflect inflation risks", *IE*, September 18). Official inflation at 3.4 per cent feels abstract when gas is \$4.5 a gallon and diesel \$6.4, far above last year's levels. Labour wages are barely keeping pace with it, so the real inflation lived by families is higher than the headline. Strong job numbers cloak the erosion of purchasing power. Policy must reckon not just with data and projections, but with the lived reality of workers whose livelihood shrinks against rising essentials. Monetary tightening alone cannot restore this balance.

Abhinav Shah, Lucknow

Another distraction

THE CONTROVERSY over an IPS officer's religious greetings reflects how ordinary courtesies can become political flashpoints ("Rise above the politics of greetings", *IE*, September 18). Civil administration is different from the military, where protocols demand greater uniformity. The right wing appears to have found another excuse to turn a routine greeting into a political issue. Officers should be judged by their conduct, integrity and professional duties. When governance is entangled with symbolic gestures, substantive issues risk being pushed aside.

Harsh Pawaria, Rohtak

Myths and facts

HISTORICAL BELIEFS and popular traditions deserve to be examined with curiosity, but claims about the past should rest on credible evidence ("A reality check for an ancient myth", *IE*, September 18). Myths can have cultural value without necessarily being treated as historical fact. Schools and public institutions can encourage students to distinguish between folklore, interpretation and verifiable evidence. Archaeology, scientific research and documented historical sources should guide such discussions. This approach neither dismisses tradition nor accepts untested claims, but promotes a more informed understanding of our heritage.

BA Neboba, Perundurai



RAM RAJYA

BY RAM MADHAV

"NEARLY ALL men can stand adversity, but if you want to test a man's character, give him power," Abraham Lincoln once said. Many falter while exercising power. But Narendra Modi has stood out.

Modi comes from the ideological school that taught him the song, "*Path ka antim lakshya nahi hai simhasan chadhte jaana*" (ascension to power is not the ultimate aim of our journey). The song then details the purpose of this journey: "*Sab samaj ko liye saath me aage hai badhte jaana*" (march along, carrying the entire society with you) and "*safal rashtra ka anupam vaibhav sabhi bhanti se hai laana*" (bring about the ultimate glory of the successful nation in all respects). As he completes 25 years in public service, first in Gandhinagar and later in Delhi, it is this vision and mission that has guided Modi's politics.

After the Modi government's formation, we passed a resolution at the party's national executive. It asserted, "We are not here merely for reform. Reform is good, but it is largely about tinkering with the existing system. PM Modi's vision is transformative." In the West, it is said that "a society gets a government it deserves". But in the Mahabharata's Shanti Parva, Bhishma tells Yudhishtira, "*Raja kalasya karanam* (the king is the master of the times)." Modi has implemented that transformative agenda.

There are two ways of doing

In 2021, the RBI introduced the concept of Upper Layer of NBFCs. It ruled that large, systemically important non-banking financial companies would have to be listed within three years of being notified. In September 2022, Tata Sons was classified as an NBFC listing

When power & leadership is vehicle for seva

that — one prescribed by the 15th-16th century Italian statesman Machiavelli, and the other professed by Kautilya, a scholar-minister in India in the third-fourth century BCE. In *The Prince*, Machiavelli proposed that "a prince who wants to keep his authority must learn how not to be good". Kautilya, in contrast, argued that the happiness of a king lies in the happiness of his subjects. He insisted that the ruler must be disciplined and compassionate.

In calling for a month-long campaign of *seva sankalp* — commitment to service — on the completion of 25 years in public office, Modi demonstrated his commitment to Kautilyan principles. *Seva* is a uniquely Indian concept, to which the English word "service" doesn't do complete justice. That's why the Oxford English Dictionary made a separate entry for the word *seva* in 2024, defining it as "selfless service; the action or practice of rendering service to others...". While the word "service" is seen broadly as an altruistic civic duty of a giver, *seva* is a spiritual concept that helps in self-purification and the elimination of ego, in which the giver is just a human while the receiver is regarded as the divine. The concept of *nar seva* (serving humans) as Narayan *seva* (serving God) is integral to Indian thinking.

Modi's governance is based on that spiritual idea of serving society with devotion. Bhishma's *raj dharma* talks about three qualities of a transformative ruler — *saahas*

(courage), *samvedna* (compassion) and *samdrishhti* (equanimity). Modi has demonstrated these qualities in his governance. The nation has witnessed his courage and compassion on several occasions, especially during his handling of the Covid crisis. His equanimity is evident in not allowing extreme levels of slander and criticism to impact his governance.

The Chinese philosopher Confucius was once asked a tricky question: "When you are slapped on one cheek, should you show the other cheek as some say, or should you respond in a way that, for one tooth, the entire jaw? Should one do good to those who do bad unto him, or should one respond to the evil doer in the same coin? Confucius responded with a counter-question: If you do good to those who do bad unto you, what do you do to those who do good unto you? His answer was: You should always do good to those who do good to you; but don't do bad to those who do bad to you; give them justice. Justice is a higher idea that calls for a great sense of righteousness and equanimity. Modi's governance personified that justice.

Some time ago, an article in *Forbes* magazine listed eight qualities of a successful leader: Honesty, communication skills, confidence, commitment, positive attitude, innovation, intuition, and inspiration. If a leader possesses several of these qualities, he will be a good leader. But the leader who possesses all of them is Narendra Modi.

The writer, president, India Foundation, is with the BJP



URVASHI PATOLE

I HAVE been riding motorcycles for nearly two decades. I have ridden alone, with other women and in large groups, across different parts of the country. I have had thousands of ordinary interactions on the road and many wonderful ones too. But there have also been incidents I still think about, especially when I see something like what happened to Sia in Gurugram.

Once, a fellow Bikerni member and I were riding towards Bhubaneswar when a group of men saw us pass and tried to stop us. A little later, we saw them again. They had spread themselves across the road, holding hands, trying to block us. I was connected to my friend on the intercom and told her to

speed up, hoping they would scatter. They did. In a bid to get away, we were doing 120 and 140 kmph. I remember thinking how unnecessary and risky it was.

Another time, I was riding alone when a Scorpio came extremely close to me and started pushing me towards the divider. I managed to get around and tried to pass it from the other side. But the passenger suddenly opened the left-side door. Thankfully, I managed to avoid it.

Once, while in Gujarat, we were with a friend who was relatively new to riding. A group of men in a car started driving very close to her and heckling her through the window. They thought I was a man riding separately from her because I used to keep my hair tucked inside my jacket to avoid attracting attention on the road. The men kept trying to push her towards the side of the road and make her stop.

By then, I was extremely angry. I had a small penknife-type tool in my waist pouch. I accelerated, got my motorcycle between my friend and the car, and went up to their window. I shouted, "Hey!" and showed them what I had. They got scared and drove away. But it could easily have gone in another direction; I don't know what would have happened if it had.

I also remember an incident in my 20s. I was riding back home in the late hours of the evening when two guys on a motorcycle

I don't want the answer to what happened to Sia to be that women should stop riding alone or avoid certain roads. We are riding because we want to

pushed me sideways. I fell hard on the ground, not before scorching the entire skin off my right calf and leg as it had touched my bike's silencer. I didn't even tell my parents as I was scared of being banned from riding.

That is the part that bothers me most. We constantly have to think about how to get ourselves out of situations we didn't create. There have been so many other experiences over the years. Women riders being asked why they are riding alone, where they are going, where they have come from. Men following us, trying to get our attention or cutting into our formation. Sometimes it is curiosity. Sometimes it is harassment.

I have also seen the other side of this country. People offering us tea, asking if we need food or water, inviting us into their homes, helping us. There have been far more good experiences than bad ones.

That is why I don't want the answer to

what happened to Sia to be that women should stop riding alone or avoid certain roads. We are riding because we want to. We aren't doing it for attention, social media or anyone's approval. We should, however, be prepared. I have learned to carry emergency contacts, keep phones with different networks, wear proper riding gear and learn basic self-defence. You also need to know how to use resources and when not to escalate a situation.

I hope there comes a time when women riding motorcycles become ordinary. Maybe our daughters and the generations after them will have that experience. I hope that one day, when a woman rides past someone on a motorcycle, the first thought isn't, "Why is she here?" It is simply: "There goes another rider."

The writer is co-founder, The Bikerni

16 cops among 21 killed in suicide blast at mosque in KPK province

Press Trust of India
Peshawar, September 18

AT LEAST 21 people, mostly policemen, were killed and 78 others injured in a suicide blast at a mosque during Friday prayers near the police lines in Kohat district of Pakistan's Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province, police said. The blast occurred at the mosque located near the old Police Lines in Kohat, around 60 kilometres southwest of the provincial capital Peshawar, they said.

According to police, an attacker rammed an explosives-laden vehicle into the mosque

premises, following which an exchange of fire with armed militants took place.

District Health Officer Kohat Dr Nasir Hussain said 21 people, including 16 police personnel and five civilians, were killed and 78 others injured in the explosion. A little-known militant group, Ittehad-ul-Mujahideen Pakistan, claimed responsibility for attack. The group, an alliance comprising the Hafiz Gul Bahadur Group, Harakat Inqilab-e-Islami Pakistan and Lashkar-e-Islam, was formed in April 2025.

Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Inspector General of Police Zulfikar Hamid said that an explosion



Police officers secure the road leading to the site of the suicide bombing in Kohat, Pakistan, on Friday. AP

ives-laden vehicle rammed into the gate of the old police lines, triggering an explosion followed

by gunfire. "The vehicle hit the gate and then exploded, and firing also took place," Hameed

said, adding that another suicide blast occurred at the Special Branch building during the exchange of fire with terrorists.

The blast occurred during Friday prayers, leaving a crater outside the mosque and severely damaging its exterior, while a wall also collapsed. Most of those wounded were worshippers. Video footage from showed the bodies of worshippers lying inside the mosque.

According to the Central Police Office in Peshawar, seven armed militants entered the police lines, where police and the Counter-Terrorism Department engaged them in a gun battle.

Six militants have so far been killed, including suicide bombers and snipers, the official said. Security officials said security forces and police had cordoned off the area.

The injured, including police personnel, were shifted to the District Headquarters Hospital, where an emergency was declared, hospital Medical Superintendent Tahir Ali Shah said.

According to Rescue 1122 Khyber Pakhtunkhwa spokesperson Bilal Ahmad Faizi, rescue teams reached the site shortly after receiving the information and launched a rescue operation.

THE DEBATE OVER A.I.

Anthropic sets up bio lab as it looks to ramp up AI drug programme

Startup aims to have Claude AI control lab robots

Reuters
San Francisco, September 18



ANTHROPIC HAS quietly set up a laboratory to do physical biology work as it pushes its artificial-intelligence ambitions into the world of drug science.

At a time when fears of AI are gripping the public, the startup has built a wet lab, or place for physical experiments, in the San Francisco Bay Area, two people familiar with the matter said. Anthropic has said it wants to unlock treatments for rare diseases, and its biology work has gone beyond "in silico" or computer evaluations.

In a Reuters interview on Tuesday, Anthropic's head of life sciences, Eric Kauderer-Abrams, confirmed the startup's wet lab. "We believe that to do biology, the final test is still and will be for a while in real lab work," he said.

"We absolutely are doing that today, and I would describe

People visit an Anthropic booth at Moscone Center in California

our approach as being typical of what you would see in most biotech companies, where there's some amount of that that we're doing in our own facilities... that we're working with external partners on."

A spokesperson later clarified that Anthropic's lab is not for drug discovery specifically, declining to elaborate.

"The mission of the company is to develop powerful AI in such a way that benefits the world," Kauderer-Abrams said.

"By far, we see the biggest opportunity for that in the life sciences, and that is motivating everything that we're doing, adding that "We're in the very early innings of using AI to automate the execution of lab work.

IRGC NAVY WARNS UNAUTHORIZED PASSAGE THROUGH STRAIT WOULD RESULT IN 'DESTRUCTION OF OFFENDING VESSELS'

Rejecting Trump, South Korea says it will not deploy its military in Iran

Choe Sang-Hun
Seoul, September 18

PRESIDENT LEE Jae Myung of South Korea pushed back against pressure from the Trump administration on Friday, declaring that his country would not deploy troops or military assets to support the US-led war against Iran.

In recent weeks, President Trump has publicly taunted South Korean President Lee Jae-myung, accusing Seoul of refusing to help defend the Strait of Hormuz US troops remain stationed on the Korean Peninsula to deter North Korea.

On Friday, Lee firmly rejected any military involvement in the West Asia conflict.

"There will be no deployment of troops or dispatch of military assets to be involved in or intervene in war," Lee said.

Instead of deploying troops, Lee said Seoul is considering expanding the role of a South Korean navy destroyer and support ships stationed off Somalia for antipiracy operations. Even if they move closer to the Red Sea or Strait of Hormuz, their sole mission would be protecting South Korean oil tankers and other vessels.

NYT

Iran strikes tanker, warns ships as huge Tehran rally backs war effort

'A projectile' caused fire that was later extinguished, says UK maritime expert

Associated Press
Dateline

IRAN SAID on Friday it struck the Togo-flagged oil tanker Trend over what it described as an "illegal attempt" to pass through the Strait of Hormuz, according to the state broadcaster, which cited the Revolutionary Guard Corps.

The Guard's navy warned that vessels attempting to pass through the strait without authorization would face "destruction," the broadcaster said. Tehran has asserted control over the waterway since the US and Israel launched the war on February 28.

The United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations (UKMTO) reported a "security incident" overnight involving a vessel 16 nautical miles north-east of Khasab, Oman, which lies on the other side of the strait.

The crew was safe and no environmental impact was reported, the monitor said.



Women affiliated with Iran's Revolutionary Guard participate in a state-organised military-style parade in Tehran on Friday. AP

Separately, the UKMTO said a tanker in the strait was hit by an "unknown projectile," causing a fire that was later extinguished. The crew was reported safe, it said.

The monitor also said another tanker was struck Wednesday by an "unknown projectile" while transiting out of the strait, with the crew reported safe. It was not clear why the report came later.

Hundreds of thousands of Iranians filled the streets of Tehran in the biggest rally since

the war began in February, pledging to take up arms as "Jan-faday-e Iran," or those "who sacrifice their lives for Iran." Iran's government has sought to rally the people and stress national unity, even as the economy worsens under a US naval blockade of Iranian ports and new US sanctions meant to increase Tehran's economic pain.

Some participants trampled flags of the U.S. and Israel. Others chanted "Death to America" and "Death to Israel." The rally was a chance to show

off military hardware. Anti-aircraft batteries were on display, while female guards in black headscarves sat with truck-mounted machine guns.

Meanwhile, hundreds of people rallied in northern areas of Yemen in support of the Houthis and to protest Saudi Arabia's accusation that the rebels targeted Islam's holiest site, Mecca.

Houthi-controlled Al-Masirah TV showed protesters carrying pictures of the Kaaba, a landmark in Mecca, along with Yemeni, Iranian, Lebanese and

US clears way for \$24.3 bn fighter jet sale to Saudi

Washington: The US Department of State said on Thursday it had approved the potential sale of Lockheed Martin's F-35 Lightning II fighter jets to Saudi Arabia, as the kingdom is drawn deeper into war in West Asia.

Saudi Arabia made a direct appeal for the jets in early 2025 to US President Donald Trump and has long been interested in Lockheed Martin's fighter.

The estimated \$24.3 billion sale would include 48 of the military aircraft and 49 Pratt & Whitney engines, the US State Department said. REUTERS

Palestinian flags. A speaker reiterated the Houthis' opposition to Saudi Arabia, which supports Yemen's internationally recognized government.

A UKMTO update said there have been no new attacks on shipping in the Red Sea in the week since Houthi rebels captured key islands in the Bab el-Mandeb Strait.

Early voting begins in US midterms that could flip control of Congress

Associated Press
Virginia, September 18

IN-PERSON voting for this year's midterm elections began Friday, ushering in the final six weeks for Americans to decide which party they trust to lead Congress through a cost-of-living crisis, a prolonged war in Iran and other pressing issues.

Election administrators say they are prepared and confident the vote will be accurate and secure. Nevertheless, President Donald Trump has continued efforts to denigrate certain voting methods and reshape how elections are run, through court challenges, an expansive federal hunt for noncitizen voters and a pressure campaign to force election officials to share sensitive voter data.

Friday marked the start of early voting in Virginia. Voters in a few other states, including Minnesota and South Dakota, can cast absentee ballots in person, typically at a local election office or voting center. More ex-



Voters cast ballots in Virginia on Friday, the first day of in-person voting for this year's US midterm election. AP

pansive early voting is scheduled to begin in those and other states in the coming weeks.

At a voting location in Fairfax, Virginia, 18-year-old college student Sanya Singhal was among the first to vote early in person, arriving well before the site opened to get in line.

"Why not just have a little fun in life, you know, try to be the first early voter?" she said. "I really want to participate in my

democracy."

The Nov. 3 election includes votes for governor and state legislature in most states and will determine whether Republicans maintain control of the US House and Senate. If Democrats retake Congress, it will alter the trajectory of the final two years of Trump's term, most likely leading to investigations and other oversight efforts.

Two students, gunman killed in Philippines school shooting

Manila: A shooting at a high school in the southern Philippines on Friday left two 14-year-old students and the teenage gunman dead and wounded at least eight people, local government and police officials said.

The shooting at Banga National High School in the South Cotabato town of Banga is under investigation, the Philippine National Police said in a statement. South Cotabato Governor Reynaldo Tamayo said the two students killed were a boy and a girl, both 14. He said the gunman also shot himself and died.

Banga Mayor Albert Palencia told DZBB radio that the gunman hit 10 students, two of whom died. Tamayo said the gunman's best friend told officials that the teenager was a member of an online "true crimes community." Authorities were probing the account and whether it had any connection to shooting, he said. AP

Zelenskyy rallies seven regional allies as Russian strikes kill 3 in Ukraine

Associated Press
Kyiv, September 18

UKRAINIAN PRESIDENT Volodymyr Zelenskyy hosted leaders and representatives from seven regional countries for talks on deepening cooperation on Friday, as overnight Russian strikes in multiple regions sparked fires and caused several deaths and injuries.

The inaugural summit of the so-called "Carpathian Eight" brings together Ukraine, Romania, Serbia, Poland, Slovakia, the Czech Republic, Austria and Hungary, with the European Union also involved.

It comes as US-mediated efforts to end Russia's 4 1/2-year full-scale invasion have stalled, with the issue of territorial concessions in eastern Ukraine among the central sticking points. Some of the nations attending the meeting in western Ukraine's Ivano-Frankivsk region, such as Poland and Ro-

The summit is a significant beginning of a movement intended to further strengthen ties between our countries and create another strong element of cooperation at EU level"

VOLODYMYR ZELENSKY, PRESIDENT OF UKRAINE

mania, have been staunch supporters of Ukraine. Others, such as Hungary, Serbia and Slovakia, have refused to provide Kyiv with direct military assistance.

Zelenskyy wrote on Telegram that the summit was a "significant beginning" of a movement intended to "further strengthen ties between our countries and create another strong element of cooperation at the EU level."

AS THE AfD PARTY SEEKS TO CONTROL A STATE GOVERNMENT FOR THE FIRST TIME, ITS PUSH FOR 'PATRIOTIC' ART HAS DRAWN COMPARISONS WITH NAZI POLICIES

As it moves closer to power, Germany's Far-Right AfD takes aim at theatres & the arts

Jim Tankersley & Sam Gurwitt
Magdeburg, September 18

THE ALTERNATIVE for Germany, or AfD, the far-right party that won an election in Saxony-Anhalt, plans a cultural overhaul that has drawn comparisons to actions taken during Germany's Nazi past.

The state's arts community is preparing to fight for its survival if the AfD can form a coalition government. Artistic directors at institutions statewide, many dependent on government funding, are mobilising to oppose plans for "patriotic" arts programming.

The AfD has made cultural

change central to its plans for Saxony-Anhalt and the rest of Germany. Its election platform pledged to push artistic institutions to celebrate prewar German history, break from multicultural influences and end Germany's "guilt complex" about the Nazi past.

The party has also criticised the Bauhaus, the design school in the state that was shuttered by the Nazis, who saw its avant-garde style and international outlook as a threat to traditional German identity. The Nazis used the movement as shorthand for foreign, Jewish and communist influence.

The AfD's campaign platform says the Bauhaus lacked

"national roots". Platform co-author Hans-Thomas Tillschneider has separately called the school "non-German".

Barbara Steiner, director of the Bauhaus Foundation, said, "The AfD understands through culture, they can get into people's heads, into their mind-sets." "An AfD state government will trigger a cultural renewal," Tillschneider said. The party did not respond to questions.

The Saxony-Anhalt AfD chapter has been classified as right-wing extremist by federal intelligence. The party's lead candidate has said he cannot "presume to judge" whether the Holocaust was humanity's worst crime. The AfD won 44%



The main building of the former Bauhaus design school, now home to the Bauhaus foundation, in state of Saxony-Anhalt. AP

of this month's vote, amid voter backlash against economic stagnation and a decade of high immigration. "The same lan-

guage that the National Socialists used in 1933," art historian Elizabeth Otto said of the party's attacks on the Bauhaus.

The Nazis targeted culture they considered "un-German" and burned thousands of books.

Wolfram Weimer, Germany's culture minister, told a German newspaper this summer that "the AfD in Saxony-Anhalt is a direct continuation of the Nazis when it comes to the Bauhaus."

AFD leaders reject comparisons with the Nazis. Its platform describes its cultural plans as a corrective to a German culture weakened by "rainbow ideology" and fixation on past atrocities. It criticises Germany's effort to grapple with its Nazi history, known as "Vergangenheitsbewältigung," or "coming to terms with the past".

The AfD promises to steer money towards classic theatre productions and "art that contributes to the formation of German identity". It would scrap an official state homage to the Bauhaus and says its changes should "heal" the nation's identity crisis "through a new, patriotic cultural policy that restores German self-confidence".

Arts leaders fear the moves would stifle free expression. Concern is acute at the Bauhaus, which derives half of its funding from the state and is among the region's most internationally prominent cultural institutions.

The AfD has attacked the site since 2024, when state officials changed the Saxony-Anhalt

motto to "Think Modern". Tillschneider denounced the school's legacy, citing its "forced elimination of tradition".

The AfD platform would change the motto to "Think German" and suggests requiring public buildings to "adopt recognised traditional architecture". Steiner said she interpreted the push as a call for the same "homeland style that the Nazis also referred to". She anticipates the AfD might try to replace her.

"I'm not going to give in," she said. "As long as I can, I will stay."

Other institutions fear an AfD could use budgetary leverage to force them to cancel performances or exhibits that officials dislike. NYT

‘DECISION SHOULD BE VIEWED AS AN OPPORTUNITY TO BRING PEOPLE AND INSTITUTIONS TOGETHER’

Shapoor Mistry supports RBI’s move on Tata Sons, backs listing

George Mathew
Mumbai, September 18

SHAPOOR MISTRY, Chairman of Shapoorji Pallonji Group (SP group) which holds 18.37% stake in Tata Sons, has come out in support of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) decision to reject Tata Sons application for deregistration as an upper layer non-banking finance company. The RBI decision will force the company to go for listing.

“With the RBI having rejected the application to surrender its registration and directing Tata Sons towards the necessary compliance at the earliest, the path forward is clear,” Mistry said in a statement. The RBI has provided full clarity. Tata Sons had been classified as an Upper-Layer NBFC under the RBI’s Scale-Based Regulatory Framework, and the prescribed listing route followed from that regulatory architecture, he said.

Shapoor Mistry is the brother-in-law of Noel Tata, Chairman of Tata Trusts, who is overseeing the listing of Tata Sons. Tata is married to Mistry’s sister. Debt-laden SP group, which is active in construction and infrastructure sectors, has been looking for ways to monetise its holding in Tata Sons.

Shapoor’s brother Cyrus

Mistry, who passed away in 2022, was Chairman of Tata Sons from 2012 to 2016.

“I have repeatedly said that the public listing of Tata Sons is not merely a financial or regulatory matter. It is a social and moral imperative,” Mistry said. It is about strengthening transparency and public accountability in one of India’s most consequential business institutions, while preserving and advancing the extraordinary philanthropic purpose that lies at the heart of the Tata legacy, he said.

Mistry said this landmark decision should not be viewed as a victory of one stakeholder over another. It should be viewed as an opportunity to bring people and institutions together. “The listing of Tata Sons can become a bridge. A bridge between shareholders and Trusts, between private heritage and public accountability, between generations of stewardship, and between India’s great past and the extraordinary future that lies ahead,” he said.

He said the relationship between the Shapoorji Pallonji and Tata group is itself more than a century old. It has been built over generations through enterprise, trust, shared experiences, and a deep understand-



Shapoor Mistry, Chairman of Shapoorji Pallonji Group.

ing of the responsibilities that come with building institutions in India. “I therefore look forward not merely to a resolution of the present chapter, but to forging a greater partnership, greater engagement and deeper relationships with Tata Sons and the Tata Trusts in the years ahead. Always with a spirit of mutual respect and always keeping the national interest paramount,” Mistry said.

“I believe a transparent and publicly accountable Tata Sons can strengthen the entire ecosystem. It can broaden participation, enhance governance, give greater visibility to value, protect the legitimate interests of investors and provide the

basis for a more robust and equitable dividend policy,” Mistry said. Most importantly, it can strengthen the capacity of the Tata Trusts to pursue their philanthropic responsibilities over generations, he said.

The RBI’s decision can therefore become far more than the conclusion of a regulatory question, he said. It can become a landmark in the evolution of Indian corporate governance — an affirmation that scale and heritage can coexist with transparency; that philanthropy can coexist with public accountability; and that great private institutions can evolve in step with the aspirations of a great nation, Mistry said.

Noel’s ‘No’ vote makes Chandra’s extension invalid: DY Chandrachud

Mumbai: Former Chief Justice of India DY Chandrachud has provided a legal opinion stating that the board proposal extending Tata Sons Chairman N Chandrasekaran’s term for five years requires the affirmative vote of nominee directors from Tata Trusts to be legally valid.

Of the two nominee directors of Tata Trusts, Venu Srinivasan and Noel Tata, Noel Tata voted against the resolution for reappointment while Srinivasan backed the proposal, making the board decision on reappointment invalid, as per the opinion.

“The affirmative vote of the nominee directors of the Querists (Tata Trusts) is an independent and standalone requirement and operates on a wholly different plane from the Chairperson’s casting vote which is designed to resolve a tied vote amongst all directors of the Board taken cumulatively,” said the legal opinion given to Tata Trusts. **ENS FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](#)**

EPFO wage ceiling hike after 12 years

How it widens social security net, why unions are claiming it is ‘too little and too late’

Aanchal Magazine
New Delhi, September 18

IN A bid to widen the country’s social security net and formalise the workforce, the Ministry of Labour and Employment has notified a hike in wage ceiling for the Employees’ Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) effective Thursday — a revision seen after a long gap of 12 years.

The wage ceiling for the retirement fund body now stands at Rs 25,000 from Rs 15,000, which means that over 8 crore subscribers of the EPFO will now have to mandatorily contribute for the EPF scheme, Employees’ Pension Scheme (EPS) and Employees’ Deposit Linked Insurance (EDLI) Scheme up to the wage limit of Rs 25,000, beyond which contributions will be voluntary.

The decision will have the maximum impact for workers earning between Rs 15,000 to Rs 25,000 as their social security contributions will see a rise, with the revision expected to bring in over 51 lakh workers under the EPFO’s mandatory coverage. The existing subscribers whose PF contributions are linked to basic pay or actual pay higher than the previous wage ceiling of Rs 15,000 will be already contributing at a higher wage. They will, however, see an increase in their pension contribution to Rs 2,083 from Rs 1,250, which is capped at the wage ceiling for most subscribers (8.33% of Rs 25,000 as against Rs 15,000 earlier). The wage ceiling hike, which has been discussed in several meetings of the Central Board of Trustees (CBT) of the EPFO over the last decade, was criticised by trade unions, calling the increase “too little, too

late”. “A social-security ceiling frozen at Rs 15,000 for 12 years was already completely out of sync with the prevailing wages.

Besides, Rs 25,000 is not an adequate ceiling. Any social security must keep pace with the workers’ earnings. It must evolve in consonance with the minimum wages, actual wages, inflation and cost of living. This revision is therefore too little and too late. AITUC demands that the ceiling may be raised to Rs 30,000 in order to include deserving sections of employees,” Amarjeet Kaur, General Secretary, AITUC said. Another concern raised by experts is that with the hike in the wage ceiling, employers will try to absorb it in the existing cost-to-company (CTC) structure, effectively reducing the take-home pay for workers due to higher social security contributions.

Hike in EPFO wage ceiling

The Union Cabinet Wednesday approved a hike in the wage ceiling for subscribers of the EPFO to Rs 25,000 from Rs 15,000 per month, following which the Ministry of Labour and Employment notified the change on Thursday, which was also Vishwakarma Day.

This is the ninth time that the wage ceiling under the EPF Scheme has been revised ever since it was first started in 1952 and only the third such instance where the gap between two wage revisions was undertaken after a decade. The last wage ceiling revision was in September 2014, when it was raised to Rs 15,000 from Rs 6,500, before which it was hiked to Rs 6,500 from Rs 5,000 in June 2001.

The hike in wage ceiling may also send a signal to the labour market and states about a higher wage scale for workers, experts said. At present, at least seven major states and Union Territories have the statutory minimum wages for unskilled workers above the Rs 15,000 wage ceiling: Delhi (Rs 17,800), Maharashtra (Rs 17,000), Karnataka (Rs 16,800).

Significance of wage ceiling

The wage ceiling serves as the base for mandatory coverage of workers in establishments covered under the ambit of the EPFO for all three schemes — EPF, EPS and EDLI. All workers earning up to Rs 25,000 will have to mandatorily contribute under the EPFO till this limit, beyond which workers can choose not to contribute. Both employees and employers contribute 12% of the employee’s basic salary, dearness allowance and retaining allowance, if any, to the EPF. The employee’s entire contribution goes to EPF, while the 12% contribution by the employer is split as 3.67% to the EPF and 8.33% to EPS, that is, the Employees’ Pension Scheme.

The government contributes 1.16% for an employee’s pension up to the wage ceiling to make up for any shortfall due to lower wages. Employees do not contribute to the pension scheme. The EDLI Scheme, which provides life insurance cover ranging between Rs 2.5 lakh to Rs 7 lakh to EPF members in case of death during service, requires employers to contribute 0.5% of wages, with no deduction from employees. **FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](#)**

• BRIEFLY

Moody’s raises India’s FY27 growth outlook sharply to 7%

New Delhi: Moody’s Ratings on Friday sharply raised India’s GDP growth forecast for the fiscal to 7%, aided by economic resilience in the face of West Asia war but flagged risks to inflation from elevated oil prices and El Nino. “The economy’s demonstrated resilience to the global shock wrought by the conflict in the Middle East has driven an upward revision to our forecast for real GDP growth in fiscal 2026-27 to 7% from 6% earlier,” it said. **REUTERS**

Pvt financing critical for Viksit Bharat goal: DEA Secretary

New Delhi: Achieving India’s ‘Viksit Bharat’ vision will require critical private sector investment, as public expenditure alone cannot bridge the massive financing gap, Economic Affairs Secretary Anuradha Thakur said on Friday. Speaking at a conference of finance ministers and finance secretaries, Thakur highlighted the sovereign rating upgrades from major international rating agencies received by India over the past one-and-a-half years. **PTI**

Tata, L&T Semicon partner to manufacture chips in India

New Delhi: L&T Semiconductor Technologies Limited and Tata Electronics on Friday announced a strategic partnership to expand indigenous production of semiconductor chips for global markets. The alliance aims to build domestic design and manufacturing capabilities to cater to next-generation product requirements across automotive, industrial, communications, security, and intelligent-edge sectors, according to a statement. **PTI**

MDR worry unlikely to spur higher cash usage: RBI DG

Mumbai: Concerns that introducing a Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) would spur a surge in cash transactions are unlikely to materialise, RBI Deputy Governor Shrirish Chandra Murmu said on Friday, adding that it was only an “initial apprehension”. From October 15, a 0.4% MDR will apply to person-to-merchant UPI payments above Rs 2,000. The charge will be paid by merchants, not consumers, and will be capped at Rs 300 for transactions of Rs 75,000 or more. **PTI**



Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal held talks with Canada’s Minister of International Trade Maninder Sidhu on Friday. Both sides reaffirmed the commitment to expedite negotiations and conclude the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement at the earliest. **X/PIYUSHGOYAL**

Trade talks pick up pace

Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal held talks with Canada’s Minister of International Trade Maninder Sidhu on Friday. Both sides reaffirmed the commitment to expedite negotiations and conclude the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement at the earliest. **X/PIYUSHGOYAL**

Amid trade war, US share in India’s software service exports rose to 54%

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, September 18

IN A year in which the US began a global trade war starting with its Liberation Day tariffs that targeted import of goods, the world’s largest economy became an even bigger destination for India’s software services exports, stretching its lead over the UK.

As per data released Friday by the Reserve Bank of India, India’s software service exports to the US rose 11% to \$119.7 billion in 2025-26, accounting for 54.1% of all such exports last year. In

EU waste law to ban India from importing bloc’s metal scrap

Brussels: India will be among the countries barred from importing European Union (EU) metal waste, including aluminium scrap, under a new law due to take effect in May 2027, according to a European Commission proposal setting out exemptions for non-OECD countries.

The move comes after the Commission earlier this month ditched a plan to impose a 15% export duty on aluminium scrap following pressure from the biggest buyer — India. Disagreements among EU officials diluted the trade proposal by exempting India, reducing its impact. **REUTERS**

All in all, India’s software services exports in 2025-26 amounted to \$221.4 billion, up 8% from the previous year. This figure does not include the \$179 billion of sales made by foreign affiliates of Indian companies.

The money Indian companies got from providing their software services ‘on-site’ reduced to \$18.4 billion in 2025-26 from \$19 billion the previous year, indicative of the tightening visa norms. In on-site services, engineers and other personnel work directly at the client’s office and not remotely from their own country.

Effective April 2, 2025, the Liberation Day tariffs announced by US President Donald Trump wreaked havoc on global trade. And while they were subsequently struck down by the US Supreme Court, the Trump administration continues to try and find ways to levy import duties on foreign goods. **FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](#)**

Direct tax mop-up rises 13% to Rs 12.12 lakh cr

New Delhi: The net direct tax collection rose 13% to over Rs 12.12 lakh crore till September 17 in the current financial year, buoyed by better advance tax mop-up from corporates, data released by CBDT on Friday showed.

Advance tax mop-up grew 16.1% to about Rs 5.22 lakh crore. This includes an 18% growth, at over Rs 4.16 lakh crore, in advance tax payments by corporates, and a 9.24% rise in non-corporate advance tax of Rs 1.06 lakh crore.

Refund issuance jumped 29.19% to over Rs 2.20 lakh crore, as per the Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT) data. Gross direct tax collection clocked a 15% growth, totalling over Rs 14.32 lakh crore. Securities Transactions Tax (STT) collection grew 53% to Rs 40,214 crore between April 1 and September 17. After adjusting refunds, net collections from direct taxes (which includes corporate, non-corporate, STT) saw a 12.96% growth at over Rs 12.12 lakh crore. Net corporate tax mop-up rose 19.48% to about Rs 5.56 lakh crore. **PTI**

CBDT removes arrest, detention provisions from tax recovery rules

ENS Economic Bureau
New Delhi, September 18

THE CENTRAL Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT) has removed arrest and detention provision from the tax recovery rules with retrospective effect from April 1, 2026 which will bar tax officers from undertaking arrest in case of tax default.

In a notification dated September 17, the CBDT has brought in Income-tax (Fourth Amendment) Rules, 2026, which also removes “arrest and detention” from the tax recovery rules in case of death of the defaulter.

FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](#)

• MARKETS

 Sensex 74,294.96 -19.63 -0.03%	 NIFTY 23,346.40 75.80 0.33%	 Gold ▲ ₹1,53,727	 US Dollar ▼ ₹95.88
		 Silver ▲ ₹2,36,908	 Oil ▼ \$125.14

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF SEPTEMBER 17, 2026

• GLOBALLY, THE EV SEGMENT COVERS AN ALPHABET SOUP OF SOME OTHER TECHNOLOGIES THAT INCORPORATE ELECTRIFICATION IN SOME FORM: HEVS, PHEVS AND FCEVS

India’s first mainstream PHEV, and the gap it plugs in the EV ecosystem

Anil Sasi
New Delhi, September 18

THE TOMAHAWK Land Attack The Tomahawk Land Attack Missile is an iconic American long-range, jet-powered, subsonic cruise missile that is used by the United States Navy in ship and submarine-based land-attack operations.

The long-range analogy is perhaps what JSW MG Motor India wanted to play on when it decided to christen its newly-launched Hector Tomahawk plug-in hybrid vehicle (PHEV), alongside an all-electric version of this new SUV, to emphasise range efficiency.

The vehicle is India’s first mainstream plug-in hybrid SUV, claimed to deliver over 115km of electric-only range and a combined fuel efficiency

figure of over 40kmpl. MG claims the Tomahawk PHEV can cover over 1,100km with a full tank of fuel and a fully charged battery.

So, what exactly is a PHEV?

To understand this, it’s important to examine the textbook definition of an EV — a vehicle that can be powered by an electric motor, which draws electricity from a battery and can be charged from an external source. Beyond this broad classification, though, across most parts of the world, a range of vehicle categories are subsumed as EVs.

Globally, the EV segment covers, besides battery electric vehicles or BEVs, an alphabet soup of some other technologies that incorporate electrifi-

cation in some form: HEVs or hybrid electric vehicles, PHEVs or plug-in hybrid electric vehicles, and FCEVs or hydrogen fuel cell electric vehicles.

All these technologies are part of a broad basket of low-emission vehicular platforms that the Chinese now term as New Energy Vehicles.

Unlike battery electric vehicles or BEVs, which are typically battery electric vehicles such as the Tesla Model S or the Tata Nexon electric that need to be plugged in before the battery is discharged, technologies such as HEVs and PHEVs bring together the best of both worlds. For instance, HEVs, or conventional hybrid electric vehicles, such as strong hybrid variants of the Toyota Hycross Hybrid and the Honda City e:HEV in India, or the Toyota Prius HEV sold

• EV FAMILY: BEVS, HEVS & PHEVS

CONVENTIONAL HYBRID electric vehicles (HEVs) combine a conventional ICE system with an electric propulsion system to produce a hybrid drivetrain that substantially lowers fossil fuel usage.

THE PHEVs, or plug-in hybrid electric vehicles also have a hybrid drivetrain that uses a combination of the ICE and electric power for motive power, but is backed by rechargeable batteries, quite like the HEVs.

THE BIG DIFFERENCE is that a PHEV can be plugged into a power source, which offers an external option to charge the battery that is not available on an HEV.



abroad, combine a conventional internal combustion engine (ICE) system, like in a regular petrol car, with an electric propulsion system to produce a hybrid drivetrain that substan-

tially lowers fossil fuel usage.

The on-board battery in a conventional hybrid vehicle gets charged when the internal combustion engine is powering the drivetrain to produce for-

ward or reverse motion, and this charge from the battery kicks in to offer motive power when it is fully juiced up. There is no need or provision to plug in these HEVs to recharge the batteries.

The PHEVs, or plug-in hybrid electric vehicles, such as the new Tomahawk or the Chevrolet Volt in the US market, also have a hybrid drivetrain that uses a combination of the internal combustion engine (ICE) and electric power for motive power, but is backed by rechargeable batteries, quite like the HEVs.

The big difference therefore is that a PHEV can be plugged into a power source, which offers an external option to charge the battery that is not available on an HEV. A plug-in hybrid car has a comparatively bigger battery and offers a

longer electric range than a traditional HEV. The battery, which gets charged while driving and with regenerative braking, as in an HEV, can be recharged by plugging into a socket if that option is available.

Effectively, a PHEV combines the positive attributes of internal combustion (range on long journeys) with those of plug-in electrics (a cleaner engine that typically costs less to run) in a single vehicle, resulting in a combination of features superior to those of a regular HEV. A bigger battery means that a plug-in hybrid car can be driven completely on 100% electric power far more frequently if it is recharged adequately at a charging point. And unlike a regular hybrid, it does not have to depend entirely on driving or braking for the on-board battery

to get charged, given that external charging is an option in the PHEV that is not there in an HEV. On the flip side, plug-in hybrids are comparatively more expensive to buy than their internal combustion counterparts, and they are also pricier than normal HEVs, given that the on-board battery in a PHEV is bigger than in an HEV.

Running costs for a PHEV, on the other hand, are generally lower, especially if the batteries are charged from an external socket regularly. The important thing is that in the transition to emission-free vehicles, PHEVs offer a genuine progression from hybrids to BEVs, given that they address several concerns with battery electrics — range anxiety being the most important. **FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](#)**

The Big Picture

SATURDAY, SEPTEMBER 19, 2026

A biopic on Neem Karoli Baba, the spiritual guru whose fame coincided with the Western spiritual counterculture movement of the 1960s and 1970s, is one of the biggest hits of the year. VIDHEESHA KUNTAMALLA & DEEPAK TENGURIYA on the man and his legend

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Looking for Neem Karoli Baba

How a 20th century guru found a new generation

ALITTLE before 6 pm, hundreds wait in the slow drizzle for the *aarti* to begin. A woman stands with her palms folded in prayer, her tear-streaked face lit up by the *aarti* flame. Just then, the bells toll, and she joins the crowd to chant a guttural “Sitaram, Sitaram”.

Here at Kainchi Dham, a shrine and *ashram* in the Kumaon hills dedicated to Neem Karoli Baba, faith and devotion, and the steady stream of worshippers, crowd out any stray questions one may have about the pull and relevance of a long-departed spiritual guru in these times.

A recent film, *Hanuman Ansh*, a biopic on the Baba who died in 1973, has turned into one of the year's biggest hits. Made on a modest Rs 2 crore budget, it has already grossed Rs 300 crore worldwide and forced Bollywood to take note. With that, the traffic on the winding hill roads leading up to the *ashram*, 20 km from Nainital, have only thickened: bus loads of travellers from across the state and outside, private vehicles cramped with families, and young Instagrammers wanting to cash in on the latest trend.

The Baba of Kainchi hills

One of the most influential Indian spiritual gurus of the 20th century, the height of Neem Karoli Baba's fame coincided with the Western spiritual counterculture movement of the 1960s and 1970s. Like his contemporary Mahesh Yogi, whose *ashram* in Rishikesh famously hosted the Beatles in 1968, Neem Karoli Baba's influence spread globally through his prominent American disciples. Among them, Richard Alpert, the Harvard psychologist who became Ram Dass and whose *Be Here Now* is considered a landmark text for spiritual seekers, American rock singer-turned-*kirtan* singer Krishna Das (born Jeffrey Kagel), and Dr Larry Brilliant, the American epidemiologist who is globally renowned for his role in eradicating smallpox.

But modern interest around the Baba was piqued possibly around 2015, when Prime Minister Narendra Modi visited the Facebook headquarters in California, where Mark Zuckerberg spoke about a “difficult period” when Apple founder Steve Jobs is said to have advised him to visit Kainchi Dham in India that Jobs had himself visited.

Since then, in a country that's in a constant search for cultural anchors, the crowds haven't stopped coming to Kainchi Dham.

According to the district administration, 24.34 lakh people visited Kainchi Dham in the first six months of 2026, compared with around eight lakh visitors a year in the previous years.

But it's one visit that everyone in Kainchi Dham and the surrounding Kainchi village talks about. In 2022, power couple Virat Kohli and Anushka Sharma, along with their daughter, visited the Baba's *ashrams* in Kainchi Dham and Vrindavan.

“The Kainchi we grew up in was a lot quieter, but after Virat Kohli and Anushka visited the shrine, the crowds wouldn't stop coming. Since I was a child, June 15, the day Mahharaj ji established the *ashram* here, has been celebrated as a festival. But now, Kainchi looks like there is a festival everyday,” says Dheeraj Tiwari, 27.

He isn't complaining, though. Tiwari runs a shop beside the Kainchi Dham *ashram*, where he sells boxes of *peda* and “Baba Kambal”, the kind of plaid woollen blankets that Neem Karoli Baba is seen wearing in all his photographs. Similar checked blankets are given as offerings at the shrine, with devotees refer-



(Clockwise from above) Neem Karoli Baba's first temple in Hanuman Garhi; the Kainchi Dham *ashram* in the Kumaon hills; actor Shobhinaw Satya as Karoli Baba in *Hanuman Ansh*; a photograph of BR Ambedkar shares space with that of Gods and godmen at a house in Akbarpur that's the birthplace of the Baba; (below) Neem Karoli Baba in his trademark blanket

ring to the Baba's iconic blanket-wrapped reclining pose as the “Kambal Mudra” and associating it with Lord Hanuman's posture when he blocked Bhima's path. Some of his followers even consider him a reincarnation of Lord Hanuman.

“Baba is given only Raymond blankets as offering,” says Tiwari, going on to talk about his tryst with the Baba's “chamatkaar”.

A few years ago, he says, when he decided to set up his blanket shop, he needed a distributor for Raymond blankets. “I had no idea where to find one. Then, that very day, a Raymond agent arrived in Kainchi. My family has been running a restaurant here since the 1990s, now we run this business, too. *Sab Babaji ki kripa...* my life is a gift Baba ji has given me,” he says, folding his hands, slipping into a few moments of reverence.

Much of what is known about the Baba is through devotional biographies, accounts of those who lived around the same time as him, and now, the movie. According to these accounts, the Baba was born around 1900 into a wealthy Brahmin family in Akbarpur, in Uttar Pradesh's Firozabad district, as Lakshman Narayan Sharma. Married as a child, he is said to have left home at 12, with the subsequent years marked by long periods of wandering across Rajasthan, Gujarat and later, Uttar Pradesh. There are accounts of how he went back to his village at one point, only to wander again. In Uttar Pradesh, he travelled to Neeb Karori village in Farrukhabad district and meditated here, an association that stayed in his name.

By the early 1950s, the wandering ascetic had begun creating places of worship. His first temple was Hanuman Garhi, built on the Manora hillside in Nainital. Over the next two decades, temples and in some places *ashrams* followed — at Bhumiyaadhar, Kainchi and Kakrighat in Uttarakhand, Vrindavan, Kanpur and Lucknow in UP, and Shimla and Delhi, among other places.

Kainchi Dham, whose Hanuman temple was consecrated on June 15, 1964, eventually became the principal *ashram* of his later years.

“The Kainchi we grew up in was a lot quieter, but after Virat Kohli and Anushka visited the shrine, the crowds wouldn't stop... now, Kainchi looks like there is a festival everyday

DHEERAJ TIWARI, 27
A SHOPKEEPER NEAR KAINCHI DHAM

The Kainchi economy

A little after 6 pm, the crowd moves towards the Kainchi shrine barefoot. Devotees leave their footwear outside and step onto the cold stone floor, moving through steel railings and barricades that guide them towards the sanctum. There are no separate queues for VIPs. A little ahead is a white marble statue of the Baba, complete with the blanket in marble.

The Shipra River runs by the *ashram*, the sound of its rushing waters a constant soundtrack that's audible above the bells and the *bhajan* of devotees.

This weekend, the packed road outside the shrine, wet after a sudden shower, glistens with lights from the shops on either side. Kainchi's local economy runs entirely on Baba's name — “his blessings”, is what the traders call it — with shops selling his photographs, trinkets, blankets and *prasad*.

Metres away, Vishesh Kaushik, 26, an IIT Kanpur graduate from Gurgaon, waits outside Hotel Monal for his room to be handed over. He says he decided to come to Kainchi after watching *Hanuman Ansh*. “I am usually not impulsive,” he says. “But after watching the movie, I opened the RedBus app, booked a ticket and came here.”

Kaushik, who recently lost two members of his family, says the film affected him more deeply than he expected. “I cried several times while watching it,” he says. “But here, I feel a sense of peace.”

Talking of the film, he says he was particularly struck by a scene in which Baba is shown eating seeds and producing plants from his mouth.

To Kaushik, the moment represented



something larger than a cinematic miracle. “That is the power to create life,” he says.

At 7 pm, the temple closes. Red curtains are drawn across the rooms where the deities sit, and the gates are shut. Devotees who have failed to make it inside stand outside, pleading with the authorities to let them in. Some cry, others wait in the hope that the doors might reopen.

Then, Kainchi changes almost immediately. The shops begin to close and the crowd thins out.

Vineeta Rawat, 27, who grew up in Bhowali, a town 10 km from Kainchi village, and who now works at Hotel Monal, says, “Once the *mandir* shuts down, it feels like Kainchi has gone to bed.”

The screen comes alive

On a Friday night in state capital Dehradun, the 8 pm show of *Hanuman Ansh* at the city's Pacific Mall is packed. Families with children and the elderly, and young people in groups, all watching the story of a guru.

As Shobhinaw Satya, who plays the Baba, appears on screen, there's none of the hooting and whistling that usually accompany the hero's entry; only a reverential silence.

One of the scenes has a group of children teasing the Baba as he meditates in a lake. He then miraculously pulls out *laddoos* from the water and gives it to each of the children. In the movie hall, a young girl turns to her sister and asks, “*Aise sach mein hota hai kya?*” (Does this really happen?)

Later, as a man lost in the forests around Kainchi begins reciting the *Hanuman Chalisa*, the audience joins in.

When the lights come on, people linger to take photographs, some make reels with

photos of the Baba that appear on the screen along with the rolling credits, and others continue sitting, wiping their eyes.

Anupriya Nagar, 21, one of the three producers of the film, says she was doing her Bachelor's in Economics at the University of Bath, UK, when she came across the story of how Steve Jobs met Neem Karoli.

The daughter of an art collector, Nagar had already secured a job at an art company in Zurich and hoped to graduate and leave for Switzerland. Instead, she found herself drawn to the story of the Baba.

Back in India, Ragini Sona, a family friend, introduced her to the team making *Hanuman Ansh*. Nagar, who read 120 pages of the script, recalls “getting goosebumps”. She offered to pitch in with the production, along with Sona and Namrata Singh, leading to an all-woman team of producers. “The movie should have been made long ago. I believe spirituality is in every one of us; we need to find a way to access it.”

Hope for change in his village

Over 400 km from the Kainchi *ashram* is Akbarpur, a village in Firozabad district that's the birthplace of the Baba.

Though the village has a temple that came up in 2001, where his stone statue shares space with those of Lord Hanuman, Lord Vishnu and Goddess Lakshmi, Akbarpur isn't awash in the kind of devotion that keeps Kainchi going. When they talk of him here, it is as “Lakshman Das ji”, a mortal among mortals, the father of two sons and a daughter, a man who left his family behind and found fame elsewhere.

It doesn't help that a property tussle has been playing out in Akbarpur between the Baba's granddaughters and a Trust, which manages the temple and the family property. Six daughters of the Baba's younger son Dharam Narayan Sharma, have written to the District Magistrate seeking action against the illegal occupation of their ancestral house in Akbarpur.

Shyam Upadhyay, a farmer, says that as long as Lakshman Das walked through these lanes, he was not “Baba”, just an ordinary householder with a family.

In her brick house behind the temple, Shanti Jatav, who says she is around 85, claims to have met Lakshman Das ji. “On the day Lakshman Das set out on his journey, his wife Rambeti did not even weep,” she says.

But now, Akbarpur is hoping the Baba's popularity will help the villagers' cause.

There's a quiet excitement about a new ring road or a *parikrama* path that's being built around the village. People also hope that the other roads in the village will finally be fixed, and that dirty water won't pool in the lanes anymore.

On a platform just outside the family's dak bungalow are two pairs of *charan paduka* (footprint-shaped markers) commemorating the Baba's two sons, Aneg Singh Sharma and Dharam Narayan Sharma, who died during the Covid wave. People come, quietly bow their heads, and leave.

The government has now announced that the region will be part of a larger tourist circuit. The village hopes all of this will add up to something.

A labourer on the outskirts of the village says, “The cremation ground is without a roof and it's difficult to cremate bodies in the rain. Maybe now, they'll build a roof?”

As the day winds down, we find ourselves at a doorway. Inside, a framed photograph of Ambedkar hangs tilted on the exposed brick wall. On a shelf below it are framed pictures of Gods, and one of the Baba. The young man who lives here sees no contradiction in an iconoclast sharing space with Gods and godmen. “We believe in all. Whatever we are today, we owe to Ambedkar ji, but Neem Karoli Baba is our village's pride, so we worship him too.”

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused Milan, S/o. Raju Khatri, R/o. H.No. K- 483, Ground Floor, Shakurpur, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide Case e-FIR No.01021/2022 U/S 380/411 IPC registered at P.S Subhash Place, North West District, Delhi and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said accused Milan could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused Milan is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said Milan, accused of Case e-FIR No.01021/2022 U/S 380/411 IPC, P.S Subhash Place, North West District, Delhi is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before 23.10.2026.

By Order, Ms. Upasana Satija
Chief Judicial Magistrate (North-West)
Room No.108, First Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/ 13252/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Tender Notice

Invitation of Tenders through E-procurement system
Principal chief materials manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001 for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for the following items.

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing time
01	82265067A	Pediatric Patient Simulator (As per attached Specification)	01 No	13.10.2026

Note: 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website www.ireps.gov.in for details.

2. No manual offer will be entertained. Tender Notice No. 82265067A Date: 18.09.2026 3243/2026

Serving Customers With A Smile

UJVN Limited

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006

Phone : 0135-2763508, 2763908 & Fax : 0135-2763507

CIN No. U48101UR2001SGC025866

RO No. 827 Tender Notice Dated : 18/09/2026

Office of the Executive Engineer, Maintenance Chilla (Pauri-Garhwal), invites sealed tenders from experienced firms for following works/supply for Chilla Power House:-

- 1- T-14/EEM/2026-27:- Hiring of Light diesel vehicle non AC (Mahindra & Bolero or equivalent) with driver for a period of 12 months for DGM (HGC), Chilla.
- 2- Estimated Cost - Rs. 5,10,300.00 (Taxes Extra)
- 3- Date of availability of Tender document on website - 17-09-2026 (17:00 Hrs)
- 4- Date of Receipt of the tender - 08-10-2026 up to 11:00 Hrs.

For all details, bidders are advised to visit our website www.ujvn.com

Executive Engineer (M), Chilla Power House

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

SEE SECTION 84 BHARTIYA NAGARIK SURKSHA SANHITA

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Ajit Kumar Pandey S/o Deena Nath Pandey R/o H.N. 7752, Fashi Building, Subzi Mandi, Ghanta Ghar, Delhi also Gali No. 06 C/o Rajan Khari, New Chandrawal, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under FIR No. 227/2019 U/s 279/304(A) IPC., has been registered at PS: Sarai Rohilla, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Ajit Kumar Pandey** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Ajit Kumar Pandey** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Ajit Kumar Pandey** of under FIR No. 227/2019 U/s 279/304(A) IPC., Registered at PS: Sarai Rohilla, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 06.11.2026.

By Order
Mr. Ankit Solanki
DP/13175/N/2026 JMFC-04 (Central), Central Distt.
(Court Notice) Room No. 37, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

Tender Notice No.: MECHCKP-26-27-36, For & on behalf of President of India, Divisional Railway Manager (Mechanical), South Eastern Railway, Chakradharpur invites E-Tenders for the under mentioned work. Manual offers are not allowed against the tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. **Name of work:** Online repairing of unloadable wagons at Sardega sidings (MFSJ & MCGB) under SSE (C&W)/Jharsuguda for a period of 02 years. **Tender Value:** ₹ 6,92,68,706.80. **Bid Security:** ₹ 13,85,400. **Cost of Tender Form:** Nil. **Place of opening of tender:** Office of the Sr. DME, Chakradharpur, South Eastern Railway. **Date and time of closing of tender:** 15.00 hrs. of 12.10.2026. **Tender can be viewed at website:** <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. The tenderer/bidder must have Class-III digital signature certificate & must be registered under IREPS portal. Only registered tenderer/bidder can participate in e-tendering. All relevant paper must be uploaded at the time of participating in e-tendering. (PR-783)

WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY

Mechanical Branch
NIT No.- JBP-M-Tender-21A-2026, Dated 16/09/2026 (Open Tender)
E-Tender on behalf of the President of India acting through Sr. Divisional Mechanical Engineer (Frt & EnHM), DRM(Mech) Office, West Central Railway, Jabalpur for the following works:- **NIT No. & Date-** JBP-M-Tender-21A-2026, Dated - 16/09/2026. **Name of work with location-** Outsourcing of various yard Repair activities at Freight Yard STA, Adv. Value of the work Rs. - 29129998.72. **Earnest Money Rs.-** 582600.00. **period of Completion-** 24 Months. **Tender Closing date & time-** 08.10.2026 15:00 Hrs. The complete information of the above E-tenders is available in website <https://ireps.gov.in> and also placed on the notice board of the Divisional Railway Manager (Mech) office of West Central Railway Jabalpur. Tenders other than in the form of e-bid shall not be accepted against above tenders. (Sd.) For DRM (M) West Central Railway, Jabalpur

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Naseem @ Durrani @ Rizwan, S/o: Islamudin R/o: H.No. 431, Gali No. 06, New Mustafabad, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No. 248/2026, U/S: 103(1)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, 25/27 A.Act, PS: Khajuri Khas, Delhi, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Naseem @ Durrani @ Rizwan**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Naseem @ Durrani @ Rizwan**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Naseem @ Durrani @ Rizwan**, of FIR No. 248/2026, U/S: 103(1)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, 25/27 A.Act, PS: Khajuri Khas, Delhi, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 27.11.2026.

By Order
Norma Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class- 03
Room No. 22, First Floor North East District
Karkardooma Court, New Delhi

DP/13057/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

RAIL WHEEL FACTORY

Yelahanka, Bengaluru-560064. Website: www.rwf.indianrailways.gov.in

TENDER NOTICE NO.RWF/S/146/2026-27/06 Dated: 18.09.2026
On behalf of the President of India, Principal Chief Materials Manager invites E-Bids from experience/reputed contractors for the following works through IREPS E-Portal www.ireps.gov.in.

Tender No.	Tender Due Date & Time	Scope of Work	Distance Slab	Approx Qty.	Estimated Value	EMD
RWFSTPT- FORGED AXLEMOHATA	16.10.26 @ 15:00 Hrs	Carriage of axles from & to RWF	Approx 1991 Km	3500 MT	₹ 1,26,12,985/-	₹ 2,13,100/-
RWFSTPTS- FIV_2ndSLAB	23.10.26 @ 15:00 Hrs	Carriage of Wheels from RWF	500 to 1000 Km	3700 MT	₹ 92,13,000/-	₹ 1,84,300/-

Contract Period: 24 months from date of issue of LOA.
For more details & detailed scope of work please visit RWF website & IREPS E-Portal.
Principal Chief Materials Manager

PUNJAB STATE POWER CORPORATION LTD.

(Office:- Chief Engineer/ P&M, PSPCL, Ludhiana.)

CIN: U40109PB2010SGC033813

Website: www.pspcl.in

Tender Enquiry no. 19/CE/P&M/2026

CE/P&M, PSPCL, Ludhiana invites e-Tender for Manufacture, testing, supply and delivery of 12 no. Single Phase Relay Test Set. For detailed NIT & Tender specifications please refer to <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in> from 19.09.2026 (11:00 hrs) onwards.

Note:- Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>

No. 15369/PB C 896/26

UJVN LIMITED

H.O.: "Ujjawal" Maharani, Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun - 248006 (Tel:0135-2763508 Fax 2763507)

Letter No: 829 E-TENDER NOTICE Date: 18/09/2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (M), Vyasi Power House, Hathiyari, Dehradun invites sealed online tender from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:

NIT No: e-19/EE(M)/VP/2026-27

Name of Work: Supply of safety equipments for Vyasi Power House, Hathiyari.

Estimated Cost: Rs 5,93,050/- + GST

Date of availability of bid document on website: 19.09.2026 at 17:00 Hrs

Last date for submission of bid on website : 10.10.2026 upto 13:00 Hrs

For fuller & further details of tender, kindly visit e- procurement portal <http://uktenders.gov.in>

Executive Engineer(M)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

Office of the Chief Project Director

WATERSHED MANAGEMENT DIRECTORATE

Indira Nagar Forest Colony, Dehradun (Uttarakhand)

Phone No. 0135-2768712, 2760170, www.wmduk.gov.in, wmd-ua@nic.in

No. 516/11-12(5-8)UCRRFP/2026-27 Dehradun Date 18th September, 2026

"REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL"

Watershed Management Directorate (WMD), Uttarakhand, Dehradun is implementing the Uttarakhand Climate Responsive Rain-fed Farming Project (UCRRFP) Funded by the World Bank. Under the Project Fund, WMD invites proposals for Selection of a "Social Media Agency".

Request for bid document is available on e-procurement portal i.e. www.uktenders.gov.in (Tender ID 2026_UCRF0_100308_1). The last date for submission of bid is 19th October, 2026.

For any kind of query the bidder may contact on phone no. 0135-2768712, 2760170 or email on wmd-ua@nic.in.

Project Director, Admin. Watershed Management Directorate

Indira Nagar Forest Colony, Dehradun, Uttarakhand, PIN: 248006

Uttarakhand Electricity Regulatory Commission

Vidut Niyamak Bhawan", Near ISBT, P.O- Majra, Dehradun-248171

PH. 0135-2641115 Website www.uerc.uk.gov.in E-mail: secy.uerc@gov.in

EXTENSION NOTICE

Inviting comments on the Draft UERC (Deviation Settlement Mechanism and Related Matters) Regulations, 2026.

In exercise of the powers conferred under Section 181 of the Electricity Act, 2003 (36 of 2003), and all other powers enabling it in this behalf, the Commission has issued draft UERC (Deviation Settlement Mechanism and Related Matters) Regulations, 2026. The draft Regulation had been posted at the Commission's website www.uerc.uk.gov.in. and the last date of submission of comments/suggestions/objections was 17.09.2026.

2. However, the Commission did not receive an adequate number of comments, suggestions, or objections by the stipulated date. Therefore, the Commission has decided to extend the date for submission of comments/suggestions/objections by 28.09.2026. Accordingly, comments/suggestions/ objections may be submitted to the undersigned latest by 28.09.2026 by post or e-mail or in person at the above-mentioned address for Commission's consideration.

3. The comments/suggestions/objections received after the stipulated date in the Commission's office may not be considered while finalizing these Regulations.

Advt. No 14/2026-27 Secretary

Office of Superintending Engineer

PWD Bulandshahr Circle, Bulandshahr

No. 8917/96M/E-TENDER/BSR CIRCLE/2026-27 Dated. 05.09.2026

E-Procurement-Inviting Tenders

On behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh, Superintending Engineer Bulandshahr Circle, U.P.P.W.D., Bulandshahr invites online the following percentage rate bid through <http://etender.up.nic.in> website, from the eligible and approved Contractors registered with P.W.D. in the category mentioned below as per column no. 10. Applied from Date 21.09.2026 to 26.09.2026 upto 12:00 Noon as per tender form T-2 prescribed by the Govt. of U.P. The technical bids will be opened online on dated 26.09.2026 at 12:30 PM. If the office happens to be closed on the date of opening of the bids as specified, the bids will be opened online on the next working day, at the same time any validity of bid will be considered from the original date. The date and time of opening of the financial bid shall be notified on the website.

Sl. No. Name of Work Estimated cost (Rs.in Lakh) Bid Security (Rs.in Lakh) Time of Completion work including rainy season Tender document fee including GST (In Rs.) Address of Executive Engineer executing the work Address of Superintending Engineer Address of Chief Engineer Category (Bridge)

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

1 Construction work of 2x6 M Span RCC Small Bridge on the nala at km 2 on Farukhganar-Siraura road in Ghaziabad district. 142.00 9.10 06 Months Tender Cost Rs. 300+2000 +18% G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00 PD PWD, Ghaziabad Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr Chief Engineer Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut A, B

1. Time allowed for completion of Whole work is mention in col. No. 5 with including rainy season

2. The Bid Security and Tender Document fee must be deposited through Internet Banking only.

3. All registered contractors have to upload Turnover certified by C.A. of last 5 years and details of maximum cost work satisfactorily completed in last 5 years on Chanakya Software before submission of tender.

Details of e-tender uploaded on <http://etender.up.nic.in> shall also be uploaded on UP PWD Chanakya software, before last date & time of submission of bid.

4. Terms & other conditions related to bid are available on <http://etender.up.nic.in>

5. While executing the work, it will be mandatory for the contractor to ensure compliance with all the safety measures related to Covid-19 issued by the Uttar Pradesh government

6. In PWD technical evaluation of tenders is to be done by Prahari Software URL for Prahari is <http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari/>

7. The contractor is required to deposit performance security valid for 45 days from the date of expiry of defect liability period. For unbalanced bids, it will be mandatory to deposit additional performance security amount as per G.O. No.- 86/2026/649/2026/23-7099/106/2025 Dt. 23.05.2026 upto the date of completion of work as per Contract Bond.

Sd/- Executive Engineer P.D., PWD, Ghaziabad UPID-256438 Dt. 17/09/2026 www.upidadv.gov.in

Sd/- Superintending Engineer Bulandshahr circle, PWD Bulandshahr

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Letter No:- DRM/C/AGRA/NFRE/AUCTION Dated:- 17.09.2026

E-Auction Notice

On Behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager, North Central Railway-Agra invites E-Auction as per categories given as under :-

Category: ADVT Catalogue No.: ADVT-AGRA-26-09

Asset Details

Commercial Publicity via Glowsign/Board at Platform & Concourse area of Idgah Railway Station zone.

E-Auction Start Date and Time: Date: 01.10.2026 Time: 11:00

E-Auction End Date and Time: 01.10.2026 Time: 11:30

Commercial Publicity via Digital/Video Wall at circulating area of Agra Cantt. Railway Station.

E-Auction Start Date and Time: Date: 01.10.2026 Time: 11:10

E-Auction End Date and Time: 01.10.2026 Time: 11:40

Commercial Publicity via Digital/Video Wall at Main entry & IInd entry circulating area of Mathura Jn. Railway Station.

E-Auction Start Date and Time: Date: 01.10.2026 Time: 11:20

E-Auction End Date and Time: Date: 01.10.2026 Time: 11:50

Commercial Publicity via Backlit/Unipole/Hoarding/Board at city side railway land of Agra.

E-Auction Start Date and Time: Date: 01.10.2026 Time: 11:30

E-Auction End Date and Time: Date: 01.10.2026 Time: 12:00

Note:- Prospective bidders are requested to visit E-Auction Leasing Module on IREPS website (www.ireps.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. 2134/26(AK)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Gaurav Kumar Singh S/o Sh. Umesh Kumar Singh R/o: H.No. 60/02, 2nd Floor, Pragati Vihar, Authority Road, Near Indian Gas Agency, Mukundpur Part-II, Also At: H.No. R/39, Gopal Park, Azadpur, North West, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in, **E-FIR No. 24/2026, Dated 29.01.2026, U/s: 308/318(4)/319/340/61 Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, PS: Special Cell, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Gaurav Kumar Singh**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Gaurav Kumar Singh**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Gaurav Kumar Singh**, of **E-FIR No. 24/2026, Dated 29.01.2026, U/s: 308/318(4)/319/340/61 Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, PS: Special Cell, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 30.10.2026.

By Order
Mdul Gupta
Chief Judicial Magistrate
26, G.F Annexe Building
Patiala House Court, New Delhi

DP/13217/SP.CELL/2026
(Court Matter)

KARNATAKA POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED

(CIN : U40109KA1999SGC025521)

No: CEE/T&P/SEE-1/EE-T4/2026-27/6638-52 Date: 18.09.2026

BRIEF TENDER NOTIFICATION

(THROUGH KARNATAKA PUBLIC PROCUREMENT PORTAL ONLY)

KPTCL Invites Bids on electronic mode for the following work against following enquiry number on Partial/Total Turnkey basis.

Enquiry No. and Name of the work

KPTCL/2026-27/SS/WORK_INDENT4214

Establishing 2x20MVA, 66/11kV sub-station at **Kowshika** by construction of LILo line from existing 66kV Hassan-Hangarahalli line for a distance of 2.689km in Hassan Taluk & District.

The bids will be received through electronic tendering mode only. The details regarding participation in the e-tendering process can be obtained by logging on to KPTCL website <https://kptcl.karnataka.gov.in> with hyperlink "E Procurement KPTCL" or <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> on or after 28.09.2026 @ 15:00 hrs. Last date & time for receipt of Bids and any extension of Due date for Bid submission will be intimated in the KPP portal. Any details required in this regard can also be obtained from the office of the undersigned during office hours.

All Corrigendum / Addendums shall be noticed by the bidders before the last date of submission of the Bids.

Sd/- Chief Engineer (Ele),

Tendering & Procurement, KPTCL, 9th Floor,

Indhana Bhavan, A.R Circle, Bengaluru – 560 009.

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER

RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, ANUGOLA

E-Mail - sencrwangul@yahoo.co.in

No. 3256 Dt. 17/09/26

1st corrigendum to Bid Identification No. Road online.AGL. 22/2026-27

Due to some unavoidable circumstances the last date of Online for bidding and opening of the date has been modified as follows in respect of tender for Road works for the year 2026-27 invited vide this office Tender Call Notice No. 2979 dt.25.08.2026 (Bid ID No. Road Online-AGL-22/2026-27) as Procurement Officer Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle Anugola.

Availability of Tender on-line for bidding

From To



POSTGRADUATE INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL EDUCATION & RESEARCH CHANDIGARH
(In the matter of Arbitration Proceedings arising out of ARB No.624 of 2024)
Post Graduate Institute of Medical Education and Research and Others
Vs.
M/s Sanyog Enterprises Private Limited
NOTICE THROUGH PUBLICATION
To,
1. Sh. Dewan Chand Sharma (Director), M/s Sanyog Enterprises Pvt. Ltd., B-1, Yadav Park, Rohtak Road, Nangloi, Delhi-110041, Phone No.011-49300500, FAX No.011-43852219. Email:- info@sanyogpharmacy.com, reach2vipul@gmail.com
2. Sh. Dewan Chand Sharma S/o Sh. Ram Dhan Sharma, #A-902, Plot No 23, Sector-07, Shri Radha Krishna, C.G.H.S. Dwarka, Delhi-110075. M. No.84477-56725. Email:- info@sanyogpharmacy.com.
3. M/s Sanyog Enterprises Pvt. Ltd, 9 & 10, IIInd Floor, Express Plaza LSC, Deraawal Nagar, Delhi, Roop Nagar, Pin-110009. M. No.84477-55741
Whereas the Post Graduate Institute of Medical Education and Research, Chandigarh (Claimants) have initiated Arbitral Proceedings against you before the Arbitral Tribunal, and notice sent to your last known address by the Arbitral Tribunal has been returned with the postal endorsement "Address Left".
Take notice that pursuant to the order dated 08.09.2026 passed by the Arbitral Tribunal, fresh service of notice upon you is being effected through publication to afford you an opportunity to appear and participate in the Arbitral Proceedings.
Date of Hearing: 27.10.2026
Time: 2:30 A.M.
Mode of Hearing: Through Video Conferencing (V/C Zoom Meet)
Join Zoom Meeting: https://us06web.zoom.us/j/8158755015
Meeting ID: 815 8755 5015
Tribunal Office Address: #36, Sector-8A, Chandigarh.

.....Claimants

.....Respondents

Director, PGIMER, Chandigarh



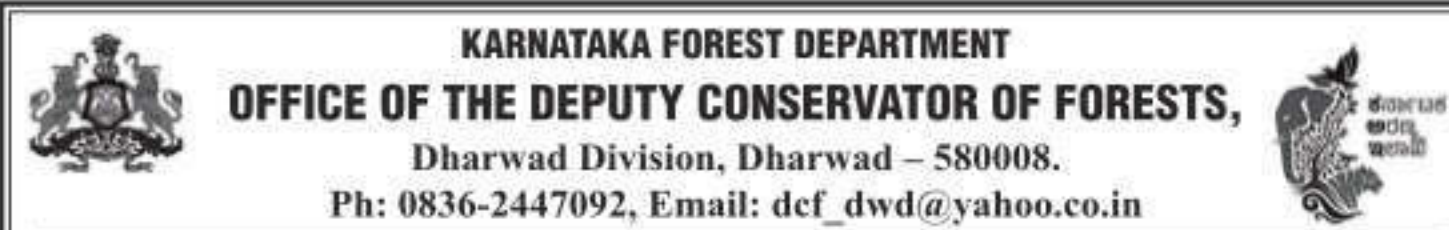
KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar, Bengaluru-560009. Phone No. 080-22265383, Website: www.kiadb.in

No. IADB/ENGG/ETND-EP-37/1595/2026-27

Date: 18.09.2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)
Item Rate Tenders under two cover bid system are invited as per the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and Rules 2000 through electronic procurement from eligible Contractors who have got adequate financial resources, state of the art technology, suitable construction equipments, technical man power & sufficient past experience for the work of :
Name of the Work: Formation of Industrial Layout including Construction of Roads including asphaltting, construction of RCC Side Drains, Inspection Chambers, Spur Culverts, Valve Cistern, Rain Water Harvesting & Water Supply Works at Sector-2 of Gowribidnur 4th Phase in Jarabandanahalli Village, Gowribidnur Taluk, Chikkaballapura District.
The last date and time of receipt of tender is : **05.10.2026 upto 4.00 pm.**
Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>.
Sd/-
Engineer in Chief, KIADB, Bengaluru

DIPR/CP/2824/SMCL/2026-27



KARNATAKA FOREST DEPARTMENT
OFFICE OF THE DEPUTY CONSERVATOR OF FORESTS,
Dharwad Division, Dharwad – 580008.
Ph: 0836-2447092, Email: dcf_dwd@yahoo.co.in

No.A1/ACT/CR-05/2026-27

Date: 16-09-2026

BRIEF SALE NOTIFICATION
It is hereby notified for the general information of the public that the Sandalwood stored at **Central Sandal Depot, Dharwad-580008** will be sold by e-tender-cum-auction mode through MSTC Ltd., on the online platform “www.mstcecommerce.com”. The sale conducting authority is Deputy Conservator of Forests, Dharwad Division, Dharwad. The e-tender-cum auction is subject to terms and conditions uploaded on the website www.mstcecommerce.com, by e-tender-cum auction.
Notice No:MSTC/BLR/Karnataka Forest Department/1/Forest Complex/26-27/31783
Date of e-tender-cum-auction **07th October 2026**
Mode Online-www.mstcecommerce.com
Times **03:00 PM to 05:00 PM**
Quantity of Material Approximately **139.397446 MT Sandal wood of Different kinds.**
Approximate value Approximately Above Rs.1.70 Crores
Inspection of logs by the bidders **23-09-2026 to 24-09-2026 (Both dates inclusive) 10:30 AM and 04:00 PM** (On working Days) at Central Sandal Depot, Dharwad–580008.
Pre Bid Meeting **24-09-2026 at 04:00 PM** in the Chamber’s of Deputy Conservator of Forests, Dharwad Division, Dharwad.
Conditions:-
1. Interested bidders should get themselves Registered with MSTC well in advance.
2. Intended bidders are advised to inspect the material to their satisfaction.
3. The Quantity notified adjacent to each class kept for sale is approximate.
4. Every Registered bidder shall pay an Earnest money deposit (EMD) of **Rs.1,00,000/- (One Lakh only)** for all lots/or any lot.
5. The black listed bidders, defaulters, Minors, insolvent persons will not be Permitted to participate in the sale.
6. Detailed Sale Conditions to be downloaded from www.mstcecommerce.com. E-Auction **No:MSTC/BLR/Karnataka Forest Department/1/Forest Complex/26-27/31783 Sale Conducting Officer.**
Sd/-
Deputy Conservator of Forests
Dharwad Division, Dharwad
DIPR/DHARWAD/641/2026-27/DESHPANDEPUBLICITY



KARNATAKA STATE LAW UNIVERSITY
Navanagar, Hubballi-580 025.
Accredited with ‘A’ Grade by NAAC
Phone: 0836-222239292, Website: www.kslu.karnataka.gov.in

No. KSLU/DPAR/2026-27/884(G)

Date: 17-09-2026

NOTIFICATION FOR APPOINTMENT OF TEMPORARY FULL TIME ASSISTANT PROFESSORS AND GUEST FACULTY - REG.
Applications are invited for appointment of Temporary Full Time Assistant Professors and Guest Faculty for the Academic Year 2026-27 for the Law School of Karnataka State Law University, Navanagar, Hubballi.
1. Temporary Full Time Assistant Professors:

Sl. No.	Subjects	Faculty Required	Qualification & Experience	Salary
1	Law	Assistant Professor – 21	A good academic record with 55% Marks at Masters Degree LL.M., with NET/SLET/SET/Ph.D. (in accordance with the UGC Regulations 2018)	(Consolidated pay - Rs. 50,000/- per month)
2	Management	Assistant Professor – 03	A good academic record with 55% Marks at respective Masters Degree with NET/SLET/SET/Ph.D. (in accordance with the UGC Regulations 2018)	
3	Political Science	Assistant Professor – 01	A good academic record with 55% Marks at respective Masters Degree with NET/SLET/SET/Ph.D. (in accordance with the UGC Regulations 2018)	
4	Sociology	Assistant Professor – 01	A good academic record with 55% Marks at respective Masters Degree with NET/SLET/SET/Ph.D. (in accordance with the UGC Regulations 2018)	

2. Guest Faculty:

Sl. No.	Subjects	Faculty Required	Qualification & Experience	Salary
1	Law	05	A good academic record with 55% Marks at Masters Degree LL.M., preferably with NET/SLET/SET/Ph.D. (in accordance with the UGC Regulations 2018) *UGC Qualified Guest Faculty (NET/SLET/SET/Ph.D.) – Rs. 525/- per hour. *Non-UGC Qualified Guest Faculty (Only Masters Degree with 55%) – Rs. 450/- per hour. *Retired Professor/Practicing Advocates (with 5years of Practising) – Rs. 525/- per hour. *Local conveyance per day - Rs. 150/-	

Interested Candidates may send their application along with Proforma provided (download from KSLU [website: www.kslu.karnataka.gov.in](http://www.kslu.karnataka.gov.in)) and the copy of Marks Cards & Degree Certificates and other relevant documents as per proforma to the undersigned. The application submitted whether by post or in person or e-mail should reach the University **on or before 25.09.2026**. They have to submit attested copies of their documents and produce the originals for verification at the time of interview. The date of interview will be communicated in due course.
Hard Copy of the Application along with required attested documents has to be sent to:
The Registrar, Karnataka State Law University, Navanagar, Hubballi-580025.
Candidates can send the Application along with required attested documents through email: kslu.registrar@gmail.com
For more details visit KSLU website: www.kslu.karnataka.gov.in
Sd/-
REGISTRAR
DIPR/DHARWAD/642/2026-27/DESHPANDEPUBLICITY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE						
SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	CONSTRUCTION OF SERVICE ROAD UNDER ROB I/C-79 ON GOHANA LAKHANMAJRA MEHAM BHIWANI ROAD (SH-16 A) IN DISTRICT ROHTAK. (ROAD ID-1739) UNDER WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27	11.09.2026 21.09.2026	103.80 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	09416046666 pwd-eeepd1-rohtak@hry.nic.in
2	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	05 NO. WORK (I) CONST OF RCC SIDE DRAIN AND LAYING OF 80MM IPB ON OLD NH-71 A IN JASSIA FROM 16.700 TO 17.300 (BOTH SIDE) (ID-10281) (II) CONSTR. OF RETAINING WALL ON LADHOUT TO KILOI SHIV MANDIR FROM 2.0 TO 2.100 AND 2.180 TO 2.780 (ID-1855) (III) SHIFTING OF ROAD FROM BUS STAND KILOI TO SHIV MANDIR FROM 1.70 TO 1.770 (ID-1856) (IV) STG. ON BALLAMBHA RLY STATION ROAD FROM 0.0 TO 1.8 (ID- 12704) (V) STG. ON BHALOUT TO KILOI ROAD FROM 0.0 TO 0.250 IN DISTT RTK (ID-1867) WP 26-27	11.09.2026 21.09.2026	309.11 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	09416046666 pwd-eeepd1-rohtak@hry.nic.in
3	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	07 NOS. WORK (I) IMP. BY PDG AND LAYING CCB ON KHARKARA TO BHARAN 0.33 TO 0.58 (ID-1844) (II) IMP BY RELAYING OF CCB ON BAHU AKBARPUR TO SAMARGOPALPUR 6.870 TO 6.970 (ID-1757) (III) STG. BY RELAYING OF 80MM IPB ON BHARAN SCHOOL APPROACH ROAD 0.0 TO 0.275 (ID-1812) (IV) STG. BY RELAYING OF CCB ON NIDANA TO SAMAR GOPALPUR KALAN 0.0 TO 2.74 (ID-1819) (V) STG. ON UPTO HOSPITAL I/C BEE PASS IN BALLAMBHA 0.0 TO 2.9 (ID-9733, 1848) (VI) WDG. AND STG. UPTO POOJA STHAL IN KHARAK JATTAN 0.0 TO 3.5 (ID-HSA	11.09.2026 21.09.2026	336.71 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	09416046666 pwd-eeepd1-rohtak@hry.nic.in
4	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	04 NO. WORK (I) STG. ON KANHELI TO PEHRAWAR ROAD FROM KM. 0.0 TO 4.2 (ID- 1772) (II) STG. BY WAY OF PDG. AND LAYING 80MM IPB ON RTK -BERI ROAD TO BABA HARIDAS MANDIR IN VILLAGE SUNARIYA KHURD FROM KM. 0.0 TO 0.90 (ID- 783) (III) STG. ON GARNAUTHI TO KAHNAUR ROAD VIA KAKRANA SUNDANA IN VILLAGE KAKRANA FROM KM. 5100 TO 5150, 5650 TO 5700 AND IN VILLAGE SUNDANA FROM KM. 8.3 TO 8.4 (ID- 1876) (IV) STG. BY PDG. AND LAYING CCB ON LINK ROAD FROM NH-10 TO SH-16 ROAD (IDC CHOWK TO BHIWANI ROAD (ID-1692)	11.09.2026 21.09.2026	249.72 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	09416046666 pwd-eeepd1-rohtak@hry.nic.in
5	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	STG. ON NORTHERN BYE PASS ROHTAK ROAD FROM 5.730 TO 7.900 IN ROHTAK DISTT. (ROAD ID-1750)	11.09.2026 21.09.2026	220.12 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	09416046666 pwd-eeepd1-rohtak@hry.nic.in
6	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	WDG. AND STG. ON ISMILA TO KULTANA ROAD FROM KM. 0.000 TO 3.420 IN DISTRICT ROHTAK. WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27	11.09.2026 21.09.2026	339 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	09416046666 pwd-eeepd1-rohtak@hry.nic.in
7	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	STG. ON OLD DHS ROAD (CITY PORTION) FROM KM. 75.100 TO 78.000 IN DISTRICT ROHTAK. (ROAD ID- 10253	11.09.2026 21.09.2026	461.19 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	09416046666 pwd-eeepd1-rohtak@hry.nic.in
8	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	5 NO. WORK (I) STG OF ATAIL TO GANDHRA FROM KM.0.0 TO 4.25 (ID-1884) (II) IMP. BY WAY OF PDG AND LAYING IPB ON GJJJI SCHOOL FROM KM. 0.0 TO 0.35 IN (ID-1891) (III) STG. BY PDG. AND LAYING 80MM IPB AND 20MM PC ON ROAD OVER DRAIN NO. 8 FROM SANGHI TO CHHAJU WALA BRIDGE FROM RD 0 TO 1.530 IN (ID-10520) (IV) STG. ON OLD DHS ROAD IN VILLAGE ISMILA FROM KM.0.72 TO 1.65 IN (ID-1885) (V) STG. BY PDG. AND LAYING 80MM IPB ON SAMPLA TO KANSRAINTI FROM RD 0.8 TO 1.55 IN DISTT RTK. (ID-1902)	11.09.2026 21.09.2026	310.92 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	09416046666 pwd-eeepd1-rohtak@hry.nic.in
9	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	STG. ON OLD DHS ROAD IN VILLAGE KHARKARA FROM KM. 0.000 TO 4.350 IN ROHTAK DISTT. (ROAD ID- 12579)	11.09.2026 21.09.2026	338.03 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	09416046666 pwd-eeepd1-rohtak@hry.nic.in
10	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	03 NOS. WORKS (I) STG. ON KATESRA TO PILANA FROM KM. 3.000 TO 7.570 IN DISTRICT ROHTAK. (ROAD ID-1707) (II) STG. ON POLICE LINE QUARTERS TO SUNARIYA JAIL ROAD (LINKED TO HUDA ROAD) FROM KM. 0.000 TO 1.930 IN DISTRICT ROHTAK. (ROAD ID-10517) (III) STG. ON MARODHI JATTAN TO SUNARIYA JAIL ROAD FROM 0.000 TO 2.400 IN DISTRICT ROHTAK. (ROAD ID- 1737) UNDER WP-2026-27	11.09.2026 21.09.2026	396.66 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	09416046666 pwd-eeepd1-rohtak@hry.nic.in
11	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	ROAD CUT RESTORATION OF OLD DHS ROAD IN MEHAM CITY PORTION IN ROHTAK DISTT. (ROAD ID-10312)	11.09.2026 21.09.2026	133.32 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	09416046666 pwd-eeepd1-rohtak@hry.nic.in
12	PWD B&R, FATEHABAD	S/R/STG./WDG. OF 06 NO. ROADS UNDER RATIA CONSTITUENCY IN FATEHABAD DISTT. (W. P.2026-27) (GROUP-1) 1. RAISING AND RELAYING CCB ON BADALGARH TO DHANI BABANPUR (ID 5521) 2. STG. AND RELAYING OF CCB ON DARIYAPUR TO AHLISADAR(ID 5491) 3. RAISING AND RELAYING OF CC BLOCK ON RATIA TO BABANPUR(ID 5477) 4. STG. AND RELAYING CCB ON MEHMRA TO BHANI KHERA (ID 5480) 5. STG. ON BAHAMANNWALA TO REYOND UPTO PUNJAB BORDER (ID 11257) 6. WDG. AND STG. ON ROJANWALI TO BHUNDERWAS(ID 11269) (WITHOUT GST) + 7 WORKS	15.09.2026 30.09.2026	2534.01 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01667-220120 pwd-eeepd-fatehabad@hry.nic.in
13	PWD B&R, SIRSA	DNIT FOR S/R BY PDG. WDG. AND STG. RAISING/RE-CONSTN., PC/IPB OF 6 NOS. ROADS I.E. 1. MADHOSHINGANA TO MODIA KHERA KM 0 TO 4.79 (5931), 2. MITHANPURA TO KARAMSANA LENGTH 1.45(5921), 3. THOBRIA TO HARNI KM 0.90 TO 2.40 (0.30KM), 11704), 4. ELLENABD BYE-PASS TO TALWARA KM 0 TO 5.10 (11706), 5. DHANI NAIYAN TO BEHARWALA KM 5.80 TO 6.80 (2274), 6. KISANPURA SCHOOL TO DHANI SHAB RAM RAJU RAM KM. 0 TO 1.82 (9634) IN SIRSA DISTT. IN ELLENABAD CONSTITUENCY (W.P 2026-27) HEAD-3054 (GROUP- I) (WITHOUT GST + 8 WORKS	17.09.2026 29.09.2026	2382.68 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666-222959 pwd-eeepd2-sirsa@hry.nic.in
14	PWD B&R, HISAR	CONSTRUCTION OF NEW BUILDING OF GOVT. COLLEGE AT BOND KALAN IN CHARKHI DADRI DISTRICT (PDG. E.I. WORK ONLY). WORKS IMPROVEMENT WDG. AND STG. OF 5 NOS. ROADS (4 NOS. KALAYAT CONSTITUENCY AND (1 NO. PUNDRI CONSTITUENCY) I.E. (1) KATHAL HARSOLA ROAD TO SHERGARH (ID 10044) (2) PHIRANI TO VILLAGE ROHERA (ROAD ID 10118) (3) SONGRI TO SURTA KHERA UP TO BALU BADSIKRI ROAD (ROAD ID 12465) (4) MAJRA TO NAND KARAN TO JAKHOLI (ROAD ID - 9440) IN KALAYAT CONSTITUENCY AND (5) KATHAL KURUKSHETRA ROAD TO TEEK KEORAK ROAD (ROAD ID - 10404) IN VILLAGE TEEK PUNDRI CONSTITUENCY UNDER WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27. (GROUP-IV) + 3 WORKS	14.09.2026 22.09.2026	137.82 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662225651 pwd-eeed-hissar@hry.nic.in
15	PWD B&R, KAITHAL	RE-CONSTRUCTION ON OLD NH 71 A ROAD FROM KM. 6.790 TO 8.520 IN DISTRICT ROHTAK (ROAD ID 10313) (UNDER WORK PROGRAM 2026-27)	CLOSING DATE 25.09.2026	1562.22 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896320998 pwd-eeepd-kaithal@hry.nic.in
16	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	RE-CONSTRUCTION OF ROAD FROM MAHARAJA AGGRASAIN CHOWK TO RAILWAY STATION NARWANA IN JIND DISTRICT (M.C. ROAD)	11.09.2026 25.09.2026	807.17 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	09416046666 pwd-eeepd1-rohtak@hry.nic.in
17	PWD B&R, NARWANA	WDG STG 9 ROAD (1)APP. ROAD TO VETRY HOSPITAL PANIHAR CHECK 0.00 TO 0.300(5061)(2)CHIROD RAILWAY STATION APP. 0.00 TO 0.200(4769)(3)BHERIA TO RAJGARH ROAD VIA KALUWAS PTH 0.00 TO 1.00(5064)(4)CHOUDHRYWAS TO GAWAR 5.560 TO 5.760(4953)(5) HISAR RAJGARH TO PANIHAR CHECK 1.800 TO 2.020(4959)(6)GIRLS SCHOOL TO DHARAMSALA PATTAN 0.00 TO 0.200(5072)(7)TALWANDI RUKKA SCHOOL APP. 0.00 TO 0.300 (4773)(8)RAWAT KHERA JAMBESHWAR MANDIR 0.00 TO 0.330(4770)(9)GANGWA TO KAIMRI 0.00 TO 2.300(10513)(NALWA 26-27 G3) + 1 WORKS	17.09.2026 24.09.2026	53.47 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	7599999782 pwdnarwana@gmail.com
18	PWD B&R, HISAR	SPECIAL REPAIR/WDG./STG. OF 02 NO. ROADS UNDER RATIA CONSTITUENCY IN FATEHABAD DISTRICT (WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) (GROUP-14) 1. SPECIAL REPAIR OF ROAD FROM SEIKHPUR SOTTER TO PALSAR ROAD KM. 0.0 TO 2.85 (ROAD ID 9053) 2. SPECIAL REPAIR OF ROAD FROM HASANGA TO DHANI RAIPUR ROAD (ROAD ID 9106) KM 0.0 TO 1.80 (WITHOUT GST)	CLOSING DATE 26.09.2026	824.88 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9878384499 pwd-eeepd1-hissar@hry.nic.in
19	PWD B&R, FATEHABAD	CONSTRUCTION OF SUB HEALTH CENTRE AT VILLAGE DUDHWA	17.09.2026 30.09.2026	340.28 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01667-220120 pwd-eeepd-fatehabad@hry.nic.in
20	PANCHAYATI RAJ, CHARKHI DADRI	BEAUTIFICATION OF POND NO 174 VILLAGE ASSAN KALAN BLOCK PANIPAT + 6 WORKS	14.09.2026 21.09.2026	46.63 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9582622008 xenprcharkhidadri@gmail.com
21	PANCHAYATI RAJ, PANIPAT	CONST. OF RASTA FROM CHANDWAS ROAD TO HANSAWAS KALAN SEEMA AT VILLAGE CHANDWAS + 1 WORKS	17.09.2026 23.09.2026	294.41 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9068676922 prexeeng.pnp@gmail.com
22	PANCHAYATI RAJ, CHARKHI DADRI	GOHIDA CONSTRUCTION OF GRAM SACHIVALAYA AT VILLAGE GOHIDA BLOCK NISSING + 4 WORKS	14.09.2026 21.09.2026	77.52 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9582622008 xenprcharkhidadri@gmail.com
23	PANCHAYATI RAJ, KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR SUPPLY MEDICINE & CONSUMABLE (TIMOLOL EYE DROPS 0.5%, 5ML, FLUTICASONE CREAM 0.01%, 10GM, POVIDONE IODINE OINTMENT 5% ,15GM ETC.) AT KCGMC, KARNAL	15.09.2026 24.09.2026	187.28 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896202019 prexeeng.krl@hry.nic.in
24	PANCHAYATI RAJ, BHIWANI	E-TENDER FOR SUPPLY MEDICINE & CONSUMABLE (TAB. ISOSORBIDE MONONITRATE 20MG, TAB. LORAZEPAM 2MG, TAB. QUETIAPINE 200MG, TAB. TAMUSULOSIN 0.4MG ETC.) AT KCGMC, KARNAL	15.09.2026 21.09.2026	12.09 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01664243927 prexeeng.bhw@hry.nic.in
25	PANCHAYATI RAJ, SONIPAT	E-TENDER FOR SUPPLY MEDICINE & CONSUMABLE (INJ. MULTI VITAMIN 10ML, MULTI VITAMIN DROP 15ML, LULICAZONE CREAM 1% 10GM, I.V. CANULAS 24 NO. ETC.) AT KCGMC, KARNAL	17.09.2026 24.09.2026	27.11 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9146391006 prexeeng.snp@gmail.com
26	DIRECTOR GENERAL SUPPLIES & DISPOSALS PANCHKULA, HARYANA	ANNUAL RATE CONTRACT OF SEWER CLEANING RODDING MACHINES WITH ALL ACCESSORIES.	19.09.2026 19.10.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0172-2570122 Supplies@hry.nic.in
27	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, HISAR	LAND DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME OF WATER LOGGED AND SALINE SOILS THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE PROJECT AT VILLAGE -BADALA,BHATOL RANGRAN AND JEETPURA BLOCK - HANSI- II, DISTT. HANSI	17.09.2026 28.09.2026	266.61 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9813562162 aschoisar@gmail.com
28	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, HISAR	LAND DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME OF WATER LOGGED AND SALINE SOILS THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE PROJECT AT VILLAGE - PATAN BLOCK - HISAR- II DISTT. - HISAR	17.09.2026 28.09.2026	191.31 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9813562162 aschoisar@gmail.com
29	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, PANCHKULA	1. SUPPLY OF HARDWARE ITEMS PERTAINING TO M.GARH WS (M) DIVISION, NARNALU + 1 OTHER WORK	18.09.2026 01.10.2026	30.47 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01722582542 xenproc@gmail.com
30	FOREST DEPARTMENT, HISAR	5 TENDER FLOATED BY HISAR FOREST DIVISION FOR PLANTATION WORKS AT DEPOSIT WORK IN HISAR, HANSI & ADAMPUR RANGE UNDER JURISDICTION OF HISAR FOREST DIVISION.	17.09.2026 23.09.2026	477.02 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9992222537 dfhoisar.@gmail.com
31	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR SUPPLY MEDICINE & CONSUMABLE (TIMOLOL EYE DROPS 0.5%, 5ML, FLUTICASONE CREAM 0.01%, 10GM, POVIDONE IODINE OINTMENT 5% ,15GM ETC.) AT KCGMC, KARNAL	21.09.2026 28.09.2026	EMD 10000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896154463 director.kgchc-hry@gov.in
32	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR SUPPLY MEDICINE & CONSUMABLE (TAB. ISOSORBIDE MONONITRATE 20MG, TAB. LORAZEPAM 2MG, TAB. QUETIAPINE 200MG, TAB. TAMUSULOSIN 0.4MG ETC.) AT KCGMC, KARNAL	21.09.2026 28.09.2026	EMD 10000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896154463 director.kgchc-hry@gov.in
33	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR SUPPLY MEDICINE & CONSUMABLE (INJ. MULTI VITAMIN 10ML, MULTI VITAMIN DROP 15ML, LULICAZONE CREAM 1% 10GM, I.V. CANULAS 24 NO. ETC.) AT KCGMC, KARNAL	21.09.2026 28.09.2026	EMD 10000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896154463 director.kgchc-hry@gov.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in

No.49430/HR



GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA

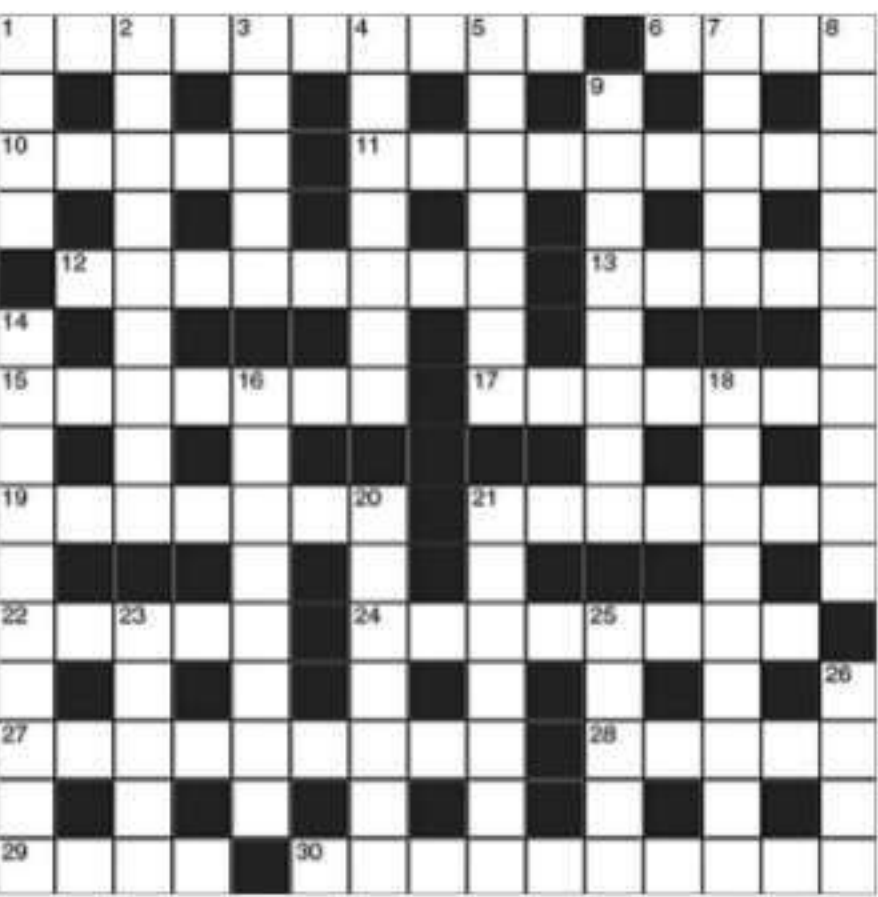
TENDER NOTICE



SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP/ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP/AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	DHBVN	27/XENCIVIL/HSR/2026-27 DATED 20.05.2026 RE-CONSTRUCTION OF BOUNDARY WALL AND OTHER ALLIED CIVIL WORK TO PREVENT THE 33 KV SYSTN., KARANDI (FATEHABAD) FROM FLOOD WATER	17.09.2026 28.09.2026	60.47 LACS	www.dhbvn.org.in	9813045911 xencivilhsr@dhbvn.org.in
2	DHBVN	19/XENCIVIL/HSR/2026-27 DATED 14.05.2026 RE-CONSTRUCTION OF BOUNDARY WALL AND OTHER ALLIED CIVIL WORKS TO PREVENT THE 33 KV SYSTN., BEHBALPUR (FATEHABAD) FROM FLOOD WATER	17.09.2026 28.09.2026	83.36 LACS	www.dhbvn.org.in	9813045911 xencivilhsr@dhbvn.org.in
3	DHBVN	11/XENCIVIL/JGN/2026-27 CONSTRUCTION OF COMPLAINT CENTER MOTLAN KALAN UNDER OP CIRCLE REWARI	17.09.2026 24.09.2026	12.80 LACS	www.dhbvn.org.in	9813045911 xencivilhsr@dhbvn.org.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaprocurement.gov.in or [www.etenders.hry.nic](http://www.etenders.hry.nic.in)

CROSSWORD



ACROSS
1 Good ones get a lot of backing — so research shows (10)
6 A conservative leader about to give ground (4)
10 Steel or brass (5)
11 Promise to look after one's funeral? (9)
12 It makes pears lie against the wall for example (8)
13 Bill is a first name (5)
15 Very eager for everybody to go back after a key (3,4)
17 Motoring clubs? (7)
19 Waiting to be stocked (2,5)
21 Troops didn't finish the course (7)
22 Two in difficulties being pulled along (2,3)
24 Travelling after the game (2,6)
27 The present perfect? (5,4)
28 An icy blockhouse (5)
29 The piper's upset. Get a photo! (4)
30 Mission can offer conversion to the restless (10)

DOWN
1 Band call (4)
2 A case of building-up ready for the maiden flight (9)
3 He gets involved with any wild carnivore (5)
4 Carefully arranged touring may depend on it (7)
5 In the nude maybe and blushing but carried on (7)
7 She doesn't make a full declaration (5)
8 Training for employment (10)
9 Falling behind on the track (8)
14 Aids Alec if it is required (10)
16 Kindly feeling for worthy Shakespeare (8)
18 Male reads about girl from Notre Dame (9)
20 Noise or disturbance can be wearing (7)
21 Turn to riots to get food (7)
23 A Greek character at the Exchange (5)
25 Pretend to sound desirous (5)
26 For which there are bids in plenty (4)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6097 **ACROSS:** 1 Retired, 5 Cameo, 8 Light meal, 9 Tap, 10 Cuba, 12 Droughts, 14 Anyone, 15 Legend, 17 Switches, 18 Used, 21 Mad, 22 Incumbent, 24 Dowse, 25 Respond **DOWN:** 1 Relic, 2 Tag, 3 Rats, 4 Dreary, 5 Coloured, 6 Matchless, 7 Opposed, 11 Bay window, 13 Inactive, 14 Assumed, 16 Fencer, 19 Dated, 20 Amos, 23 Ego

JUMBLLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

Definiteness of ____ is the starting point of all achievement.
- W. Clement Stone (7)

DNTER

APYOS

GNRSPU

KNSUYP

W. Clement Stone

ANSWER: Definiteness of purpose is the starting point of all achievement. - W. Clement Stone (7)

6098

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 5s
INSTRUCTIONS
To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6446

	7	8			3	9		
9				6	3	8		1
			5				6	
	7	5				4	8	
	1			2				
8		9	1	4				7
	2	4			5	9		

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6445

2	7	8	9	6	1	4	5	3
3	9	6	2	4	5	8	1	7
4	5	1	3	7	8	2	6	9
7	6	3	4	9	2	1	8	5
8	1	9	6	5	3	7	4	2
5	2	4	1	8	7	3	9	6
6	8	5	7	3	4	9	2	1
1	4	7	5	2	9	6	3	8
9	3	2	8	1	6	5	7	4

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): This is a tricky day. Don't be too ambitious today. Kick back and relax. But do be aware that communications with parents and authority figures might be confused, vague or subject to misunderstandings. Tonight: You're admired.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Avoid controversial subjects and important discussions about politics, religious issues and travel. You might be interested in a new relationship with someone different. Tonight: Explore something new.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): This is a poor day for financial discussions or how to share something with a friend. Wishful thinking will outweigh rational analysis. However, a work-related romance might be dreamy and promising. Tonight: Check your finances.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Be careful in discussions with parents, bosses as well as partners, because distorted views and misunderstandings are classic today. Be aware of overdoing alcohol. Tonight: Listen to others.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Work-related relationships will be supportive today, perhaps even romantic. Discussions about foreign countries or issues related to travel, politics and religion will very likely be confusing. You won't know what to believe. Tonight: Get organised.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): This is a lovely day for romance, playful outings and socialising. Having said that, be careful about dealing with shared expenses, property and the wealth and resources of others. Something is off or incorrect. Assume nothing. Tonight: Enjoy socialising.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Today you're in a dreamy state of mind, which can promote fantasies more than reality. It's a poor day for important decisions. Something to do with your finances or purchases will please you. Keep your receipts. Tonight: Relax at home.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): This is basically a relaxed dreamy day. Don't give yourself an ambitious agenda. Be careful of overdoing alcohol or something that can confuse you, because this is possible today. Tonight: An interesting conversation.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): In many ways, this is a laid-back, feel-good day! There might be confusion or incorrect assumptions in romantic relationships. Double-check all your details. Make sure you're on the same page. Tonight: Check your money.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Today the Moon is in your sign, which gives you a slight advantage over others. Relations with friends and groups will be warm and supportive. Be careful with family discussions. This is where confusion might trip you up. Be clear. Tonight: You win.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Relations with bosses, parents and authority figures are warm and supportive. People are happy to see you. If you feel a sense of confusion or that something fishy is going on, it probably is. Tonight: Privacy.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Be careful about financial agreements between friends and groups today. Double-check details for errors or wrong assumptions. Enjoy meeting people from different backgrounds. Learn something new. Tonight: Friendships.

CORPORATE BRIEFS

EDUCATION



JAMIA HAMDARD - CELEBRATIONS

Jamia Hamdard commemorated the 118th birth anniversary of its founder, Late Hakeem Abdul Hameed Saheb, at Hamdard Convention Centre, New Delhi. Held under the patronage of Chancellor Janab Hammad Ahmed Saheb, the event featured Dr. Sanjay Kumar, Chairman, Agricultural Scientists Recruitment Board, as Chief Guest. The highlight was the Hakeem Abdul Hameed Memorial Lecture 2026 on "Bioresources for a Thriving Bioeconomy: Linking Nature, Science and Livelihoods." Dr. Kumar highlighted India's growing bioeconomy and Hakeem Saheb's vision for humanity, education and scientific advancement. Vice Chancellor Prof. (Dr.) M. Z. Abdin reaffirmed Jamia Hamdard's commitment to excellence, innovation and social responsibility.



ITS COLLEGE OF HEALTH AND WELLNESS SCIENCES - EVENT

ITS College of Health and Wellness Sciences (ITSCHWS) celebrated World Physiotherapy Day on 8th September with high energy and enthusiasm under the theme "Motion, Mind & Masterpieces." Bachelor of Physiotherapy (BPT) students showcased their talent across a diverse array of competitive events, blending healthcare awareness with artistic expression. The day featured spirited intellectual debates during an Extempore competition, alongside creative contests including Face Painting, Jute Bag Painting, Digital Poster Making, and a "Best Out of Waste" initiative. Students also demonstrated their versatility in a Short Reel Screening and a fireless culinary showcase, "Cooking Without Fire." The vibrant event highlighted not only the academic dedication of future physiotherapists but also their creative ingenuity and community spirit.



SARLA CHOPRA D.A.V. PUBLIC SCHOOL, NOIDA - ORIENTATION

The school organised a Parent Orientation Session under Project MATE (Mind Activation Through Education) to sensitise parents about its objectives, significance and implementation. The session featured Dr. Nand Kumar, Professor, Department of Psychiatry, AIIMS, New Delhi, alongside Dr. Deepika Dahima and Ms. Priyanka Tandon. The resource persons highlighted mental health, emotional well-being and holistic child development, emphasising supportive family and school environments. Parents actively participated, sharing concerns and queries. The session strengthened collaboration among parents, the school and mental-health professionals.



LBSIM - LEADERSHIP DELEGATION

The Directorate of Training, Placement and Alumni Affairs (DTPAA), Jamia Hamdard, in collaboration with the School of Management and Business Studies, successfully organised the SMBS Alumni Meet 2026, witnessing participation from over 350 alumni from India and abroad. Alumni from batches 2001–2026, representing management, healthcare, pharmaceutical management, and hospitality programmes, reunited to celebrate their enduring bond with the University. Hon'ble Vice Chancellor Prof. (Dr.) M. Z. Abdin highlighted the vital role of alumni in institution building through mentorship, industry linkages, placements, internships and knowledge sharing. Distinguished alumni were felicitated for their achievements and contributions. An engaging panel discussion offered students valuable insights into careers, industry expectations and professional skill, sand strengthened their shared institutional connection.



AJAY KUMAR GARG ENGINEERING COLLEGE - CONFERENCE

The 1st International Conference on Innovations in Electronics, Communication and Computing Techniques (IEC2T-2026) commenced at AKGEC, Ghaziabad. Co-sponsored by the IEEE U.P. Section, the two-day physical event selected the top 10% of over 1,200 submitted research papers across seven technical tracks. The inauguration featured Chief Guest Prof. S. N. Singh (Director, ABV-IIITM Gwalior), Guests of Honour Dr. P. C. Panchariya (CSIR-CEERI) and Mr. Jitender Garg (BSNL), alongside AKGEC Director Dr. Hemant Ahuja and General Chair Dr. Neelesh Kumar Gupta. Day one featured keynotes by Mr. Preet Yadav (NXP Semiconductors) and Mr. Pawan Chhabra (Intel, USA), alongside parallel technical sessions and an IEEE student poster competition. The event is led by Dr. Gupta, Conference Chair Dr. Himani Garg, and Organizing Chair Dr. Naresh Kumar.

LOTUS VALLEY INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL- SCHOOL CONNECT

Education must go beyond academic achievement. It must nurture values, character, life skills and emotional well-being. As children enter middle school and navigate the transition into adolescence, they seek greater independence while facing new emotional, social and digital influences. This often brings concerns around discipline, declining life skills, excessive screen exposure, distractions and communication. A thought-provoking question for every parent is: "Who do you want your child to become?" The answer lies in a strong home-school partnership built on:

- Clear and consistent boundaries
- Punctuality, discipline and responsibility
- Respect for school identity and values
- Age-appropriate guidance on relationships and digital behaviour
- A nurturing environment where children feel heard and valued
- Parents who model the values they expect from their children
- Consistent reinforcement of positive behaviour at home and school

When school and home speak the same language of values, accountability and empathy, children are better equipped to grow into confident, responsible and compassionate individuals. Academic success matters—but the person a child becomes matters even more. So let's join our hands as together we can and together we will make a difference. -Written by Neerja Rishi

‘Ten hours of running about, no food... my body was depleted’



VARUN SANYAL

● *Sanyal will represent India in the men's traditional 77kg category of MMA at the Asian Games.*

IT WAS a long flight from India and once I landed in Japan, I thought my trip was done and I would finally catch

up with some rest. But it was one crazy day (Thursday). My selection to the team was pretty late and I first flew from London to Mumbai.

From Mumbai, it was a six hour trip to Singapore, five hours layover and then another five hours to Nagoya making it a total of a 16-hour trip for me apart from the London to Mumbai flight.

There were a lot of social media posts about the chaotic situations athletes were facing, specially related to the allocation of the rooms. First, I thought it

was a routine delay but eventually it lasted for hours.

Once I landed in Nagoya, I took the shuttle to the Exhibition center. But the videos were doing rounds on the social media and it was no less than chaotic.

The athletes were all over the place in the convention center. Some were lying around, some were sleeping on the floor and others were just waiting.

I arrived and went to register myself by showing my accreditation card, which also serves as my visa but the system didn't

have my name. I was like a total ghost in their system. At first, I thought it was some glitch as I hadn't seen what was happening around.

Other Indian officials were also waiting with me and we left the facility after three hours. However, my problem wasn't solved and they asked me to go to the cruise ship where all the athletes are staying.

It took a 30 minute bus ride to reach the cruise ship. But there was no communication between

the exhibition center and the cruise ship and I had to go through the whole process of getting my name registered again.

They started doubting if I had been registered at all. To which, I showed my card and said that the immigration official let me in and that is because I have been registered.

I was asked to contact my National Olympic Committee and I did that.

I was asked to go to another facility, which was another 30

minutes away and like the previous two, they also had no idea. Another thing is that none of these facilities had anything to eat. They just gave water bottles and one can't go out to buy anything.

At the third facility, I saw a Tajik person and a Sri Lankan team stranded in a similar position as me.

That is when I realized that it is a widespread problem and everybody is suffering.

Finally, after running around for more than 10 hours and three different facilities, I got a room

to sleep. However, 30 minutes later, two Indian athletes also claimed that the room was assigned to them.

I was like, 'not again'. Eventually the mess was sorted out and I got to catch up on my much needed sleep.

Another thing to note is that as combat fighters, we have to cut weight and maintain our nutrition in the body.

We need to eat something. My body was depleted when I fell down on the bed. I will play the first round on September 20 and lost close to a whole day in

sorting out this mess, which was honestly not mine to sort out.

I made a video about it also but I was requested to take it down. The interesting thing is that India would have been a butt of jokes globally had these things happened there. It is really important that the ordeal of our athletes is mentioned.

Anyway, right now I know all I want is to focus on my weight cut and be ready to represent my country.

VARUN SANYAL SPOKE TO PRITISH RAJ

● **INDIA WATCH**

DAY 1

TEQBALL, 6:30 AM

● Quimcy Dsouza is one win away from confirming India's first medal. She faces Indonesia's Sumaya in the women's singles semifinals.

● **BRIEFLY**

North Korea's anthem played ahead of South Korea's match

SOUTH KOREA faced Bangladesh in the first match of Pool A in men's hockey at the 2026 Asian Games on Friday but it was North Korea's national anthem that rang out at the Gifu Prefectural Green Stadium before the match. Moreover, the players had to do the customary handshakes with their opponents when the South Korean anthem was eventually played after Bangladesh's anthem.

Once the North Korean anthem concluded, organisers apologised for the gaffe and proceeded to play the Bangladeshi national anthem.

The South Korean anthem was then played after that. According to South Korea's *Yonhap* news agency, the referee instructed players to exchange greetings while the South Korean anthem was still playing due to time constraints. ENS

Manu, Toor to be flag-bearers

DOUBLE OLYMPIC medal-winning shooter Manu Bhaker and defending shot put champion Tajinderpal Singh Toor were named as India's flag-bearers for Asian Games opening ceremony. The ceremony is scheduled for Saturday, and a 158-strong Indian contingent will take part in it.

"Manu Bhaker will be one of the flag-bearers," India's chef-de-Mission Sahdev Yadav said. One of the four deputy chefs de mission and decorated former shooter, Anjali Bhagwat, said 158 members of the Indian contingent will take part in the opening ceremony. Bhaker made history at the 2024 Olympics by becoming the first athlete from Independent India to win two medals in a single edition of the Olympic Games. Toor won gold medals in the past two editions. PTI

STARTING OFF ON THE WRONG FOOT

Japanese city built on precision is having a very imprecise week

After record rainfall, Nagoya is facing an organisational storm of its own making



Mihir Vasavda
Nagoya, September 18

THE STREETS of Nagoya have dried. The trains are moving. The banners are up. The volunteers are in place. And across a city preparing to host the Asian Games and welcome 17,000 athletes and officials, the instinct is to carry on as though nothing happened.

Something, however, did. A week ago, the port city was dealing with record rainfall. Schools shut, trains were suspended and hundreds of Asian Games athletes had to be evacuated from their accommodation. Water leaked into some competition venues.

Now, with the opening ceremony on Saturday, the city looks remarkably composed. But the Games itself is confronting many a battle, putting under scrutiny the Japanese reputation for precision, which even delivered an Olympic Games in the middle of a pandemic.

On Friday, even the formal welcome for teams stumbled. India's ceremony at the Garden Pier athletes' village was delayed and then abruptly halted, leaving the Indian delegation and five other nations waiting. The organisers apologised and said there was "some trouble," without offering any further explanation. The promise to resume in 15 minutes turned into nearly two hours.

It was another small episode in a Games that has accumulated an unusually long list of them before the opening ceremony. India's shooters, for instance, landed at approximately 9pm on September 15. By the time they reached their accommodation, it was nearly 5am.

Another 30-35 Indian athletes were not allocated rooms. As a contingency measure, the Indian Olympic Association booked 18 extra hotel rooms and planned to reserve 10 more

in case any accommodation issues surface, chef de mission Sahdev Yadav said.

"They (organising committee) informed us that more players than expected had come (from India). But as far as India is concerned, that's not the case. We stuck to the number of players they had invoiced," Yadav said. "But they removed some names, so we booked hotels for them... we faced difficulty with regard to 30-35 athletes."

Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya said the country has set up three layers of assistance for its athletes, drawing on Nagoya's 2,000-strong Indian diaspora community. Two officials have been stationed at the airport, three more at the athlete welcome centre, and the residences of Indian diaspora members have been identified in advance, in case accommodation issues persist. Almost half of India's 501-member contingent is yet to reach Nagoya.

The logistical issues haven't spared anybody, be it South Korea or China, Qatar or Thailand, or even hosts Japan themselves.

The accommodation and the travel itself has become a story of a Games that wanted to be a trendsetter.

There is no traditional athletes' village. Instead, the 17,000 athletes and officials are spread across hotels, temporary container-style accommodation and the Costa Serena cruise ship docked at Nagoya Port. The OCA said the arrangements were a conscious attempt to avoid building an expensive village that could become a post-Games white elephant, and insist every registered participant has been provided with accommodation.

An official of the continental body, speaking anonymously, told this paper that apart from the cost-saving measures, this was also done because the declining and ageing population in the region meant there weren't many buyers for the repurposed flats after the Games.

Tayyab Ikram, the head of the OCA's coordination com-



Containers that house athletes participating in the 20th Asian Games in Nagoya, Japan. PTI

“They (organising committee) informed us that more players than expected had come (from India). But as far as India is concerned, that's not the case. We stuck to the number of players they had invoiced.”

SAHADEV YADAV
CHEF DE MISSION, INDIA

mission, said: "We had clear statistics about what is happening in the real estate values. We don't want to leave a white elephant after the Games here."

Missing giants

The complaints, meanwhile, keep coming. One theory doing the rounds in Japan is that the absence of one familiar force from the organisation of a major sporting event may have mattered.

Dentsu, Japan's giant adver-

tising and sports-marketing agency, is not involved in the Games' operation in the way it has been in previous major events. The agency's absence follows the fallout from the Tokyo Olympics corruption and bid-rigging scandal, which led to restrictions on Dentsu and other major agencies.

Former Japan Wrestling Federation vice-president and Aichi-based Shigakukan University president Ikuko Tanioka, speaking to *Yahoo Japan*, pointed directly to the unusual structure of these Games. "Dentsu and Hakuhodo, the advertising agencies, are not involved in the operation of these Asian Games. Aichi Prefecture and Nagoya City have organised the organising committee, and various people have come together to prepare for the Games," he was quoted as saying.

Tanioka was describing the structure rather than establishing a direct cause of the problems. But in Japan, a question has surfaced: has an attempt to move away from the traditional big-agency model exposed the difficulties of organising an event on this scale?

There have been other own-

goals, too. The welcome ceremony for the Costa Serena, the cruise ship being used as a floating hotel, featured performers dressed as Oda Nobunaga, Toyotomi Hideyoshi and Tokugawa Ieyasu, regarded as Japan's three big unifiers.

Hideyoshi's appearance prompted an official complaint from South Korea because of his role in Japan's invasions of Korea in the 1590s, an awkward historical choice at an event whose slogan is "Imagine One Asia."

All of which makes the backdrop particularly ironic. Nagoya is a city whose reputation has been built on making things work.

Industrial ecosystem

This is Toyota country, home ground of the world's most famous Japanese carmaker, but also the industrial ecosystem behind brands Indians know well, from Toyota and Lexus to Denso and Mitsubishi Heavy Industries.

Organisation, logistics and control, through its famous warlords and world-renowned factories, is something Nagoya is familiar with. And now, those traits are being tested.

Nagoya crosses fingers as typhoon approaches

Express News Service
Mumbai, September 18

THE *ASAHI SHIMBUN* media outlet reported that Typhoon No. 25 was moving west near Chichijima island (1030 kms to north of Nagoya) and could head into the Pacific coast of eastern Japan on September 20-21.

Residents of the distant Ogasawara islands, located south of Tokyo, were put on high alert for landslides on September 19 and to take precautions against high waves and strong winds. Nagoya, located in central Japan, hosts the Asian Games from September 19 to October 4.

The *Asahi Shimbun* quoted the Japan Meteorological Agency as saying that the storm could turn northward and then northeastward and bring heavy rain from eastern Japan to the northeastern Tohoku region (850 kms from Nagoya).

Asahi said that rainfall over the 24-hour period through noon on Sept. 21 is forecast to reach a maximum of 200 millimetres in the Kanto region (350 km from Nagoya) and the Izu islands (265 kms from Nagoya).

However, residents along the Pacific coast from the Tokai (17 kms from Nagoya) to Tohoku regions (820 kms) as well as in the Izu islands, were advised to be on alert for landslides, flooding in low-lying areas and rising rivers from September 20 to 21.

Japan's chef de mission for the Games Kosei Inoue, who is also senior executive board member of the Japanese Olympic Committee (JOC), had told the media on Thursday that due

to the weather some postponements and delays are likely in the sports schedule, around September 21 due to the Typhoon dubbed Dujan.

"Due to the heavy rain and severe weather, some competitions have already experienced delays or postponements, and there is also a possibility that a typhoon could approach on September 21," he told reporters. "Under these circumstances, we are holding thorough meetings within the JOC to ensure that we are fully prepared and capable of responding appropriately to these situations."

Dujan had moved west-northwest at 40 kph about 310 kilometers southeast of Chichijima island on Friday, as per the forecast.

"The typhoon had a central pressure of 975 hectopascals, with maximum sustained winds of 108 kph near the center and maximum gusts of 162 kph. Although the storm had shrunk in size from the previous day, it gained strength. The typhoon is expected to move east of the Kanto region by the morning of Sept. 21," *Asahi Shimbun* wrote.

The Japanese met office predicted that by the morning of September 22, the typhoon is forecast to move toward the ocean east of Japan and turn into an extratropical cyclone, leading to rains at Tokyo.

"Nagoya and Osaka are also likely to experience mostly cloudy conditions, although the chance of rain is expected to be lower than in Tokyo. Fukuoka may have more sunny days during the latter half of the Sept. 19 to 23 holiday period."



Japanese Scouts raise the Tricolour during the official welcome and flag-hoisting ceremony in Nagoya. PTI

Quimcy one win away from a medal in teqball

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 18

WITH THE official opening ceremony of 2026 Asian Games still a day away, a 24-year-old test engineer from sporting goods brand Decathlon is nearing a historic first medal for India in most unlikely of the sources, teqball. Mumbai-born Quimcy Dsouza, who played football at the U19 level, reached the semi-final of the women's singles on Friday.

In her first match at the Asian Games, Quimcy produced an upset after she came from a game down to beat world no 7 and home favourite Yuina Sakamoto of Japan 2-1 (10-12, 12-11, 13-11) in 43 minutes in her first match in Group B. In the next fixture, she took down

Koemyean Dy of Cambodia 2-0 (12-9, 12-7) in 24 minutes.

On Saturday, she'll have two shots at winning a historic medal for India. If she defeats Indonesia's Sumaya, it will confirm a podium finish for the Indian. Quimcy, who hails from Mumbai, started out as a middle distance runner at the age of 13. She also represented Maharashtra in age group football.

While her career in the sport of football didn't grow, the love for the game remained which further shaped her career as a teqball player.

After completing her Sports Management degree, Quimcy joined sports goods retailer Decathlon and started pursuing teqball after watching Brazilian legend Ronaldinho play it on Instagram videos.

India begin women's cricket gold defence by steamrolling Japan

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, September 18

IN THE last 107 hours, the Indian women's cricket team has lived in the eye of a storm. Some of it was self-inflicted, perhaps, having declined to receive the Women's Asia Cup trophy from Mohsin Naqvi, the ACC's sitting president but, more pointedly, Pakistan's interior minister. That controversy aside, India also reduced the final itself to a formality, dispatching Sri Lanka by 72 runs, before embarking on a near-8,000-kilometre odyssey — Dubai to Delhi first, and eventually on to Nagoya.

Against that backdrop, Harmanpreet Kaur's team could dearly have done with a campaign opener that did not demand much out of the players. They got precisely that in the fourth quarter-final of the

women's cricket competition at the 2026 Asian Games. Bowling hosts Japan out for 57, India strolled to the target inside five overs, shedding only two wickets along the way.

For Japan, whose men's team are themselves gearing up for a one-off T20I against India in Sano on September 22, an opportunity to play against the current 50-over world champions came as a rare platform to showcase their potential. The opening pair of Haruna Iwasaki and Ayaka Kato-Stafford made the most of that platform, scoring 24 in the powerplay, but crucially, without either's departure.

But that was the full extent of the moral victory Japan could claim. The next 33 runs cost all ten remaining wickets, as Sree Charani — the world's top-ranked T20I bowler — turned the contest into a mass-



India captain Harmanpreet Kaur (L) in a lighter mood with allrounder Deepti Sharma after the eight-wicket win over Japan at the Asian Games. PTI

The other concern could be their next opponents — Bangladesh. No side came remotely close to troubling India through the Asia Cup, but Bangladesh ran them closest,

ively lopsided duel. The left-arm spinner took four wickets for 10 runs, while Shafali Verma, who has recently made a strong case to be used more often with the ball by Harmanpreet, having scalped two wickets at the Asia Cup, chipped in with 2/13.

For Japan, Ayaka Kato-Stafford was the leading run-scorer with a 47-ball 25, albeit the first

metric can be ignored when playing against a team placed 36 slots higher in the ICC women's T20I team rankings.

Born in Brisbane to an Australian father and a Japanese mother, Ayaka has also represented Australia U-19 — making her debut at merely 15 — while her brother, Kazuma Kato-Stafford, plays as an all-rounder for the Japan men's team.

In the chase, nearly one-third of the target was scored in the first over itself, with Shafali accumulating 17 against Ahilya Chandel, whom she has previously faced in the nets of Delhi Capitals.

The next over brought Japan a rare moment of unbridled joy, as Nonoha Yasumoto trapped G Kamalini for a golden duck. In the next over, Ayaka proved her game extends well beyond the bat, as she dis-

missed Bharti Fulmali. While the wicket is of little significance in the context of the game, Fulmali not getting to cumulative triple-figure in international cricket despite having already played 13 T20Is will be a cause of concern for the Indian team.

The other concern could be their next opponents — Bangladesh. No side came remotely close to troubling India through the Asia Cup, but Bangladesh ran them closest, and might well have engineered an upset but for five dropped catches. Should Nigar Sultana Joty's side prove less charitable this Sunday, India will need to be at their best.

BRIEF SCORES: Japan 57 all out in 19.5 ovs (Ayaka Kato-Stafford 25; Sree Charani 4/10) lost to India 59/2 in 5 ovs (Shafali Verma 40 not out; Nonoha Yasumoto 1/8).

'It was my idea': Gukesh opens up on shock move to Board 4



D Gukesh at the Chess Olympiad in Samarkand. FIDE

Amit Kamath Mumbai, September 18

EYEBROWS SHOT up instantly when the Indian team announced their board order for the 2026 Chess Olympiad. D Gukesh has suffered bad form for the past 19 months with a barren stretch since becoming the youngest world champion at the age of 18.

But even then, India captain Srinath Narayanan's decision to place him on the fourth board - with R Praggnanandhaa, Arjun Erigaisi and Nihal Sarin - ahead of him led to speculation about the team management's faith in Gukesh. On a day he brushed aside Italian grandmaster Sabino Brunello in an imperious display of chess with black pieces, Gukesh explained how the order was finalised.

"It was my idea. The whole team... we all thought this is the board order that gives us the best chance of winning the tournament," Gukesh said in an interview with FIDE after his win on Friday. "It's clear that Pragg and Arjun have been in really good shape. And about the world champion playing on board four, if the team needs it I would rest all the games. There's no player bigger than the country."

On Thursday, Gukesh slipped below 2700 in the live ratings after being held to a draw against Indonesia.

"I wouldn't consider yesterday's result a disappointment. It was just a very good game by both sides. And my opponent defended well, sometimes you can't do anything. Today, I did nothing special. I had black pieces again, so I just wanted to play a good game. Luckily my opponent was a bit too creative and I took over," he said.

Powered by Gukesh's victory, the Indians thumped the Italians 3-1 with Pragg and Arjun playing out draws while Nihal Sarin claimed another win.

The women's team continued its imperious form against Greece, with Vantika Agrawal (board 3) and Savitha Shri (board 4) claiming their third wins in a row. While Koneru Humpy won on the top board, Divya Deshmukh was held to a draw on board 2.

The Indian team had claimed gold two years ago in Budapest losing just once in 44 contests across the four boards. They matched that record this time in the first round itself.

Gukesh explained that the organisational issues that led to the Indians not getting a room for six hours after landing in Samarkand had played a role. "We had a hectic travel and there were organisational issues. The first day was a bit tricky but after that, we are all rested."

Agarkar refuses extension; BCCI looking for new chief selector

Shankar Narayan & Devendra Pandey Mumbai, September 18

AJIT AGARKAR has decided not to seek an extension as chairman of the senior men's selection committee, and the BCCI will now look for a candidate for the post.

"Agarkar didn't ask for an extension. As there was no interest from his side, the BCCI has decided to look for a new chief selector," a source told *The Indian Express*.

This paper had reported in August that BCCI officials

would meet Agarkar to discuss a one-year extension to his term after India's tour of Sri Lanka amid differences over Rohit Sharma's ODI future in the lead-up to the 2027 ODI World Cup.

Agarkar was appointed chairman of selectors in July 2023. During his tenure, India reached the final of the ODI World Cup before winning the 2024 T20 World Cup and the 2025 Champions Trophy. India also retained the T20 World Cup earlier this year.

BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia remained non-committal

about Agarkar's future after Friday's AGM. "Today, there has been no discussion about any individual. We still have 15 days to go. We will take a decision and let you know at an appropriate time," he said.

Saikia also expressed confidence that the men's and women's Asia Cup trophies would eventually reach the Board's Mumbai office.

The women's team refused to accept the silverware from Asian Cricket Council president Mohsin Naqvi after beating Sri Lanka in the final in Dubai last Sunday. Naqvi is also the Pakis-



Ajit Agarkar was appointed chairman of selectors in July 2023. PTI

tan Cricket Board chairman and his country's interior minister. The Indian men's team

had taken the same position after winning the continental tournament last year.

PATIENCE FOR PRODIGY

In supersonic era, Vaibhav has to play waiting game

Samson and Abhishek ahead in the hierarchy, insists Gambhir

Shuvaditya Bose New Delhi, September 18

"HE HAS to wait," said Gautam Gambhir, head coach of the Indian men's cricket team, in the aftermath of a 3-0 demolition of Afghanistan.

The operative word in that four-word sentence was the last one: wait. A concept increasingly alien to Generation Z. The unabashed, unafraid cohort that, according to a global study conducted by Yahoo and OMD Worldwide, has an attention span of 1.3 seconds.

And yet, wait he must.

Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, the youngest debutant of a nation with cricketing pedigree nearing a century, will have to bide his time before claiming a place in India's T20I XI. The rope will be long, Gambhir has promised. But first, the wait must be longer still.

"From Vaibhav's point of view, it was again a very clear conversation that he has to wait for his opportunity. We know the kind of talent he has. We know what he can do, but again, someone who's done extremely well over a period of two years (Sanju Samson), obviously, he will always be ahead of someone who's just walked into the team. So, whenever he gets that run, he will get a longer run as well. That's how cricket goes, whether you're a 15-year-old or a 30-year-old. When you have to wait for your opportunity, you have to wait for your opportunity," said Gambhir.

It is a sentiment strangely out of step with the age it is spoken in — this era is being heralded as the era of sporting prodigies. But, one must know — there is global sports, and then there is Indian cricket.

Still, it could be worth borrowing a page from the world beyond the boundary rope.

In a timeline in which Sooryavanshi was not yet a household name — which may sound like another age alto-



Vaibhav Sooryavanshi last made the India playing XI in July, against Zimbabwe. CREIMAS

gether, though it was only September 2023 — football had already found its wunderkind. At 16 years, a month and 26 days, Lamine Yamal made his debut for Spain.

Before he did so, Spain's coach Luis de la Fuente was asked whether it would be a gamble to trust a talent that raw, that unrefined.

"I have total confidence in him. Lamine appeared very good to me watching him on TV, but working with him you realise even more his potential. He seems even better," de la Fuente had said.

In the 44th minute against Georgia, Yamal entered the field as Spain's youngest international. Thirty minutes later, he became its youngest goalscorer. Three years hence, he is the youngest to win both the European Championship and the World Cup. Change the green of the football pitch for the asphalt of a Formula 1 circuit, and attention shifts to Andrea Kimi Antonelli, Mercedes' youngest-ever driver at 18 years and 203 days. That, too, a replacement of the seven-time champion, Lewis Hamilton.

"I made up my mind five minutes after Lewis Hamilton told me that he's going to Ferrari," team principal Toto Wolff

said after signing Antonelli.

Wouldn't it be a risk? "When you invest in young drivers, you need to be prepared to take that risk," he had said. A year later, Antonelli became the youngest-ever championship leader.

Risk aversion

By deciding not to tinker with an experienced pair up top, the Indian team management have made their pen-chant for risk aversion evident.

Numbers, though, argue Sooryavanshi's case with quiet insistence. Since his debut in the Indian Premier League, he ranks first among batters for powerplay runs (665), strike rate (228.95) and sixes (54). His international debut did not possess the same shimmer as Yamal's — he made 14 against England in Manchester — but with 151 runs in three T20Is against Zimbabwe, which earned him the Player of the Tournament award, he had shown his ability to adapt, improvise and overcome difficulties.

For Gambhir, though, the calculus runs deeper than anything de la Fuente or Wolff had to weigh. Sooryavanshi's direct competitor had also won a Player of the Tournament award recently — not in a series against twelfth-ranked Zim-

babwe, but at the T20 World Cup. Sanju Samson.

After the Afghanistan series, where Samson finished as the second-highest run scorer with 117 runs at 39 and 180, Gambhir alluded to it.

"Someone doesn't become a Player of the Tournament in a World Cup without having any talent, so he (Sanju Samson) has done enough. Obviously, it was tough, probably the toughest decision I've taken in my coaching tenure, leaving him out in that England series because obviously the way he performed before that.

"But again, sometimes you go with a player's form as well, and in this series, I was always very clear, from my point of view, that we want to go back with the combination that we had during the World Cup," said Gambhir. Since the T20 World Cup, only two openers from Test-playing nations — Abhishek Sharma and Brian Bennett — have outsourced Samson in T20Is.

Cricket, like life, becomes intelligible only in hindsight. The dilemma Gambhir finds himself in contains no right or wrong choice — only his choice. And that, he made it clear on Thursday night.

So, we wait.

Well begun but nothing done as India fall 0-2 down vs Korea

Bhuvan Gupta New Delhi, September 18

THE MAJOR talking point in the lead-up to India's South Korea visit was the slow, low court prepared to counter Dhakshineswar Suresh and Sumit Nagal in the Davis Cup Qualifiers in Seoul.

However, both players adjusted quickly to the conditions on D-Day. They just couldn't outlast their opponents.

Dhakshineswar and Nagal both squandered one-set advantages to leave India a mountain to climb. The Koreans need just one more win from the three rubbers on Day 2 to enter the Final 8 of the prestigious team competition.

Soonwoo Kwon and Hyeon Chung were dull off the blocks but sped into gear as their matches wore on. They showed their class towards the end, sucker-punching the Indians with tactical brilliance.

In the opener, Kwon took longer than Dhakshineswar to find his serving and striking rhythm on the sluggish court. By the time he did, 'DK' had run away with the first set.

The tall 26-year-old broke Kwon's serve straight away. His own big service kept him going despite the nature of the hard court. Dhakshineswar sealed the set with an ace wide out on the Kwon forehand.

Change in tack

Kwon then went wider with his serves and groundstrokes. He started stroking the ball better, forcing errors and loose returns off the DK backhand. The Indian's first serve percentage also slipped to 48 in the second set from 57 in the first. The physical toll of the slow conditions was becoming apparent.

Conversely, Kwon's returns got deeper, pushing the attack-happy DK back. The 157-ranked Korean's service firmed up — he won all 14 points on his first serve in the second set. Compelled to go for aces, Dhakshineswar netted four double faults in the set. He had none in the first.

DK saved two break points in Game 4 of Set 2 with an ace and some gutsy volleying off his second serve. He staved off another in Game 6 with a delightful backhand passing shot. But the Korean was third-time lucky when he launched a powerful backhand down the

"Asia Cup trophies, we hope, they will come one day. I will not give you a timeline. But I can assure you that both the trophies will come and land up in this office of the BCCI at the Wankhede Stadium, Mumbai," Saikia said.

Meanwhile, the BCCI has increased the daily fees paid to domestic umpires, the first revision since 2017-18, and changed the way they will be graded and allotted matches.

"Since 2017-18, there had been no revision of the fees of the umpires. So we have done a restructuring of their cat-

egories. Earlier, there were four categories, A+, A, B and C. Now we have restructured it as A, B, C and D. All their fees per day have been enhanced substantially," the board secretary said.

Match referees will also receive higher fees. The board has also introduced a system under which an umpire's performance will determine the matches he gets. After every season, 10 umpires will move up a grade and 10 will move down based on their performance.

"Out of those who do well 10 umpires will be upgraded to the next level," he said.



Sumit Nagal lost to Hyeon Chung despite being 6-2, 4-3 up. AP

line to draw level. This shot was to dictate terms in the third set as well.

After four hard-fought games in the decider, Kwon dealt the first blow. DK thwarted two break points before slugging a forehand long. He saved the first match point with a searing ace out wide, but could not keep out the second one on Kwon's robust serve. The scoreline read 6-3, 3-6, 4-6 in the Korean's favour. DK's four-match unbeaten streak in the Davis Cup stood broken.

Nagal starts strong

If DK's start was good, Nagal's was better. But the fact that he let the match get away despite being 6-2, 4-3 up - with a break - would rankle him.

Chung started the match with a double fault. Nagal sensed the early vulnerability and broke through with a trademark inside-out forehand. The groundstroke became the fulcrum around which the Indian cracked Chung's service open.

The former world No.19 retaliated with some gritty returning and Nagal double-faulted to be broken. The man from Jhajjar, Haryana broke right back and despite double faulting twice in his subsequent service game, took the set at the fourth time of asking.

Like Kwon, Chung found his range in the second set and the match became a duel of baseline shotmaking. Nagal held his own, fighting back from 0-40 down on serve in the

fourth game. His perseverance paid off in a marathon Game 7. Chung had seven game points and Nagal averted each one before pouncing on his first break point opportunity.

But Chung was not done yet. He turned back the clock to rediscover the flair with which he had once beaten Novak Djokovic and Alexander Zverev. The Korean broke back and put up an array of sublime backhands to bamboozle Nagal. The Indian, two games away from victory, lost the second set 4-6.

The drama heightened in the third set. Chung broke early to put Nagal under immense pressure. The 29-year-old Indian responded with a break of his own, followed by a really tense hold.

However, Nagal's legs and lungs were running out even as his mind was willing. He was valiant till the very end, even as Chung rode the vociferous crowd support to outlast the Indian 2-6, 6-4, 7-5.

"I had chances in the second set. I didn't close it down. I went for it, missed it, and from there the match pretty much changed," Nagal later said. "In the end, I guess he was better than me. That's it."

On Saturday, the onus will be on the experienced N Sriram Balaji and late entrant Niki Poonacha to keep India's hopes alive against Uisung Park and Jisung Nam. Adapting to the slow surface would not be enough. They'll have to last longer than their opponents.

LONG WAY TO GO

Tanvi conundrum: Physical fitness behind frittering of leads, not mental fragility

Shivani Naik Mumbai, September 18

THESE ARE sobering times for Tanvi Sharma, anointed by Indian badminton fans as the next big thing after Saina Nehwal and PV Sindhu. She was outplayed in the Junior World Championships final, and on Saturday at the Vietnam Open, the 18-year-old lost 21-19, 22-20 to Thai prodigy Sarunrak Vitidsarn, sister of former world champion Kunlavut, and Thai Gen Next in her own right after Ratchanok Intanon.

Sarunrak is 20, Tanvi two years younger, still green on the seniors circuit, with a game that needs small tweaks and greater physicality, both of which take time. What's raising hackles is that Tanvi led 19-13 and 20-16 in both games and couldn't convert. She has one of the most stroke-filled games around, but is prone to panicking when closing out, going for the lines

or rushing the net-kill, both of which a half-decent opponent will punish.

Sarunrak is smarter than your average Super 100 semis opponent. The only reason her ranking sits at World No. 106 is that the Thais don't dump expectations on juniors just entering the seniors circuit, forcing them to chase milestone time-lines the way Indians map every new player against Saina and Sindhu's own arcs.

Ratchanok was their certified prodigy, perhaps the most skilled shuttler ever, a senior World champion at 17. But anyone who follows the sport seriously knew that was a freak talent, not the norm. Even Saina lost her first Junior World Championships final, before winning it in 2008.

Undue pressure

Indians are rushing to project Tanvi as the heir apparent, adding pressure that shows up



Tanvi Sharma lost narrowly in the Vietnam Open semis. BAI

as poor decisions at the crunch. It doesn't help that she's pitted against Unnati Hooda, Anmol Kharb and a cohort of equally hardworking talents, all force-

fit into the "India's No. 2" slot. Tribalism around coaching centres creates bad blood and turns players into chess pieces, entirely avoidable.

Tanvi has one of the most stroke-filled games around, but is prone to panicking when closing out

Domestic rivalry is good, but not when it ignores age, experience and a simple truth: unless they're built as strong as Saina and Sindhu were, India's new crop of women's singles will take longer to match those results, even from 19-13 and 20-16 up. Sindhu and Kidambi Srikanth have both had similar meltdowns, well after winning World medals. It stems from tentative fitness, peak fitness being different from simply injury-free, breeding indecision if a coach can't fix it. But ultimately it's the player who has to handle the moment. Lakshya Sen has squandered leads at the Olympics too.

Satwik-Chirag have come back from 12-19 down and won. Carolina Marin made a career out of piling on pressure from a losing position. It's poor badminton literacy to think only Tanvi choked while Sarutong sat twiddling her thumb. Opponents force these moments all the time, and Tanvi will likely inflict the same on someone else in a few years.

Saina, Sindhu and Ratchanok were all physical freaks in their own ways. Tanvi has sublime strokes and overhead deception, and a solid feel for the game, but she isn't physically strong enough yet to navigate endgames. It isn't that she's mentally fragile, she probably isn't, but in fitness and raw strength she has distance to cover, and that will make her mentally sturdier too.

Haste to win

That endgame funk is hard to pin down. Game immaturity

means her rhythm can glitch near the close, points 17 through 21. In a hurry to pocket the set, she hacks at net strokes and goes for lines just to be sure. This is a semi-final; a young mind can leap ahead to the final already. Better endurance would let her get one more shuttle in and wait for the kill instead. Two points can feel like a lot when the mind is muddled about closing out in straight games, and 20-16 carries the same weight, with the added urge to avoid a decider. It's chaos in the head, a self-fulfilling prophecy for a player labelled an "error merchant." Easy to forget she won Taiwan on the same fearless strokes, minus the second-guessing.

Tanvi isn't the first Indian to go through this. Her temperament isn't really the issue; she's clearly fading over back-to-back days, which points to a need for stamina training that will take time. She may need a more in-

cisive, clinical coach than Park, though that wasn't the problem in Vietnam. What she needs, above all, is to get stronger, only so the lovely strokes have robust wheels on court.

Isharani Baruah faced Sarunrak in last Sunday's final in Ho Chi Minh City. With 15 Indians in the Top 100, and five of Vietnam's eight quarter-finalists Indian teenagers, the pressure on Tanvi should, ideally, be lower. But Indian fanbases keep pitting one teenager against another, and the Hyderabad-Bangalore-Guwahati-Unnati fan wars don't help. Nor does declaring Tanvi "finished" at 18 just because 15-year-old Tanvi Patri is winning International Challenges. Good popcorn, toxic for the players.

The hurtful losses come against shuttlers from other countries, Japan, Thailand, Indonesia, China, all surging, while Indians manufacture domestic quagmires instead.

